

Onyx — User Guide

Onyx · multi-process OS on Raspberry Pi 4

This guide explains how to **prepare**, **boot** and **use** Onyx: the desktop, the terminal, the file manager, the command-line tools, customization, and the application catalog.

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1. What you need

- A **Raspberry Pi 4**.
- A **microSD card** formatted as **FAT32**.
- An **HDMI display** (micro-HDMI on the Pi 4 side).
- A **USB keyboard** and a **USB mouse** (standard HID).
- (Optional) a **serial adapter** on GPIO14 (TXD) / GPIO15 (RXD), **115200 8N1**, 3.3 V, to view the boot log and error messages.

2. Preparing the SD card

Copy **all the contents** of the `sdcard/` folder to the **root** of a FAT32 card, then insert it into the Pi 4 and power on.

More partitions (optional). The Pi 4 starts only from the card's **first partition**, which must stay **FAT32**: in Onyx it is **SD:** (also **SD0:**). Partitions **2, 3, 4** of the card (MBR), when formatted **FAT32** or **exFAT**, appear as **SD1:**, **SD2:**, **SD3:** — e.g. a small FAT32 boot partition and a big **exFAT** one for your ROMs and disc images (exFAT has no 4 GB file limit). A FAT32 volume can be up to 2 TB (Windows' own formatter stops at 32 GB, other tools do not); a file on FAT32 is at most 4 GB – 1. They show in the file dialogs (`..` at a volume's root lists the volumes), in the File Viewer (**Go** menu) and in any path (`cd SD1:/roms`); a path starting with `/` stays on the current volume.

Card contents:

Item	Role
start4.elf, fixup4.dat, bcm2711-rpi-4-b.dtb, bcm2711-rpi-400.dtb, armstub8-rpi4.bin	GPU firmware + device trees (Pi 4 B, Pi 400) + Pi 4 ARM stub
firmware/brcmfmac4345{5,6}-sdio.*	Wi-Fi chip firmware: 43455 = Pi 4 B, 43456 = Pi 400 (the Pi 400 has a different Wi-Fi chip, CYW43456)
config.txt, cmdline.txt	boot configuration (see §3)
kernel8-rpi4.img	the Onyx kernel
apps/<name>.app/main	the applications (one per .app folder)
etc/autostart	commands run automatically at boot (read by <code>init</code>)
etc/quicklaunch.txt	apps pinned to the panel
bin/<tool>	the terminal command-line tools
etc/theme.txt	the desktop's colours (the Theme app)
skins/ (wings.bmp, button.bmp, menubar.bmp, cursor...)	graphic skin (<code>menubar.bmp</code> : the system menu bar, 2 states of 16×32 — bar / open title, 9-slice; a 3-colour bevel is drawn if absent)

To regenerate the contents from sources: `cd kernel && make stage` (see the [developer guide](#)).

3. Boot configuration

`config.txt`

Selects 64-bit mode and the kernel image for the Pi 4:

```
arm_64bit=1
kernel_address=0x80000
initial_turbo=0
enable_uart=1          # reliable serial console + removes the rainbow splash
disable_splash=1
[pi4]
armstub=armstub8-rpi4.bin
kernel=kernel8-rpi4.img
max_framebuffers=2
```

`cmdline.txt`

Parameters read at boot:

```
width=1920 height=1080 init=SD:/bin/init heartbeat=0 sdhs=1 netcore=1
```

- **width / height**: framebuffer resolution (default 1024×768; the card ships 1920×1080). Any size works (the firmware scales it to the monitor's mode); the monitor's native one is sharpest. An app's window can be as big as the screen. The Control Panel's **Display** applet changes it at once, and writes these two options for the next start.

- **init**: absolute path of the init program the kernel launches at boot (default `SD:bin/init`). `init` reads `SD:/etc/autostart` and starts the rest of the userland, so pointing `init=` at another ELF (e.g. a recovery shell) swaps the whole launcher without rebuilding the kernel.
- **heartbeat**: period in seconds of the kernel's GUI **heartbeat** line in the kernel log (default `5`; `0` = off). Read it with `kmsg` — e.g. remotely over `telnetd`. It shows uptime, frames per second, mouse/key events, tasks by state and every window with its queued (`q`) / dropped (`d`) events. The same GUI watchdog always warns when the compositor stops producing frames (and lists every task's state) and when an app stops pumping its window's events (a frozen app).
- **watchdog**: `watchdog=0` does not start the GUI watchdog at all (A/B testing).
- **sdhs**: the SD card runs in **High Speed** (50 MHz instead of 25: about 16 MB/s read with `fsbench` instead of ~10) — the default (`sdhs=1`). If a card misbehaves with it (boot errors, files that do not read back), set `sdhs=0`. `kmsg` says what is in use (`SD card mounted`).
- **sdcache**: `sdcache=0` turns off the **sector cache** (on by default: the FAT and the folders stay in memory, so opening files and listing folders no longer asks the card for every sector; writes still go to the card at once). For comparisons with `fsbench`.
- **dispdma**: `dispdma=0` makes the compositor's copies to the screen synchronous again (the 2D DMA started then polled, docs/05 §12, off) — to tell a display problem from another one.
- **The date of the files**: the Pi has no clock of its own; Onyx keeps the last time it knew in `SD:/etc/clock` (every 10 minutes and at shutdown) and starts from it at boot, until the network time (NTP) corrects it — so the files written early at boot get a date too.
- **hangreboot**: the **hang watchdog**, in seconds (default `15`, `0` = off): if Onyx freezes (the green LED stops blinking), core 1 notices it after 10 s, writes a report into the sectors of `SD:/etc/crashdump.txt` (prepared at boot) and restarts the Pi (the hardware watchdog does it after that time if even that fails — the green LED then blinks fast for 3 s, then stays lit 3 s if the report was written, or blinks slowly 3 times if not); the next boot keeps what it was doing (the last kernel log lines, where the processor was stuck, what the GPU and the display were doing, the free memory, a panic's registers and the addresses on its stack) to `SD:/etc/lastcrash.txt`. A kernel panic (an "Out of memory", a failed assertion) now writes that report at once too. An **app that stops answering** (its window no longer takes the mouse and the keys for 2 s) gets its own report, rewritten every 2 s into `SD:/etc/apphang.txt` (where the app is stuck, the memory, the last log lines); it becomes `SD:/etc/lasthang.txt` when the app answers again or is closed, and joins `SD:/etc/lastcrash.txt` if the Pi restarts meanwhile. Send those files along with a freeze report.
- **gpudirect**: `gpudirect=0`: the GPU renders into its own buffer, then copied, instead of writing the window's (or the full screen's) pixels itself — the same kind of test.
- **slice**: the app time slice, in 10 ms ticks (default `2` = 20 ms).
- **hogsched**: `hogsched=0` turns off the CPU-hog detection (apps preempted twice in a row lose priority — see docs/02); the scheduler is then plain round-robin (A/B testing).
- **netcore**: `netcore=1` runs the whole **network** (Wi-Fi, wpa_supplicant, TCP/IP, DNS, NTP) on **core 3**: the desktop and the network no longer slow each other down, and core 0 can rest when nothing happens. Core 3 is then no longer an app core: one emulator (or Doom) at a time gets a core of its own (core 2), the next one runs on core 0 as before. `kmsg` says `cores 1-3 started (core 1: sound, core 3: network)`. `netcore=0` (or no `netcore=`) keeps the network on core 0, as before — the way back if the Wi-Fi misbehaves with it.

Without a screen, the green **ACT LED** shows the state: slow blink (1 s) = kernel running, network not up yet; fast blink (0.2 s) = network up (`telnetd` reachable); **SOS** (· · · — — — · · ·) = kernel panic (an

exception; with a screen, the red panic page shows EC/ELR/FAR); LED frozen on or off = the kernel hangs. `config.txt` sets `hdmi_force_hotplug=1` so a headless Pi still gets a framebuffer (without it, Onyx would start neither the GUI nor the userland, `telnetd` included).

system.ini

General settings read at boot (`SD:system.ini`):

```
verbose=0      # 1 = log app start/stop/kill to the kernel log (see kmsg)
timezone=120   # minutes offset from UTC (60 = CET, 120 = CEST summer time)
ntp=pool.ntp.org # time server to sync against once the WLAN link is up
```

Wi-Fi (WLAN)

Onyx connects over the Pi's on-board Wi-Fi. Two files must be on the SD card:

- **SD:/firmware/** — the BCM/Cypress WLAN firmware. For the Pi 4 (CYW43455): `brcmfmac43455-sdio.bin`, `.txt` and `.clm_blob` (fetch them with `circle/addon/wlan/firmware/Makefile`, or copy them from a Raspberry Pi OS install).
- **SD:/etc/wpa_supplicant.conf** — your network credentials (⚠ stored in **clear text** — keep it on the card, do not publish it):

```
#country=BE
network={
    ssid="YourNetwork"
    psk="YourPassword"
    proto=WPA2
    key_mgmt=WPA-PSK
}
```

The link comes up a few seconds after boot (watch the log, or run `net`). It is fully optional: if the firmware/credentials are missing, the desktop still works — only the networked apps stay offline.

You don't have to edit the file by hand: the **Wi-Fi Settings** app (`wpaconf`, see §12) edits SSID / password / country / proto / key mgmt in a small form and rewrites `wpa_supplicant.conf` for you. The kernel only reads it at boot, so use its **Save & Reboot** button to apply the new credentials.

4. First boot

On power-on:

1. The firmware loads `kernel8-rpi4.img`.
2. The kernel initializes the display, the SD card and USB, then briefly shows a boot log.
3. The kernel launches the **init program** (`SD:bin/init` by default, or whatever `init=` in `cmdline.txt` points at), which runs each line of `SD:/etc/autostart` as a shell command. By default:
 - **run voronoy** paints the **wallpaper** (Voronoi pattern) and then exits;
 - **run menubar** starts the **menu bar**, **run dock** the **dock**, **run agenda** the **agenda widget**, **run notifyd** the notifications;
 - **keyb FR** sets the keyboard layout.

You then get the desktop — a **modernised CDE** (the look of the classic Unix desktop, redrawn with rounded corners, soft gradients and the user's framed buttons): the wallpaper, the menu bar at the top,

the **dock** at the bottom, the agenda widget at the top left. (The former Shelf strip and left panel are no longer started: the dock replaces them; `run shelf / run panel` still bring them back.)



The

desktop: the agenda on the wallpaper, a calculator, a terminal in front (its frame in the theme's colour, the others grey), the dock with the Internet drawer open, the menu bar.

5. The Onyx desktop

The "Onyx" desktop is made of the **menu bar** (menubar: the active app's menus, the Onyx menu, the time, the sound, the Wi-Fi), the **dock** (dock: the apps' drawers, the **workspaces**, lock / Control Panel / power, the Terminal, the File Viewer, the Trash) and the **agenda widget** (agenda). Everything is drawn in the theme's colours; the settings are in the **Control Panel** (§11).

The menu bar (menubar)

A system **menu bar** runs across the top of the screen (started by `autostart`), light, in the theme's face: it shows the **active application's name** (in bold) and **its menu**, and the time on the right — **click the time** for a **calendar** of the month (the arrows or the wheel change the month; **Open Calendar** starts the Calendar app) — with the **Wi-Fi state** just left of it: the usual arcs when the Pi is connected, a grey barred circle when it is not (checked about once a second, so a lost or restored connection shows up by itself), and the **volume** left of that (a speaker: 1–3 waves by the volume, a cross when muted).

- **Click the speaker:** a box with a **slider 0–10** (drag it or click it; moving it unmutes) and **Mute**. Kept in `SD:/etc/sound.ini`, applied again at boot. The terminal command `volume` does the same. Click elsewhere to close it.
- **Click the Wi-Fi icon:** the **Wi-Fi menu** — the networks around, strongest first (the scan takes ~3 s), signal bars, a padlock for the secured ones, *Connected / Known*. Click a network to join it: a

secured one not known yet asks its **password** (Show password; Enter or **Connect**). It is joined **without a reboot**: the network is added to `SD:/etc/wpa_supplicant.conf` (the known ones are kept; the last one chosen goes first), `wpa_supplicant` reads it again and a new address is asked (DHCP). The menu says *Connected to ...* and closes, or *Could not connect: check the password* after ~30 s. **Refresh** scans again, **Wi-Fi Settings...** opens `wpaconf`; Esc or a click elsewhere closes the menu.

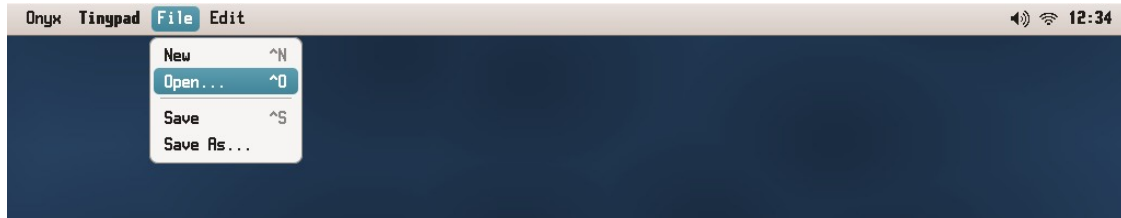


The volume

box, the Wi-Fi menu, the calendar of the month under the time.

The active application is the frontmost decorated window; clicking the dock or the desktop does not change it.

- **Click a menu title** to open its drop-down (the open title in the accent colour, the drop-down a light rounded panel); slide to another title to switch; click an item to run it (or press on a title and release on an item). Click the title again or anywhere else to close the menu.
- The first menu, **Onyx**, is always there: Terminal, **Control Panel**, File Viewer, Task Manager; then **the apps by category** — Productivity, Internet, Graphics, Games, Demos (and any other category an app declares; the `category` of its `app.txt`, "Other" without one) — each opening a sub-menu of its apps, by their friendly name (the `name` of `app.txt`), where a click launches the app, or brings it to the front if it is already running; then **Open Windows** (a sub-menu of the open apps of this workspace: a click brings one to the front — minimised ones too); then **Shut Down...** (a dialog: **Restart**, **Shut Down** — the SD card is unmounted, then "It is now safe to turn off the Raspberry Pi" — or **Cancel**). The list follows the card: an app added meanwhile (QBasic's **Make App**) is there the next time the menu opens. Not listed: the desktop's own parts (`category` = `Shell`), the settings (`Settings`: they are the Control Panel's applets) and the emulators (`Emulators`: reached through the **Game Library**, which starts the right one for a game).
- The next menu (the app's name) always has **Quit** (**Ctrl-Q**), like the close box.
- Items show their **keyboard shortcut** on the right (e.g. `^O` = Ctrl-O); the shortcuts work whether the menu is open or not.
- **Clipboard**: one system clipboard shared by all apps — Edit ► Cut/Copy/Paste in Writer (on the selection), tinypad (Copy All / Paste) and the File Viewer (files and folders).
- **Notifications**: apps (and the system, e.g. "Network — Connected. IP address ...") show a bubble in the top-right corner, below the bar; it fades in, stays about 4 s and fades out; a click dismisses it; several notifications are shown one after the other (`notifyd`, started by `autostart`).
- Windows open and are dragged **below** the bar, never under it; they open above the dock.



The menu

bar with tinypad active and its File menu open.

Applications with menus: **tinypad** (File), **Writer** (File, Edit, View, Insert, Format, Table, Tools), **Paint** (File, Edit, Image, Layers, View, Colours) and the **File Viewer** (File, Edit) — see §12.

The dock (dock)

The **dock** — CDE's Front Panel, modernised — stands at the bottom of the screen, centred (started by `autostart`); it stays above the windows, on every workspace, and a maximised window ends above it. In its middle, the workspaces and the lock / gear / power buttons; its other buttons — the drawers, the launchers, the Trash, in this order — are shared **evenly on the two sides** (the odd one out at the left): with the five drawers, the Terminal, the File Viewer and the Trash, four on each side.

- **The drawers** — by default **Productivity**, **Internet**, **Graphics**, **Games** and **Demos**: each shows the icon of its group's **main app** (the Text Editor, NetSurf, Paint, the Game Library, the Widget Showcase). **Click the icon** to start that app — or, if it runs, to bring it back to the front (a **minimised** one too). **Click the strip** on the dock's top edge above it to open the group's **drawer**: its apps with their icons, by name (in columns when there are many); click one to start it, or bring it back. Click the strip again, or anywhere else, to close the drawer. A **dot** under a launcher says

one of its apps has a window on this workspace; in the drawer, a dot beside each running app. Files dropped on a launcher are opened by its app. (As Xfce's launchers.)

- **Terminal** and **File Viewer** (the launchers after the drawers): a click starts it, or brings it back if it runs (dot).
- **The Trash** (right end): drop items on it (from the File Viewer) to move them to the Trash (SD:/.Trash); **click it to open the Trash in the File Viewer**. A sheet of paper sticks out when it holds something.
- **The workspaces** (in the middle): a small square each (4 by default), the current one lit, its windows drawn small in it. Click one to show that workspace (see *Workspaces* below). Beside them: the **lock** (the screen is locked: [lock](#) below), the **gear** (the **Control Panel**, §11) and the red **power** button (**Shut Down...**).

Rest the pointer on a launcher to see its name. **Right-click the dock: Panel Settings...** — the Control Panel's **Panel** applet, where the drawers (their group and main app: add, remove, reorder), the launchers after them and the workspaces (how many, their names) are set; kept in `SD:/etc/dock.ini`. The dock's colour is the theme's.



The dock:

four drawers, the middle (the four workspaces with their windows drawn small, the lock, the gear, the power button), the Demos drawer, the Terminal, the File Viewer, the Trash — and the Games drawer open (a dot: an app of it runs).

Workspaces (virtual desktops)

The desktop has **workspaces** (4 by default, 1 to 6: the Panel applet): each window belongs to one, and only the current workspace's windows are shown and handled — listed in **Open Windows**, brought back by the dock (an app whose window is on another workspace, started from the dock, opens a new window here). A window opens on the current workspace.

- **Switch:** click a workspace's square in the dock, or **Ctrl+Alt+←** / **Ctrl+Alt+→** (the previous / next one). **Ctrl+Alt+Shift+←/→** takes the window in front along.
- **Move a window:** its **window menu** (the title bar's left button) ► **Move to workspace**, or **On All Workspaces** (then shown on every one; **On This Workspace Only** undoes it).
- The menu bar, the dock, the notifications and the desktop's widgets are on every workspace.

The lock screen (`lock`, the dock's padlock): the whole screen shows the time, the date and the darkened wallpaper; a **click or a key** unlocks it — or, if `SD:/etc/lock.ini` sets a PIN (`pin = 1234`), typing the PIN then **Enter** (Backspace erases; a wrong PIN is said so).

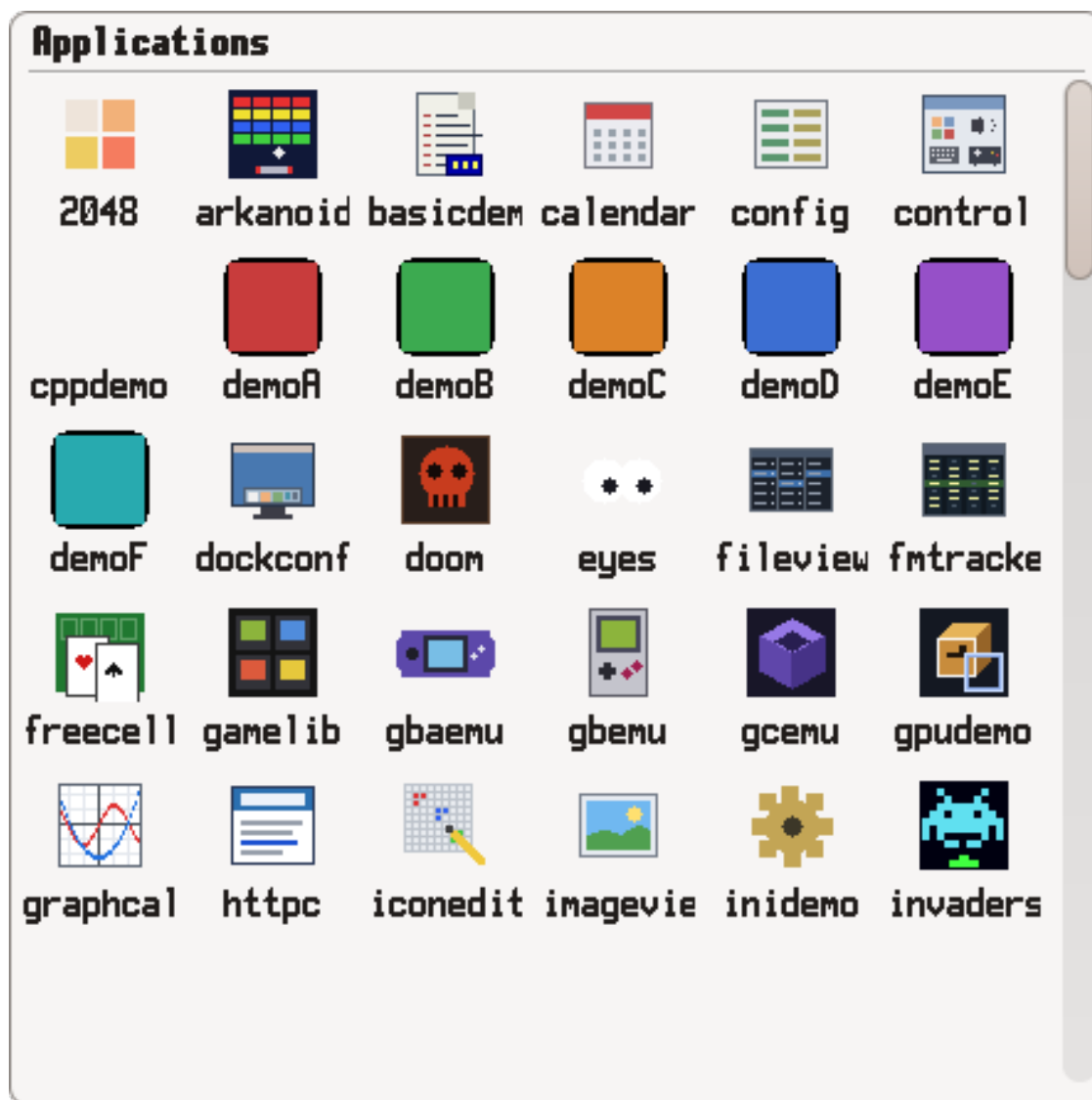
The panel (`panel`, no longer started)

A **borderless** bar, pinned to an edge of the screen (**right** with the shipped configuration; configurable via `SD:apps/panel.app/config.ini`, key `position`: 1=left, 2=top, 3=right, 4=bottom). It re-centers itself on its edge. It contains, in order:

- **The "apps" button** (9-square glyph): opens/closes the app list.
- **The quicklaunch:** the pinned icons listed in `SD:/etc/quicklaunch.txt` (by default: `terminal`, `fileviewer`, `tinypad`, `tinycalc`). A click **launches** the app (or **brings it to the foreground** if it is already open).
- **The taskbar:** the icons of the open apps (not pinned). A click **brings** the window to the foreground. System components (the panel itself, the app list, the menu bar, the notifications) are never listed: their window is created with `WIN_FLAG_SYSTEM`. An open app carries a small **badge** (triangle).
- **The clock:** updated every minute.

The app list (`applist`, no longer used)

Clicking the "apps" button opens a **square grid** (6 columns, alphabetical) of **all** the installed applications (any `SD:apps/<name>.app/` folder, except the shell components — those whose `app.txt` says `category = Shell`: `panel`, `applist`, `shell`, `menubar`, `notifyd`, `shelf`, `ask`, `agenda`). It opens **right next to the panel**, beside the "apps" button, on whichever edge the panel sits (its `config.ini position`), and below the menu bar. Click an icon to **launch** the app; the list then closes. Use the scrollbar (or the wheel) if the grid overflows.



The app

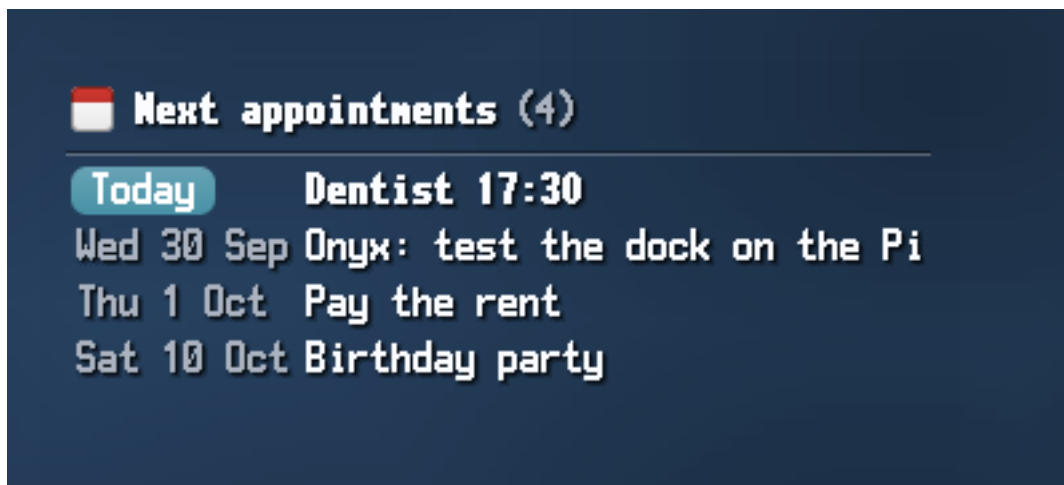
list (square, 6-column grid, opened beside the panel's "apps" button).

The Shelf (`shelf`, no longer started)

The former strip along the bottom of the screen: tabs of references to files, folders and apps (`SD:/etc/shelf.ini`). The dock no longer shows them (its middle holds the workspaces); `run shelf` brings the strip back.

The agenda widget (`agenda`)

The **next appointments**, straight on the wallpaper at the top left (started by `autostart`, under every window) — no card: its text and an etched line are part of the desktop, the ink chosen from the wallpaper under it (dark and engraved on a light wallpaper, white with a soft shadow on a dark one). The notes come from the **calendar** app (`agenda.txt`): today first (a **Today** mark in the accent colour), then by date. It re-reads them every few seconds, so a new note appears by itself. **Click** an appointment to open the calendar on that day; **drag the title** to move it (its place is kept in `SD:/apps/agenda.app/config.ini`).



The agenda

widget on a dark wallpaper.

Drag & drop and file associations

Files are dragged with the **left button**: press on an item, move a few pixels — a label follows the cursor. Hold **Ctrl** while dropping to **copy** instead of move (the label shows a +); **Esc** cancels. Drop targets: File Viewer columns and folders (and its sidebar's places), the dock's launchers (their app opens the files), the Trash, and document apps (tinypad, Writer, paint, Cardfile open the dropped file; dropped text goes in at the caret).

SD:/etc/fileassoc.ini says which app opens which file type — one `extension = app` per line (`txt = tinypad`, `png = imageview`, `docx = writer`, `card = cardfile`, ...): opening the file runs

`SD:apps/<app>.app/main <path>`. Used by the File Viewer (double-click) and the dock (files dropped on a launcher). Folders open in the File Viewer, `.app` bundles and programs run. Files that need a program to run are in **SD:/etc/runners.ini** (`extension = program`): `.bas` / `.bax` run in the BASIC runtime, `.gb` / `.gbc` in the Game Boy emulator.

Launching, closing, switching

- **Launch**: from the dock (a drawer's main app or one of its apps, the Terminal, the File Viewer), the menu bar's **Onyx** menu, the terminal (`run <name>`) or the file manager.
- **Switch**: click a window; or the dock (a running app's launcher brings it back) or the menu bar's **Onyx ► Open Windows**; another workspace: the dock's squares, `Ctrl+Alt+←/→`.
- **Close**: the `×` button of the title bar, **Ctrl-Q**, the window menu's **Close**, or the task manager (`taskman`) / `kill`.

6. Working with windows

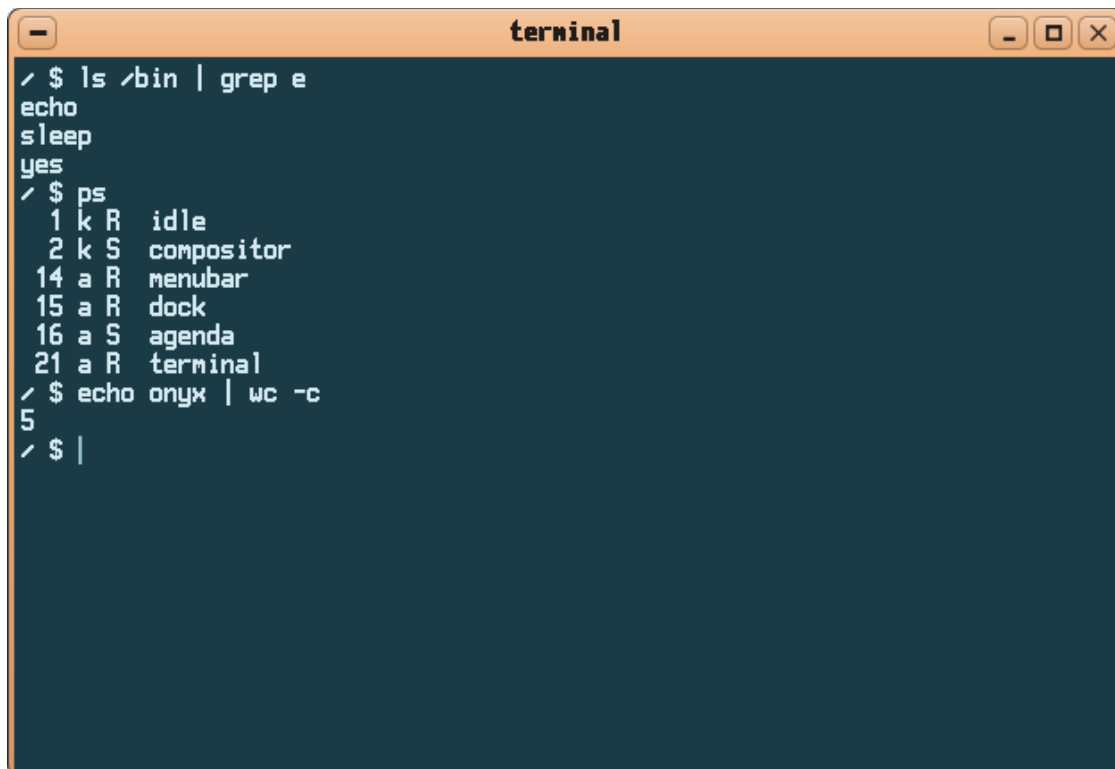
Each window has a **frame** in the theme's colour when it is in front (Peach by default), grey behind; rounded corners, a light gradient, a thin dark outline (the theme can make it black or remove it); no shadow. Its **title bar** holds:

- at the left, the **window menu** button (a bar): **Restore / Maximise, Minimise, Move to another workspace / On All Workspaces, Close** (`Ctrl-Q`) — greyed in the few apps that draw their whole window themselves (the calendar, IRC, most games, the emulators: their other buttons work);
- at the right, **minimise** (a short line): the window disappears — bring it back from the dock (its app's launcher or drawer), the menu bar's **Onyx ► Open Windows**, or by starting the app again;

- **maximise** (a square): the window fills the screen between the menu bar and the dock; the button then shows two squares (**restore**: back to its size and place). A **double click** on the title bar does the same. For the apps whose content flows to any size — **tinypad**, **Writer**, the **RTF Reader**, **QBasic**, the **terminal** and the **Game Library**; greyed for the others, whose layout has a fixed size (a game's board, the calculator);
- **close** (×).
- **Move**: drag the **title bar**.
- **Foreground / focus**: click inside a window — it comes to the top and becomes *active* (its frame in the theme's colour; the others grey).
- **Borderless** windows (the menu bar, the dock, the agenda, notifications, popups) cannot be moved or closed with the mouse: they are managed by the desktop or close themselves.
- **Mouse**: left-click, right-click (depending on the app — e.g. flag in Minesweeper, eraser in Paint) and **drag** (paint, move, drag a slider).

7. The terminal and the shell

Launch **terminal** (pinned to the panel by default). It is a console where you type commands, executed by **programs in SD:/bin/**.



```

terminal
/ $ ls /bin | grep e
echo
sleep
yes
/ $ ps
 1 k R   idle
 2 k S   compositor
14 a R   menubar
15 a R   dock
16 a S   agenda
21 a R   terminal
/ $ echo onyx | wc -c
5
/ $ |

```

The

terminal: a pipe (`ls /bin | grep e`), `ps`, and `echo zircon | wc -c`.

The prompt and the current working directory

- The prompt shows the **current working directory** followed by \$ (e.g. **SD:/** \$). The terminal has a **current working directory (cwd)**; **relative** paths given to commands are resolved against it.

- Type a command then press **Enter**. **Backspace** deletes the last character; **Page Up/Down** scroll through the output history (scrollback, 100 lines).

Built-in commands (builtins)

Three commands are executed by the terminal **itself** (they change its own state), not by a program in `/bin`:

Command	Effect
<code>cd [path]</code>	changes the current working directory (no argument: <code>SD:/</code>). The cwd is inherited by commands launched afterwards.
<code>pwd</code>	prints the current working directory.
<code>clear</code>	clears the screen (empties the scrollback).

Launching a program

Any other command `xxx` is resolved to `SD:/bin/xxx` and executed as a process; its **arguments**, if any, follow the name (`grep pattern`, `cp a b`). A command that cannot be found prints `xxx: command not found`. To launch a **graphical application** from the terminal, use `run <name>` (see §8).

Pipes and redirections

The terminal composes commands in the Unix style:

Syntax	Effect
<code>a b c</code>	pipe : the <code>stdout</code> of each stage feeds the <code>stdin</code> of the next (up to 6 stages).
<code>cmd > file</code>	redirects the <code>stdout</code> of the last stage to <code>file</code> (created / overwritten).
<code>cmd >> file</code>	same, but appends to the end of <code>file</code> .
<code>cmd < file</code>	the input (<code>stdin</code>) of the first stage comes from <code>file</code> .

Path resolution. Redirection files are resolved by the kernel **against the current working directory**: a relative path (`notes.txt`) targets `<cwd>/notes.txt`, an absolute path (`SD:/notes.txt`) is taken as-is.

Default input and output. Without `<`, the **first** stage reads what you **type**: each line confirmed with Enter is sent to its `stdin`, and **Ctrl-D** signals end of input (EOF). Without `>`, the **last** stage displays its output in the scrollback.

Examples (with the cwd being `SD:/` here):

```
pwd           # prints: SD:/
cd apps      # changes the current working directory (-> SD:/apps)
ls           # list the current working directory
ls /bin | grep e  # keep only the tools whose name contains "e"
cat SD:/notes.txt # display a file
```

```

echo bonjour > a.txt      # write "bonjour" to <cwd>/a.txt
echo encore >> a.txt      # append a line to a.txt
cat a.txt | wc            # count lines / words / bytes
grep pi < a.txt           # read a.txt, print only the lines containing "pi"
ps                         # list the processes
run mandelbrot            # launch a graphical application

```

Under the hood. The terminal splits the line on `|`, creates a memory pipe (pipe) between each stage — and a file stream for `</>` —, then launches (spawn) each `SD:/bin/<cmd>` with its (stdin, stdout) pair. The stages run **concurrently** (cooperatively); the terminal continuously drains the final output pipe (non-blocking read) and displays it, then waits for each process to finish. The details of streams and the process model are in [Kernel internals §9](#).

8. The /bin tools

Command-line programs shipped in `SD:/bin/`, executed by the terminal and **composable** via pipes (§7). The **relative** paths they receive are resolved against the terminal's **current working directory**.

Files and directories

Tool	Usage	Description
<code>ls</code>	<code>ls [path]</code>	Lists a directory (default: the current working directory). One entry per line; folders get a trailing <code>/</code> .
<code>cat</code>	<code>cat [file...]</code>	Prints the file(s) to <code>stdout</code> ; with no argument , copies <code>stdin</code> → <code>stdout</code> (useful at the end of a pipe).
<code>cp</code>	<code>cp <src> <dst></code>	Copies a file (by stream: any size).
<code>mv</code>	<code>mv <src> <dst></code>	Renames / moves a file or folder (same volume).
<code>rm</code>	<code>rm <path...></code>	Deletes files (or empty folders); accepts multiple paths.
<code>mkdir</code>	<code>mkdir <path...></code>	Creates one or more directories.
<code>touch</code>	<code>touch <path...></code>	Creates empty files if they do not exist (no timestamp).

Text and streams

Tool	Usage	Description
<code>echo</code>	<code>echo <text></code>	Writes its arguments

Tool	Usage	Description
		followed by a newline.
grep	grep <pattern>	Reads <code>stdin</code> , prints only the lines containing <pattern> (substring, case-sensitive ; only the first word is used as the pattern).
wc	wc	Counts and prints "lines words bytes" of <code>stdin</code> .
page	page	Copies <code>stdin</code> → <code>stdout</code> (the actual paging is the terminal's scrollbar via Page Up/Down); handy as the end of a pipe.

Processes, launching, keyboard

Tool	Usage	Description
ps	ps	Lists the processes in columns <code>PID K S</code> <code>PAGES MEM NAME</code> — <code>K: a</code> (app) / <code>k</code> (kernel); <code>S: R</code> (ready), <code>S</code> (sleeping), <code>B</code> (blocked), <code>N</code> (new); <code>PAGES</code> = 64 KB frames owned by the app, <code>MEM</code> = that in KB.
kill	kill <pid> [--force -f]	Terminates a process by PID (seen with <code>ps</code>). By default: clean shutdown (the app terminates itself); <code>--force/-f</code> : immediate stop. Kernel tasks and the terminal itself are protected.
run	run <app path> [args]	Launches an application : <code>run mandelbrot =</code> <code>SD:apps/mandelbrot.app/</code> <code>main</code> ; a name containing / is taken as an explicit ELF path ; the following arguments are passed as <code>argv</code> (e.g. <code>run tinypad</code> <code>SD:/notes.txt</code>).
keyb	keyb [XX]	With no argument: shows the current layout + the

Tool	Usage	Description
		list. <code>keyb FR</code> : switches to the layout (US, UK, DE, FR, BE, ES, IT, DV).

Networking and logs

Tool	Usage	Description
<code>net</code>	<code>net</code>	Shows the WLAN link status and the IPv4 address (or "link down" if Wi-Fi has not associated — check the firmware and <code>wpa_supplicant.conf</code>).
<code>ping</code>	<code>ping <host> [count]</code>	Sends ICMP echo requests (default 4, one per second, 2 s timeout) to a name or an IP and prints each round-trip time, then the loss and min / avg / max statistics. (Onyx itself also answers pings.)
<code>basic</code>	<code>basic [-d dir] <prog.bas> [args]</code>	The Onyx BASIC runtime (see §13): runs a program in the console or in its window; <code>-d</code> sets the current folder (default: the program's). A <code>.bas</code> path given to <code>run</code> or the shell runs through it.
<code>shutdown</code>	<code>shutdown, shutdown -r</code>	Ends the session like the Onyx menu's Shut Down... : unmounts the SD card (every pending write flushed), then halts — safe to switch the Raspberry Pi off once the green LED is dark; <code>-r</code> restarts instead. Works over telnet (the connection drops).
<code>reboot</code>	<code>reboot</code>	Restarts Onyx (= <code>shutdown -r</code>): unmounts the SD card, then restarts

Tool	Usage	Description
		the Raspberry Pi.
<code>fsbench</code>	<code>fsbench [big-file]</code>	Measures the SD card: reading a big file (default <code>SD:/doom/freedoom1.wad</code> , MB/s), opening every app's <code>app.txt</code> twice (the second time from the sector cache), listing <code>SD:/apps</code> twice, writing + reading back a 4 MB file (<code>SD:/fsbench.tmp</code> , removed after; its content is checked). Compare with <code>sdhs=1 / sdcache=0</code> in <code>cmdline.txt</code> .
<code>coretest</code>	<code>coretest, coretest exit</code>	Tests the app cores (cores 2 and 3, which an app can take for itself): the same computation on an app core and on the main core (their times), a job stopped cleanly, an endless job stopped by releasing the core, a job that crashes (reported in <code>kmsg</code> , the system stays up), both app cores at once. <code>coretest exit</code> leaves a job running and quits: Onyx must stop it by itself.
<code>tone</code>	<code>tone [Hz [ms [wave]]], tone scale</code>	Plays a note on the audio output (the 3.5 mm jack) — default 440 Hz, 500 ms, sine; wave <code>square</code> , <code>sine</code> , <code>triangle</code> , <code>saw</code> , <code>noise</code> ; <code>scale</code> plays a C major scale. Tests the sound system.
<code>v3dprog</code>	<code>v3dprog</code>	Checks the programmable GPU (kapi v61): draws small frames with shaders generated at run time — a colour from the

Tool	Usage	Description
		uniforms, varyings (two halves, a gradient, 12-float vertices), a texture, the scissor, blending, the colour write mask, the depth test, the near-plane clipping, 64 batches — then the GameCube's TEV as generated shaders (a MODULATE material and 8 random configurations of 1 to 16 stages and up to 8 texture lookups, checked against the CPU's reference) — and compares the pixels with the expected ones. One PASS / FAIL line a test (a failure shows the first wrong pixel and its expected colour), then ALL PASS: n/n and the time. Reads and writes no file.
hangtest	hangtest, hangtest irq	Freezes the Pi on purpose (core 0 stopped, IRQs masked; irq: a loop with them on), to check the crash report: about 10 s later the Pi restarts by itself and SD:/etc/lastcrash.txt tells what it was doing.
volume	volume, volume 0..10, volume mute / unmute / toggle	The master volume of all the sound (0 silent ... 10 full) and mute; without an argument, shows it. Kept in SD:/etc/sound.ini (applied at boot); the menu bar's speaker follows.
wifiscan	wifiscan	Lists the Wi-Fi access points around (about 3 s), strongest first: signal (dBm + bars), channel,

Tool	Usage	Description
		security (open / WEP / WPA / WPA2), SSID; * marks the network the Pi is on.
nslookup	nslookup <name>	Resolves a host name through the DNS server (shown on the first line) and prints its IPv4 address.
netstat	netstat	The network configuration (hostname, IP, mask, gateway, DNS, DHCP) and the open TCP sockets: state (LISTEN / ESTAB), local port, remote address, owning PID.
ftpd	ftpd [homedir] [user] [password]	The FTP server (see <i>File server</i> below); again while it runs = add a user.
ftp	ftp [host [port]]	Interactive FTP / FTPS client (ftp> prompt): open [-s] host [port] (asks user + password; -s = FTPS), user, ls / dir, cd, cdup, pwd, get remote [local], put local [remote], mget / mput, delete, mkdir, rmdir, rename, size, lcd / lpwd (the local folder), close, bye. Works through ftpfs (shares its connections and logins with the File Viewer). The password is echoed by the terminal.
ftpfs	ftpfs login <host> <user> <password> [save], ftpfs forget <host>	The FTP / FTPS client behind FTP: / FTPS: paths (see <i>FTP / FTPS servers as folders</i>); starts by itself; login registers credentials for a host (save = remember them in SD:/etc/ftpfs.ini); forget removes a remembered login.

Tool	Usage	Description
whois	whois <domain> [server]	Queries the WHOIS database (TCP port 43): asks <code>whois.iana.org</code> , then follows its <code>refer:</code> to the registry holding the domain — or asks the given server directly.
wget	wget <url>	Fetches an HTTP URL (<code>http://host[:port]/path</code>) and writes the response body to <code>stdout</code> — pipe or redirect it (e.g. <code>wget http://example.com/ > page.html</code>). Plain HTTP only (no HTTPS).
httpget	httpget <url>	HTTP/1.1 client demo built on the reusable <code>HttpClient</code> class (<code>user/http.hpp</code>): prints the status line, <code>Content-Type</code> , and body. Handles chunked responses. Plain HTTP only (<code>https://</code> → "not supported").
httpsget	httpsget <url>	Same as <code>httpget</code> but with TLS (<code>https://</code>), via <code>mbedtls</code> (<code>user/tls/</code>) — downloads real HTTPS pages. Opt-in build (needs the cross-built <code>mbedtls</code> — see <code>user/tls/README.md</code>). Not yet secure : no certificate verification, software (non-HW) RNG.
groq	groq <question...>, groq -j < messages.json, -c <config>	Asks a large language model through the Groq chat API (HTTPS) and prints the answer — the engine behind Lisa . Reads <code>SD:/apps/lisa.app/config.ini</code> (<code>key</code> = your Groq API key, <code>model</code> , <code>role</code> = the system prompt, <code>temperature</code> , <code>max_tokens</code>).

Tool	Usage	Description
		<code>-j</code> : stdin is a JSON array of <code>{"role", "content"}</code> messages (a whole conversation). Non-ASCII text is converted between Latin-1 and UTF-8.
<code>telnetd</code>	<code>telnetd [port]</code>	Remote text shell (default port 23): waits for Wi-Fi, then serves up to 8 clients at once , each in a thread of its own with its own <code>cmd</code> (see §7) — a session stuck on a command does not hold the others up (one at a time on a kernel older than v67). Started at boot by <code>SD:/etc/autostart</code> . No password, no encryption — trusted LAN only. See <i>Remote shell</i> below.
<code>rdpd</code>	<code>rdpd [port]</code>	Remote windows (port 3390): the Onyx windows shown one by one on a Windows PC by <code>OnyxRemote.exe</code> (pc/dist). Started at boot by <code>SD:/etc/autostart</code> . No password, no encryption . See <i>Remote windows on a PC</i> below.
<code>vncd</code>	<code>vncd [port]</code>	Remote desktop (VNC, default port 5900): see and drive the Onyx screen from any VNC viewer. Started at boot by <code>SD:/etc/autostart</code> . No password, no encryption — trusted LAN only. See <i>Remote desktop</i> below.
<code>notifytest</code>	<code>notifytest [-t <title>] <message></code>	Sends a notification (bubble under the menu bar) — handy to test

Tool	Usage	Description
		<code>notifyd</code> from the terminal or telnet, e.g. <code>notifytest -t Build "Kernel staged"</code> . The title defaults to "Test".
<code>kmsg</code>	<code>kmsg</code>	Streams the kernel log live (boot messages, app lifecycle when <code>verbose</code> is on, network events, <code>stall:</code> lines when a task kept the CPU more than 100 ms). Ctrl-C to quit.
<code>verbose</code>	<code>verbose [on off]</code>	Shows or toggles the kernel's verbose logging (app start/stop/kill); persists the choice to <code>SD:system.ini</code> .
<code>heaptest</code>	<code>heaptest</code>	Self-test of the user-space allocator (<code>umm.h</code> over <code>kapi_sbrk</code>): alloc/verify/free across size classes + realloc. Prints PASS/FAIL and how much heap it mapped.
<code>threadtest</code>	<code>threadtest</code>	Self-test of the threads (kernel v67): threads created and joined with their exit codes, a counter shared under a mutex, the allocator used by four threads at once, a manual- and an auto-reset event, a barrier, timeouts, the limit of 32 threads per process, and a worker whose results are posted to the main thread while it waits for events. One line per check, then PASS/FAIL. It quits with a thread still running: the prompt must come back anyway (the threads end with the process). Takes a few

Tool	Usage	Description
		seconds.
<code>libctest</code>	<code>libctest</code>	Self-test of the newlib C library on Onyx (<code>printf/malloc/qsort/fopen+fseek/sin/sqrt</code>). Prints PASS/FAIL.
<code>imgtest</code>	<code>imgtest</code>	Self-test of the image codecs (zlib + libpng): decodes an embedded PNG and prints its size and top-left pixel. Prints PASS/FAIL. Opt-in build (needs the cross-built codecs — see user/img/README.md).
<code>nsfbdemo</code>	<code>nsfbdemo</code>	Demo of the NetSurf framebuffer library (libnsfb) on Onyx: opens a window and draws shapes with libnsfb's plotters, then follows the cursor (a trail of dots) and drops a marker on left-click. <code>q</code> / Esc or the close box to quit. Opt-in build (needs the cross-built libnsfb — see user/nsfb/README.md).

Remote shell (`telnetd`)

`telnetd` (started by `SD:/etc/autostart`) lets you use the Onyx shell from another computer, in a text terminal. Get the Pi's address with `net`, then connect with:

- **the dedicated client** (only needs Python, Windows or Linux/macOS): `python tools/onyx-telnet.py <pi-ip> [port]`;
- or any **telnet client**: `telnet <pi-ip>`, or PuTTY with *Connection type: Telnet*.

Each connection gets its own `cmd`, exactly like the terminal app: same commands, pipes and redirections, `clear` clears the remote screen. Echo and line editing are done by the Pi (Backspace works; no history/arrows). **Ctrl-C** is passed to the running command, **exit** or **Ctrl-D** on an empty line ends the session (in `onyx-telnet.py`, **Ctrl-J** disconnects locally). One client at a time: a second connection waits until the first ends.

⚠ Not secure: no authentication and no encryption — anyone who can reach port 23 gets a shell. Remove the `telnetd` line from `SD:/etc/autostart` on an untrusted network, or run it by hand (`telnetd 2323`) when needed.

Remote windows on a PC (rdpd + Onyx Remote)

rdpd (started by SD:/etc/autostart, port **3390**) serves the Onyx windows one by one to **Onyx Remote** (OnyxRemote.exe in pc/dist/, .NET Framework 4.8 — already on Windows 10 / 11): **one window** on the PC holding the Onyx session. Type the Pi's address in its tool bar, **Connect**. Below the tool bar, the **Pi's screen at its size**, pixel for pixel (the Onyx windows, the dock at the bottom, where they are on the Pi), in a scrolling area: connected, the window takes that size as far as the PC's screen allows; smaller (or made smaller), **scroll bars** show the rest; bigger, the Pi's screen sits in its middle, black around it. **Full screen** (the tool bar's button, or **F11** at any time) takes the whole PC screen without a frame nor the tool bar: the Onyx menu bar at the top, the Onyx windows pixel for pixel where they are on the Pi — a Pi screen the size of the PC's (e.g. both 1920 × 1080) fills it exactly (a smaller one sits in the middle, black around it; a bigger one scrolls). The pointer on the screen's **top edge** shows a bar there, as Windows' Remote Desktop: the Pi's name, **Pin** (the bar stays), **Minimise**, **Leave full screen**, **Disconnect**. F11 again (or a lost connection) gives the window back; the choice is kept and applied at the next connection.

- At the top of the Pi's screen, the **Onyx menu bar**.
- Each Onyx window is a **child window** of the Pi's screen in Onyx Remote, where it is on the Pi: a normal window (its title, its close button) showing the Onyx window's content — or, with **Onyx frames**, with the frame drawn by Onyx (its rounded corners; its title buttons: close closes the app, the window menu, minimise and maximise are pressed on the Pi). Move it by its title bar inside Onyx Remote (the Pi's window stays where it is; moved or maximised on the Pi, it follows); its close button (or Alt+F4) closes the Onyx app; clicking a window brings it to the front on the Pi too, so it gets the keyboard. The keys are typed with the PC's layout. A minimised window, or one on another workspace, is not shown (as on the Pi).
- **Over the windows, see-through as on the Pi**: the menu bar's menus (and its volume box and calendar), the **dock** and its drawers, the **notifications**, the Wi-Fi menu — the parts of them that are clear on the Pi are clear here too (the windows below show), and a click on a clear part goes to what is below.
- **Desktop** shows the Onyx desktop (the wallpaper, the widgets under the windows) behind the windows; a click there goes to the desktop. Without it, the pointer's moves still reach the Pi (the **eyes** follow it).
- Faster than VNC: only the windows that change are sent, only their changed parts, compressed with LZ4; moving or overlapping windows costs nothing. **16-bit colours** halves the data (a game in a big window; the see-through windows and the frames stay in 32 bits). The tool bar shows the updates a second; it says when the Pi's kernel is too old for rdpd (copy the new `kernel18-rpi4.img`).
- **Console** opens a **telnet console** on the Pi in a window of its own (the Onyx shell served by `telnetd`, port 23 — type `address:port` in the address box for another port; it works without Connect): the output in a text box you can **scroll, select and copy** (right click: Copy, Select All, Clear, Save As...), the command typed in the line below — **Enter** sends it, **Up / Down** recall the previous ones, **Esc** clears the line, **Ctrl+C** (nothing selected) or the **Ctrl+C** button interrupts the running command; `clear` clears the text. **Reconnect** after the Pi restarted.
- One PC at a time. **No password and no encryption**: trusted LAN only (remove the `rdpd` line from SD:/etc/autostart otherwise).

Remote desktop (vncd)

`vncd` (started by `SD:/etc/autostart`) serves the Onyx screen over **VNC**, so you can see and use the desktop from another computer — handy without a monitor. Use any VNC viewer (TigerVNC, RealVNC, UltraVNC, TightVNC, Remmina...) and connect to `<pi-ip>` (port 5900 / display `:0`); choose "no authentication" if the viewer asks.

- The mouse and keyboard act exactly like USB ones (clicks, drag, wheel). Keys are typed with **your computer's layout** (the viewer sends characters); Ctrl+letter, arrows, Home/End, Page Up/Down, Delete, Esc and Enter work.
- Only the parts of the screen that change are sent (64×64 tiles, zlib-compressed when the viewer supports it), up to ~20 updates per second — fewer when the whole screen keeps changing (a game): the next update waits twice as long as the last one took, so VNC never takes more than about a third of the core the apps share.
- One viewer at a time. The picture is what the compositor shows, cursor included.

⚠ Not secure: no password and no encryption. Remove the `vncd` line from `SD:/etc/autostart` on an untrusted network.

File server (ftpd)

`ftpd [homedir] [user] [password]` starts the **FTP server** (port 21) — handy to copy files to the card from a PC (FileZilla, WinSCP, `ftp`, a file manager's `ftp://<pi-ip>`). Defaults: `SD:/`, user `onyx`, password `onyx`. There is **no configuration file**:

- The first `ftpd` becomes the server. Running `ftpd` **again** while it is up does not start a second one — it tells the running server "this user, this password, this root folder" and exits, so you add users on the fly (e.g. `ftpd SD:/apps dev secret`).
- A user sees only its root folder (`/` = `homedir`; `..` cannot climb above it).
- Several clients can be connected at once (each connection is served by its own process).
- Passive (PASV / EPSV) and active (PORT) modes; listing, download, upload (≤ 32 MB per file), resume-less append (APPE), delete, rename, create / remove folders.
- Add `ftpd SD:/ me mypassword` to `SD:/etc/autostart` to have it at every boot.

⚠ Plain FTP: the password and the files travel unencrypted — keep it on a trusted network.

FTP / FTPS servers as folders (ftpfs)

Remote FTP servers can be used **like folders of the card**, from every app: paths

<code>FTP:[user[:password]]@host[:port]/path</code>	plain FTP
<code>FTPS:[user[:password]]@host[:port]/path</code>	FTP over TLS (explicit AUTH TLS on 21, implicit on 990)

- In the **File Viewer: Go ► Connect to Server...** opens a form — **FTP** or **FTPS (TLS)**, **server** (name or IP) and **port**, **user** (empty = anonymous), **password** (masked), start **folder**, **Remember password** (checked by default); **Tab** moves between fields, **Enter** (in the password or folder field) connects. The **server** field is a combo box: type a new server, or click its arrow (or press **Down / Up**) to pick a remembered one — protocol, port, user, password and folder are then filled in. **Forget** removes the selected server's remembered login (so does connecting to it with *Remember password* unchecked). The login is handed to `ftpfs` (never put into the path, so the shelf and the path bar never show it). Or run `fileviewer FTP:host/dir`. Then browse, preview

(files ≤ 1 MB), open (double-click — tinypad, Image Viewer...), drag files between the card and the server (a move across them = copy + delete), new folder, rename, delete.

- **tinypad / Writer / paint** open and **save** **FTP:** files directly; the dock's **shelf** keeps them.
- **Logins:** in the path (**FTP:me:secret@host/...**), or once per host with `ftpfs login <host> <user> <password> [save]`; otherwise `anonymous`. A login is kept in memory by the running `ftpfs` (one per server); with **Remember password** (or `save`) it is also written to `SD:/etc/ftpfs.ini` (one line per server: host, user, password, port, FTPS, folder) and reloaded at every start, so FTP and FTPS folders (and the File Viewer's Network places) work again after a reboot. `ftpfs forget <host>` removes it. The file can also be written by hand, one section per server: `[ftp.example.com]` then `user = me, password = secret (plain), port = 21, tls = 1, folder = /www` (`ftpfs` rewrites it in its own format when a login changes). The password in that file is only **obfuscated, not encrypted**: anyone with the card can recover it (the file is excluded from git).
- `ftpfs` starts by itself the first time an **FTP:** path is used. A file is downloaded whole when it is opened (≤ 64 MB) and uploaded whole when saved.
- FTPS encrypts the connection, but the server certificate is **not verified** yet (no CA bundle on the card — like `httpsget`).

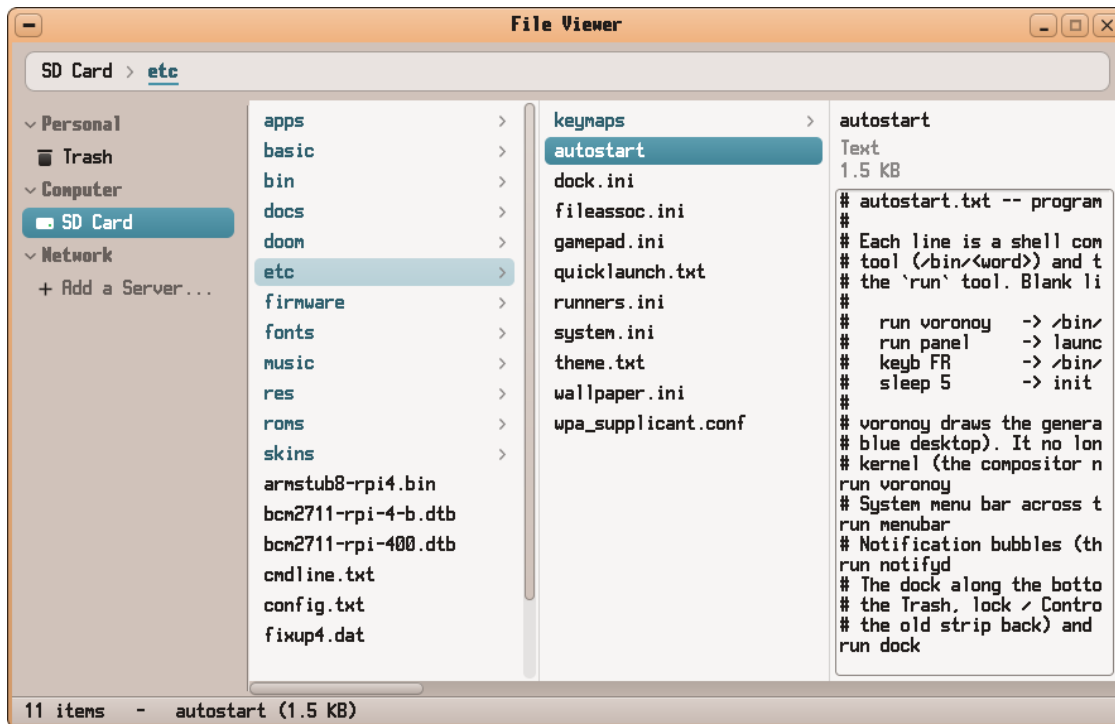
9. The file manager

File Viewer (column browser)

fileviewer (the File Viewer: the dock's launcher, the **Onyx** menu) is a NeXTSTEP-style **column browser**: each column lists one folder, and selecting a folder opens its content in the next column — the whole path stays visible, so going back is one click on an earlier column. `run fileviewer SD:/some/folder` opens a given folder (`run fileviewer trash`: the Trash — the dock's Trash does so).

- **The sidebar** (the places, on the left, in the window's colour), in three groups — click a group's title to fold or unfold it (kept):
 - **Personal:** the folders **pinned** there, each under a **name of its own** — a folder's right-click menu ► **Pin to Sidebar...**, or **Go ► Pin This Folder...** (**Ctrl-D**), asks the name —, and the **Trash**;
 - **Computer:** the SD card's partitions (`SD:`, and `SD1: ... SD3:` when present; the disk images `VD0: ...` to come);
 - **Network:** the servers connected once (**Go ► Connect to Server...**, under the name given in its **Name** field — the address when empty): a click **connects again** (the login kept by `ftpfs`, "Remember password") and opens its folder; and **Add a Server...**. Right-click a place: **Open / Connect, Rename...**, **Unpin / Forget** (the Trash: **Empty Trash...**). Files dropped on a pinned folder, the Trash or a volume go there (the place outlined). Kept in `SD:/etc/places.ini` (`pin = name|path, net = name|FTP:host/folder, folded = ...`).
- **Columns:** plain folders first (blue, with a ► arrow), then app bundles (`.app`, green, shown by their **friendly name** — the `name` = line of their `app.txt`, e.g. `demoB.app` shows as *Colour Field*; the folder name without `.app` if there is none) and files, sorted alphabetically by what is shown, with room round the names. When there are more columns than fit (3), the view follows the deepest one; the scrollbar below the columns scrolls back.
- **Path bar** (above the columns, as elementary OS's): the folders of the path as links — underlined under the pointer, the current one in the accent colour; click one to jump straight back to that folder.

- **Preview column:** selecting a file shows its size and type, the first lines of a text file, a scaled-down **image** (BMP, GIF, PNG, JPEG, PCX, WebP — with its format and dimensions), or — for an app bundle — its icon, its friendly name and its folder name (`demoB.app`).
- **Mouse:** click = select; **double-click** = open (a file in the app `SD:/etc/fileassoc.ini` associates with its extension, programs run, `.app` bundles launch); **wheel** scrolls the column under the cursor. A column longer than the window gets its own **vertical scrollbar** at its right edge: drag the thumb, or click the track to jump.
- **Keyboard:** ↑/↓, Page Up/Down, Home/End move in the active column; → enters the selected folder, ← or **Backspace** goes back; **Enter** opens; typing a **letter** jumps to the next name (as shown) starting with it.
- **Trash:** **Del** (File ► Move to Trash) moves the selection to the Trash (`SD:/.Trash`, hidden) — nothing is lost. **Go ► Trash** shows it (the path bar reads "Trash"): select an item, **Go ► Restore from Trash** puts it back where it was (its folder is recreated if needed; a clash gets a "(restored)" name), **Del** there deletes it for good; **Go ► Empty Trash...** deletes everything; **Go ► SD Card** (or the sidebar) returns to the card, **Go ► SD1: (partition 2)** ... to the card's other FAT / exFAT partitions (listed when present; a move between two volumes is a copy then a delete; the Trash is on `SD:`, so an item of another volume is deleted with File ► Delete Permanently...). **File ► Delete Permanently...** skips the Trash (with confirmation). Names starting with `.` are hidden. (`rm` in the terminal still deletes for real.)
- **Operations** (menu bar: **File** and **Edit** menus, on the active column's selection): **New Folder** (Ctrl-N), **Rename** (Ctrl-R), **Copy** (Ctrl-C), **Cut** (Ctrl-X), **Paste** (Ctrl-V — into the active column's folder; copies of folders are recursive, a clash gets a "copy" name), **Refresh** (Ctrl-L). The status bar shows the item count and the selection.
- **Drag & drop:** drag an item (press, move a few pixels) onto a folder — a folder row, or anywhere in a column for that column's folder (the target is outlined) — to **move** it there; hold **Ctrl** to **copy**. Works between File Viewer windows, onto the sidebar's places, onto the dock's Trash, and in the Trash view (a drop there moves to the Trash). Dropping a file on an app window (tinypad, Writer, paint) opens it there, on a dock launcher its app opens it.



The File

Viewer: the sidebar (Personal, Computer, Network), **SD:** ► **etc** in the path bar, one folder per column, and the preview of the selected **autostart** file.

10. Keyboard and layouts

The layout at boot is set by the autostart line **keyb FR** (in **SD:/etc/autostart**) — the kernel no longer reads **keymap=** from **cmdline.txt**. **keyb** records the layout in a persistent kernel snapshot and the kernel installs it on the keyboard the moment it enumerates, so **keyb** needs **not** wait for USB — the layout is applied however late the keyboard appears. (This removed a boot race where **keyb** could time out before the keyboard enumerated and leave it with **no** map at all — a dead keyboard while the mouse worked.) To change it **on the fly**:

- **At the command line:** **keyb FR** (or **US**, **UK**, **DE**, **BE**, **ES**, **IT**, **DV**). **keyb** alone shows the current layout and the list.
- **Graphically:** the Control Panel's **Keyboard & Mouse** applet (**keyconf**) lists the **.kmap** files actually present in **SD:/etc/keymaps/**; a click takes one at once **and keeps it** (it rewrites the **keyb** line of **SD:/etc/autostart**); a field to try it.
- **Permanently:** edit the **keyb** line in **SD:/etc/autostart** (or use the applet).

The layouts themselves live as files in **SD:/etc/keymaps/** — **BE.kmap**, **DE.kmap**, **DV.kmap**, **ES.kmap**, **FR.kmap**, **IT.kmap**, **UK.kmap**, **US.kmap** (small binary tables). The Belgian (**BE**) map is an **azerty** layout close to French, with the Belgian standard for the digit row and several **AltGr** symbols (**!** on **8**, **= +** on the bottom-right key, **- _** right of **)**, and **| @ #** on **1 2 3**, **{ }** on **9 0**, **[]** on the **^/\$** keys). **keyb XX** loads **XX.kmap** and hands it to the kernel, which copies it onto the live keyboard. **The kernel itself ships no keyboard map** — layouts are *only* these files, so the keyboard has no mapping until **keyb** has run (a second or two into boot), and deleting the **keymaps** folder would leave it unmapped. **Adding a layout never needs a kernel rebuild:** drop a new **<NAME>.kmap** in that folder (regenerate them, or seed a custom one, with **tools/keymaps/genkeymaps.py**) and use **keyb <NAME>** — it also shows up in the Keyboard & Mouse applet.

Accented letters (é è à ç û..., the Latin-1 characters of the layout) can be typed in every text field and editor. The **euro sign** is **AltGr+E** (FR, BE, DE, ES, IT), AltGr+4 (UK), AltGr+5 (US); it is a key of its own (Windows' code 0x80, not Latin-1): the Spreadsheet takes it (12,50 €), the other apps' text fields do not yet.

11. The Control Panel and the appearance

The Control Panel (control)

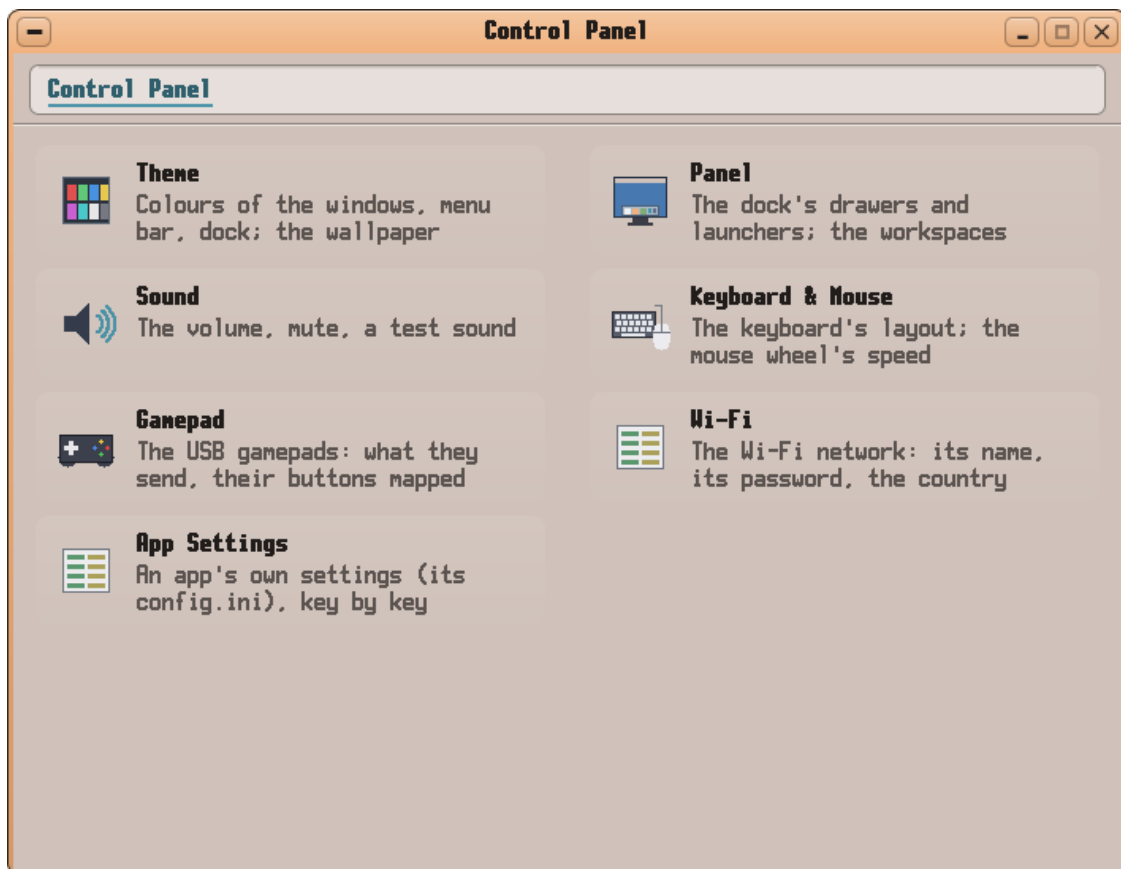
The system's settings are gathered in one window, as Windows' Control Panel: the **Control Panel** (the menu bar's **Onyx ► Control Panel**, just below Terminal, or the dock's **gear**). Its home lists the **applets**, an icon, a name and a line of help each; **click one** to open it **inside the Control Panel's window**. The path bar at the top reads *Control Panel ► Theme...*: click **Control Panel** (or the menu's **All Settings**) to go back to the list. One Control Panel at a time (started again, it brings the open one to the front).

Applet	What it sets
Theme (theme)	The desktop's colours and wallpaper, with a preview (below).
Display (displayconf)	The screen's resolution : pick a size in the list (1024 × 768 ... 2560 × 1440, 4:3, 16:9, 16:10...), Apply (or a double click): the screen changes at once — the menu bar, the dock and the notifications follow it, a maximised window fills the new screen, a window too big for it is shrunk into it, the wallpaper is painted again — and it is kept in SD:/cmdline.txt (width= / height=) for the next start. Not while an app has the full screen. The monitor shows any size (the Pi scales the picture to it); its own resolution is the sharpest.
Panel (dockconf)	The dock: its drawers (left to right: each a group of apps — the category of their app.txt — and its main app , whose icon the drawer shows; Add / Remove / move them, pick the group and the main app in the lists beside), the launchers after them (the Terminal, the File Viewer...: add any app, remove, move), the workspaces (how many, 1 to 6, and their names). Apply writes SD:/etc/dock.ini; the dock takes it at once.
Sound (soundconf)	The master volume (0–10) and Mute , applied at once to everything played and kept in SD:/etc/sound.ini (the menu bar's speaker changes the same

Applet	What it sets
	volume); Play a test sound.
Keyboard & Mouse (<code>keyconf</code>)	The keyboard layout (the maps of <code>SD:/etc/keymaps</code> : a click takes one at once and keeps it in <code>SD:/etc/autostart</code> 's <code>keyb</code> line; a field to try it) and the wheel 's speed (lines a notch: at once, kept in <code>SD:/etc/theme.txt</code>).
Gamepad (<code>padconf</code>)	The USB gamepads (§12).
Wi-Fi (<code>wpaconf</code>)	The known networks and their passwords (§12).
App Settings (<code>config</code>)	An app's own settings, its <code>SD:/apps/<name>.app/config.ini</code> : the apps (those with settings first, marked *), then the chosen one's <code>key = value</code> lines — pick one, change its key or its value, Set (Enter; a new key adds a line), Delete ; Save writes the file (the app reads it when it starts again), Reload .

Each applet also runs **alone**, in a window of its own (`run theme`, `run keyconf`...). The list is made of **link files** in `SD:/apps/control.app/applets/` (sorted by their names: `10-theme.lnk`, `20-dockconf.lnk`...), four lines each — add one to add an applet:

```
name    = Theme                # the title shown
icon    = SD:/apps/theme.app/icon.bmp  # a 40 x 40 BMP (magenta: see-through)
target  = theme                # the applet: an app (SD:/apps/<name>.app)
text    = Colours of the windows, the menu bar, the dock; the wallpaper
```



The

Control Panel's home: the applets.

The Theme applet (theme)

The desktop's look is a **modernised CDE**; the **Theme** applet sets its colours, as Windows 98's Display Properties. On the left a **preview** of a desktop (320 × 240): the wallpaper, the menu bar, a window behind, a window in front with a button, a text field, a selection and a check, the dock — drawn in the colours being edited.

- **Click a part of the preview** (or pick it in **Item**) and give it a colour: one of the **palette's**, or any colour (**Custom...**: red, green, blue sliders and the colour). The parts: the **frame of the window in front** and of the **windows behind**, the **windows' content** (the apps' face, their background), the **buttons**, the **text fields and lists**, the **selection** (focus, checks, the open menu), the **menu bar**, the **dock**, the **desktop**. The buttons, the fields and the menu bar may follow the window's colour (**Automatic**).
- **Scheme**: the named colours of the window in front — **Peach** (the default), **Steel**, **Sage**, **Brick**, **Slate**; every shade of a frame (its gradient, its buttons, its edge) is computed from its one colour, and the title's ink (dark or white) from its brightness.
- **Outline**: the frames' 1-px outline — **None**, **Dark** (the default) or **Black**.
- **Desktop**: the **wallpaper** — **Voronoi cells** (their colour and number), a **Gradient** (two colours, top to bottom or left to right), **Bubbles** (a gradient with soft bubbles), a **Solid colour**, a **Picture** (a BMP, GIF, PNG, JPEG, PCX or WebP file: **Browse...**; **cover** the screen or **tile** it; **Tinted**: its grey multiplies the **Tint** colour — checked by itself for a picture of `SD:/wallpapers`), or a **Pattern**: one of the abstract grey pictures of `SD:/wallpapers` (Bokeh, Contours, Dunes, Facets, Hexagons, Low Poly, Silk, Waves) **coloured by the two colours** — its grey multiplies the gradient from colour 1

to colour 2 (white is the colour itself), so any pattern takes any colours; the preview shows it at once.

Apply writes `SD:/etc/theme.txt` and `SD:/etc/wallpaper.ini`, paints the wallpaper again and gives the menu bar, the dock and the agenda the new colours at once; the apps opened from then on take them (the ones already open keep theirs until they are opened again). **Discard** reloads what is saved.



The

Theme applet: the preview (click a part to pick it), its colour from the palette, the scheme and the outline, the wallpaper (here the Hexagons pattern in two blues).

Manual theme editing

`SD:/etc/theme.txt`, read by every app when it starts (0xRRGGBB colours):

```
theme      = Peach      # the frame in front: Peach, Steel, Sage, Brick, Slate
active     = 0xF0B07A    # ... or any colour instead (overrides theme)
inactive   = 0xACACB0    # the frames behind
window     = 0xD0C2BA    # the windows' content: the apps' face ("face" is still read)
button     = 0xD0C2BA    # the buttons (default: the window's)
field      = 0xF6F3F1    # the text fields and lists (default: from the window's)
accent     = 0x4992A7    # focus, selection, checks
outline    = dark        # the frames' outline: none, dark, black
menubar    = 0xD0C2BA    # the menu bar (default: the window's)
dock       = 0xA4BACE    # the dock's face
wheelspeed=2             # lines a wheel notch (read by the kernel at boot)
```

Nothing is a bitmap: the frames, buttons and controls are drawn by code from these colours.

Startup and pinned apps

- **SD:/etc/autostart:** one **shell command** per line, run at boot by `init` exactly as if typed in the terminal — the first word is a `/bin` tool (`/bin/<word>`) and the rest are its arguments; blank lines and `#` comments are ignored; the `sleep <seconds>` line (an `init` builtin) waits before the next line, to stagger the startup. Launch a **desktop app** with the `run` tool (`run <name> → /apps/<name>.app/main`). Defaults: `run voronoy`, `run menubar`, `run notifyd`, `run dock`, `run agenda`, `keyb FR` (sets the keyboard layout at boot) `telnetd` (remote shell) and `vncd` (remote desktop) — see §8. Which program plays the `init` role is itself set by `init=` in `cmdline.txt` (see §3).
- **SD:/etc/quicklaunch.txt:** the apps pinned to the (former) panel (top→bottom).

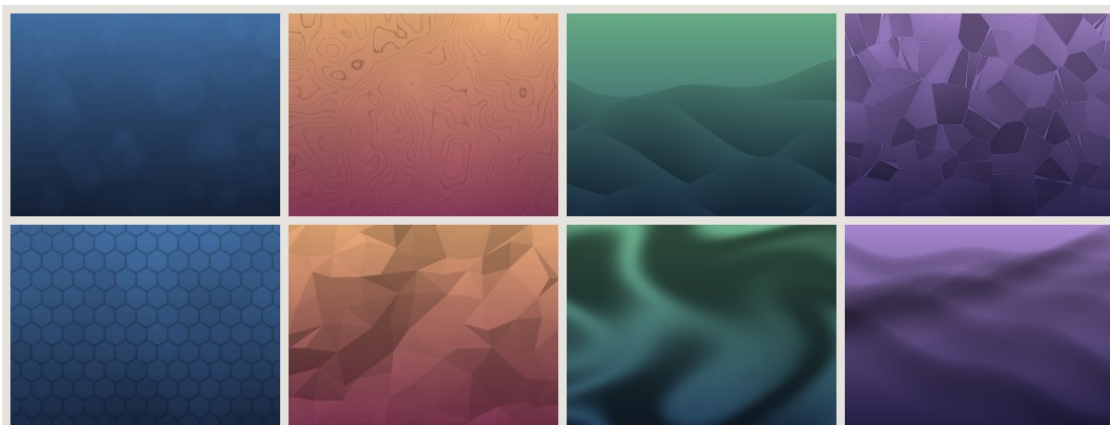
Wallpaper

At boot, `voronoy` paints the wallpaper in the shared background buffer, as **SD:/etc/wallpaper.ini** says (the Theme applet writes it):

```
mode      = voronoi      # voronoi, gradient, bubbles, solid, image or pattern
color     = 0x4878B0     # voronoi's colour, the solid one, the gradient's first
color2    = 0x1C2C48     # the gradient's second (gradient, bubbles)
direction = vertical     # the gradient: vertical or horizontal
points    = 28           # voronoi's cells (1..64)
image     = SD:/x.jpg    # image: the picture (painted by imageview --background)
style     = cover        # cover (the screen filled) or tile
tint      = no           # image: yes -- its grey multiplies `color` (a tinted picture)
pattern   = SD:/wallpapers/waves.png # pattern: the grey picture the colours multiply
```

Without the file, `SD:/apps/voronoy.app/config.ini`'s colour and cells. The wallpaper persists after `voronoy` exits.

The patterns (`mode = pattern`, `pattern = SD:/wallpapers/<name>.png`): grey pictures of 1024 × 768, light for the most part, that `voronoy` colours — each pixel's grey multiplies the gradient of `color` and `color2` (in `direction`); a screen of another size gets the picture scaled to cover it. Eight ship with Onyx, made by code (`tools/gen_wallpapers.py`); **any grey picture put in SD:/wallpapers** (PNG, JPEG, BMP...) appears in the Theme applet's list.



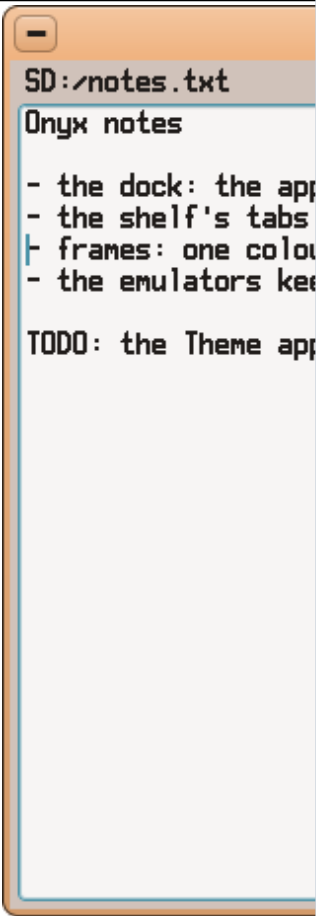
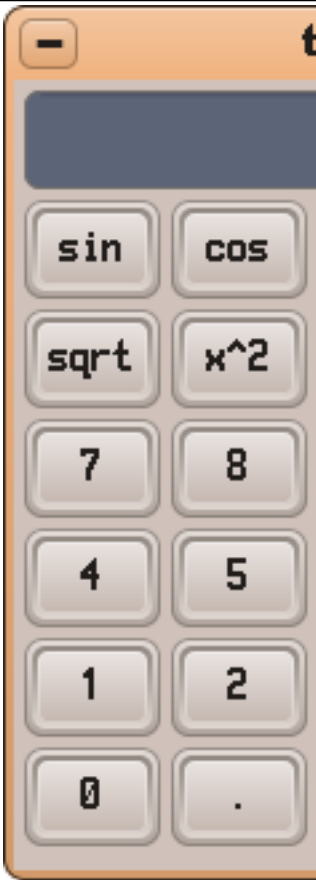
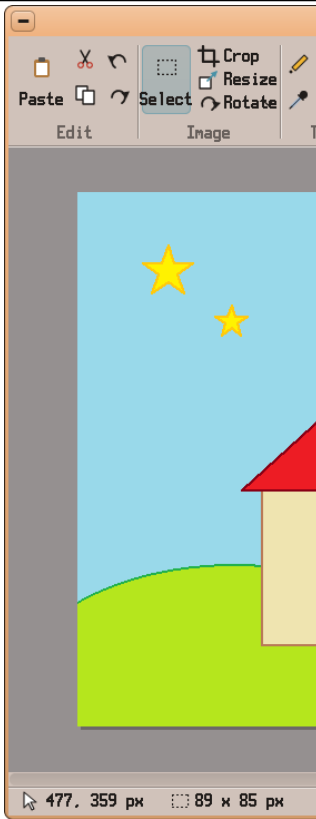
The eight patterns, each in a pair of the theme's colours: Bokeh, Contours, Dunes, Facets (top), Hexagons, Low Poly, Silk, Waves (bottom).

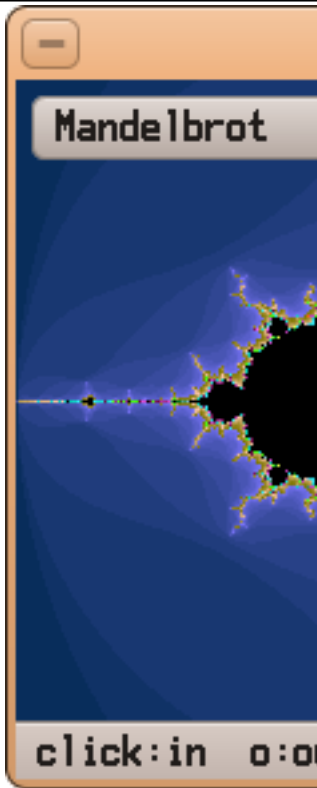
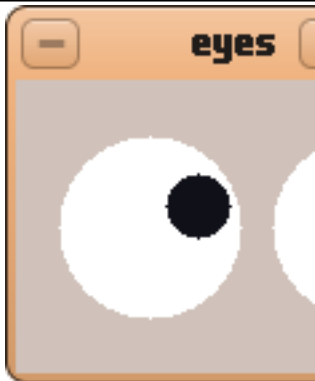
12. Application catalog

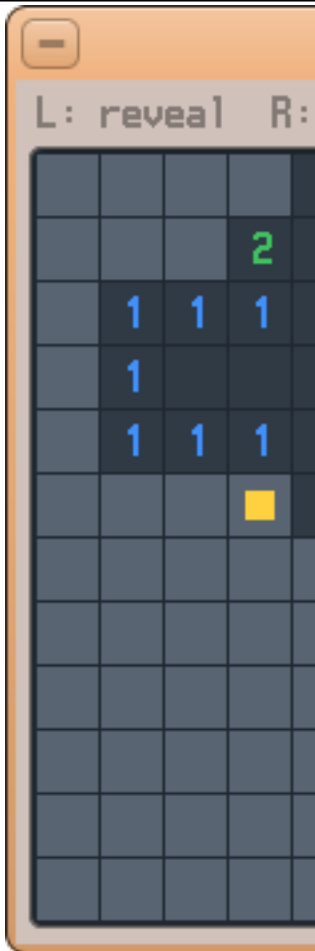
Tip: most games restart with `r`.

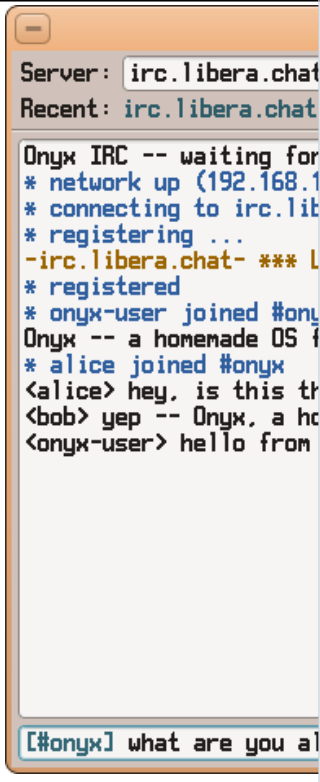
Gallery

A few applications (the real apps, run on a PC by `tools/tests/desktop_sim/shots.sh`):

		
<i>tinypad — text editor</i>	<i>tinycalc — calculator</i>	<i>paint — drawing</i>

		
<i>calendar — calendar + notes</i>	<i>mandelbrot — fractal explorer</i>	<i>eyes — gadget</i>

		
<i>taskman — task manager</i>	<i>2048 — tile game</i>	<i>minesweeper — minesweeper</i>

 sheet — spreadsheet	 irc — IRC client	
---	---	--

Productivity and tools

App	Description and controls
tinypad	Text editor. The file's path is shown above the text; click the area to edit; arrows/Home/End/Page to navigate. Select text with Shift + those keys, a mouse drag, Shift+click or ^A (Select All); typing replaces the selection. Menu Edit: Cut (^X), Copy (^C), Paste (^V), Select All (^A), Copy All. Menu File: New (^N), Open... (^O, file dialog), Save (^S), Save As... (loads/saves the whole file). Drop a file on the window to open it, or text to insert it; New / Open / a drop first ask to save unsaved changes (Yes / No / Cancel).
Writer	The word processor, in the way of AbiWord and Word: pages laid out and drawn with FreeType from the card's TrueType fonts, two toolbars (styles, fonts, sizes, bold / italic / underline /

App	Description and controls
	strike-through, superscript / subscript, colours, highlights, alignments, lists, indents, a table), a ruler (the indents, margins and a table's columns dragged), tables (merged cells, lines, shading, a heading row), headers and footers (the first page's own), page numbers and fields (date, time, pages), tab stops with leaders, a table of contents, images, Find and Replace, Special Character, Page Setup, Word Count, a mail merge (a Cardfile form's records into letters); Word (.docx), OpenDocument (.odt) and RTF read and written with everything, text, HTML export. See <i>Writer, the word processor</i> below.
Cardfile (cardfile)	A small database in the way of Access, without SQL: one .card file holds a form (its fields — text, multi-line text, integer, decimal number, date, colour, yes / no, choice list) and its records. Three views: Form (a record at a time, on an index card; Page Up / Down between records), List (a grid: a click on a column's name sorts), Design (the fields added, moved, named, typed — the values converted). Search, Undo / Redo, CSV export and import. Reads / writes .card files, .csv. See <i>Cardfile, a small database</i> below.
Graphing Calculator (graphcalc)	Plots up to four functions of x, in colour, live as you type them (left: y1= ... y4=, a check box shows / hides each; a red frame = syntax error). Syntax: + - * / ^, parentheses, x, pi, e, sin cos tan asin acos atan sqrt abs ln log exp floor ceil round sign, implicit multiplication (2x, 3sin(x), (x+1)(x-1)). Drag the graph to move, the wheel (or + / -) zooms around the pointer, the arrows pan; the pointer traces the curves (x and each y shown on the left). Standard (-10...10), Trig (-2π...2π), Square (same scale on both axes); View menu: Zoom In / Out, Grid; Edit ► Clear

App	Description and controls
	Functions. The functions are kept in <code>SD:/apps/graphcalc.app/functions.txt</code> .
Icon Editor (<code>iconedit</code>)	Draws icons: 24-bit BMP where magenta (<code>#FF00FF</code>) is transparent — the desktop's convention (app icons are 40×40, <code>SD:/apps/<name>.app/icon.bmp</code>). The enlarged pixel grid in the middle (transparency as a checkerboard); left button = 1st colour, right button = 2nd colour (X swaps them). Tools: Pen , Line , Rect , Box (filled), Ellipse (O), Fill , Picker (takes a pixel's colour), Eraser . Palette (32 colours + transparency) and More... (the colour dialog); live previews at 1× on light and dark and 2×. ^Z undo / ^Y redo, G grid. File: New 40×40 (^N) / 16 / 24 / 32 / 48 / 64, Open... (^O , up to 64×64), Save (^S), Save As...; Image: Flip, Rotate 90, Shift, Clear. Drop a BMP on the window to open it.
RTF Reader (<code>rtfview</code>)	Shows Rich Text Format documents (<code>.rtf</code> , e.g. saved by WordPad or Word) with their bold / italic / underline / strikethrough, colours, highlights and sizes, word-wrapped; accents and typographic quotes / dashes are converted. File ► Open... (^O) or drop a <code>.rtf</code> on the window (a double click on a <code>.rtf</code> in the File Viewer opens it in Writer : <code>fileassoc.ini</code>); Edit ► Copy (^C) / Select All (^A); File ► Edit in Writer . Paragraph layout (alignment, indents, tables), pictures and fonts are not kept (Writer keeps them). Sample: <code>SD:/docs/onyx-rtf-sample.rtf</code> .
tinycalc	Scientific calculator (fixed-point). Buttons + keyboard (+ - * / () ^ =), square root, trigonometric/exp/log functions.
Spreadsheet (<code>sheet</code>)	A spreadsheet in the way of LibreOffice Calc and Gnumeric: workbooks of several sheets (1 048 576 rows × 16 384 columns), formulas as Excel writes them (237 functions: mathematics, statistics,

App	Description and controls
	logic, text, lookups, dates, finance; references to other sheets, ranges, whole columns; arrays), number formats, fonts, colours, borders, merged cells, frozen panes, the fill handle's series, sort, Find and Replace, charts (column, bar, line, area, pie, scatter), conditional formatting (rules, colour scales, data bars), the AutoFilter, defined names, Undo / Redo. Reads and writes Excel's .xlsx and CSV, reads LibreOffice's .ods. See <i>The Spreadsheet</i> below.
qbasic (QBasic)	The BASIC editor (see §13): main module and SUBs / FUNCTIONs edited separately (View ► SUBs... ^L, Edit ► New SUB...), Run ► Start (^R) with errors shown at their line, File ► Make App... Opens .bas files. Reads/writes .bas files, SD:/tmp/<name>.bas (the copy it runs).
fmtracker (FM Tracker)	A music tracker with 8 channels of FM instruments (the sound system's FM synthesizer, like the AdLib). A column per channel, a row per time slice; a cell holds a note that starts there (C#4), --- (the note goes on) or nothing (silence) — a note lasts until the next note or silence of its channel. Keys: C D E F G A B a note (Shift = sharp; the cursor then goes to the next slice, and you hear it), 0–7 the octave, Space a silence, Delete ---, Backspace clears the slice above, # toggles the sharp, Ctrl+↑ / Ctrl+↓ move the note a semitone up / down, arrows / Page Up / Down / Home / End move (←/→ = channel), Tab the next channel; a click selects a cell; wheel / scrollbar scroll. The column header is a button: it opens the instrument dialog (presets from SD:/apps/fmtracker.app/ins, Load / Save .FMI, the two operators' multiplier, level, attack, decay, sustain, release, wave, sustain / tremolo / vibrato flags, feedback, FM or additive, Test); right-click it to mute the channel in this pattern. Play (^P) plays from the cursor,

App	Description and controls
	follows the position and highlights it; Stop / Esc. A song is a list of patterns (toolbar: ◀ ▶ +, Rows, Speed = a slice lasts speed / 20 s; Pattern menu: New, Duplicate, Delete). Opens and saves FM Song .FMS files (QBasic's FM Song, 2001 — SD:/music/fms has 59 songs) and .FMI instruments; double-clicking a .fms file opens it. Standard tuning (A4 = 440 Hz; FM Song's AdLib table played a semitone higher). Edit ▶ Insert / Delete slice (^E / ^D), File ▶ Song Info.
imageview (Image Viewer)	Views BMP, GIF (animated), PNG, JPEG, PCX and WebP images — double-click one in the File Viewer (fileassoc.ini), drop it on the window or File ▶ Open... (^O). Fits the window by default (never enlarged); 1 = actual size, + / - or the wheel zoom, 0 = fit; drag to pan a large image. ← / → (or Page Up / Down, Backspace / Space) = previous / next image of the folder, Home / End = first / last. Transparency is shown over a checkerboard. The status bar shows the name, size, format, zoom and position in the folder. File ▶ Edit in Paint hands the file to paint. Wallpaper: <code>imageview --background <image></code> (no window) makes the image the desktop background, scaled to cover the screen (proportions kept, the overflow cut), or with -tile repeated from the top-left corner, then exits — e.g. the line <code>run imageview --background SD:/pictures/sky.jpg</code> in <code>SD:/etc/autostart</code> instead of <code>run voronoy</code>.
paint (Paint)	Drawing, in the way of Windows 11's Paint, on transparent layers: pencil, brush, eraser, fill, colour picker, magnifier, fifteen shapes (outline and fill), a rectangular selection moved, rotated, flipped, cut and pasted, colour 1 / colour 2, a palette and your own colours, a pixel grid, zoom to 3200 %. Opens PNG, JPEG, BMP, GIF (WebP,

App	Description and controls
	PCX); saves its layers as OpenRaster (.ora); exports PNG, JPEG, BMP or GIF. See <i>Paint</i> below.
calendar	Calendar + notes. Left/right arrows = month, up/down = year; click a day, type a note, Enter to save (agenda.txt in the app's folder). An argument YYYYMMDD opens that day (used by the agenda widget).
agenda (Agenda)	Desktop widget: the next calendar appointments (see §5, <i>The agenda widget</i>).
dock (Dock)	The desktop's dock at the bottom: the drawers (a group's main app, the strip above opens the group's apps), the workspaces, lock / Control Panel / power, the Terminal, the File Viewer, the Trash (see §5, <i>The dock</i>). Reads SD:/etc/dock.ini (the Panel applet writes it).
lock (Lock Screen)	The locked screen (the dock's padlock): the time and the date full screen; a click or a key unlocks it, or a PIN from SD:/etc/lock.ini (pin = 1234) then Enter (see §5).
shelf (Shelf)	The former bottom strip of references in tabs (no longer started). Reads/writes SD:/etc/shelf.ini.
ask (Confirm)	A small system window used by apps that cannot host a dialog (the dock): `run ask "Title
fileviewer (File Viewer)	NeXTSTEP-style column browser with a clickable path bar, file previews and copy/cut/paste (see §9).
terminal	Terminal/shell (see §7).
Gamepad (padconf)	A Control Panel applet (alone: a window of its own). The USB gamepads (Xbox 360 / One, PlayStation 3 / 4, Switch Pro and any USB HID gamepad; up to 4). Tabs Pad 1–4 (or keys 1–4): the pad's USB ids and which mapping it uses, its buttons (numbered, lit while held), axes and hats live, and on a drawn pad what the apps see. Pad ► Map Buttons...

App	Description and controls
	(M): press each button when asked (the d-pad, then the bottom / right / left / top face buttons, the shoulders L1 / R1, the triggers L2 / R2 — buttons or analog triggers, both are recognised — Select, Start, the sticks' clicks, Home); Esc = the pad has none, Backspace = cancel. It writes the pad model's section of <code>SD:/etc/gamepad.ini</code> — every app uses it at once. Forget Mapping removes it. Pads Circle knows need no mapping; other pads start from <code>[default]</code> (the usual generic layout). An axis the d-pad / left stick (or a trigger) uses is never read as the right stick too: a pad whose d-pad is on axes 3 / 4, once mapped, no longer presses the Nintendo 64's C buttons when it moves.
taskman	Task manager. Arrows to select; Enter brings the window to the foreground; <code>k/Delete</code> kills the app (except kernel tasks); <code>r</code> refreshes.
memmon	Memory monitor. Shows total / used / free RAM, the memory owned by apps, a usage bar, and the processes ranked by 64 KB pages owned. Refreshes $\sim 1 \times /s$.
theme (Theme)	The Control Panel's Theme applet: the colours of the frames, the windows' content, the buttons, the fields, the selection, the menu bar, the dock (a palette or any colour), the scheme, the outline, the wallpaper (Voronoi, gradient, bubbles, a colour, a picture, a coloured pattern), on a desktop preview (see §11). Writes <code>SD:/etc/theme.txt</code> and <code>SD:/etc/wallpaper.ini</code>.
control (Control Panel)	The settings in one window: its applets drawn inside it (see §11). Its list: the link files of <code>SD:/apps/control.app/applets/</code>.
dockconf (Panel)	The Control Panel's Panel applet: the dock's drawers (group + main app), launchers and workspaces (see §11). Writes <code>SD:/etc/dock.ini</code>.

App	Description and controls
soundconf (Sound)	The Control Panel's Sound applet: the master volume, mute, a test sound (see §11). Writes <code>SD:/etc/sound.ini</code> .
keyconf (Keyboard & Mouse)	The Control Panel's Keyboard & Mouse applet: the layout (kept in <code>SD:/etc/autostart</code>), the wheel's speed (kept in <code>SD:/etc/theme.txt</code>) (see §11).
config (App Settings)	The Control Panel's App Settings applet: an app's <code>config.ini</code> , key by key (see §11).
eyes	Gadget: two eyes whose pupils follow the mouse.
mandelbrot	Fractal explorer (Mandelbrot, Julia, Burning Ship, Tricorn via the dropdown). Click = zoom in (re-centers); o = zoom out; r = reset.
inidemo	Demonstration of the <code>.ini</code> reader (displays values from <code>config.ini</code>).
irc	IRC client over Wi-Fi. Connects to the server/channel from <code>config.ini</code> , shows the conversation, type to chat. Commands: <code>/join #chan</code> , <code>/msg nick text</code> , <code>/nick name</code> , <code>/me action</code> , <code>/raw ...</code> , <code>/quit</code> . Needs the network up (see §3).
httpc	A mouse-driven text web browser (<code>http://</code> and <code>https://</code>). Renders the page text with hyperlinks in blue (click to follow), and handles simple forms (text fields, checkboxes, dropdowns, buttons → GET/POST). Navbar: <code><</code> back, <code>></code> forward, an address bar (click to type, Enter or Go to load); the right-hand scrollbar (or PgUp/PgDn/arrows) scrolls. Needs the network up (see §3).
NetSurf	The NetSurf web browser — a full graphical HTML/CSS rendering engine ported to Onyx: <code>http://</code> and <code>https://</code> , images, modern CSS (custom properties <code>var()</code> , <code>calc()</code> , flexbox, grid, rounded corners, gradients, shadows, gradient text, translucent <code>rgba</code> colours...) and JavaScript (QuickJS, ES2023: a page's menus, tabs and forms work — a script's changes are laid out again;

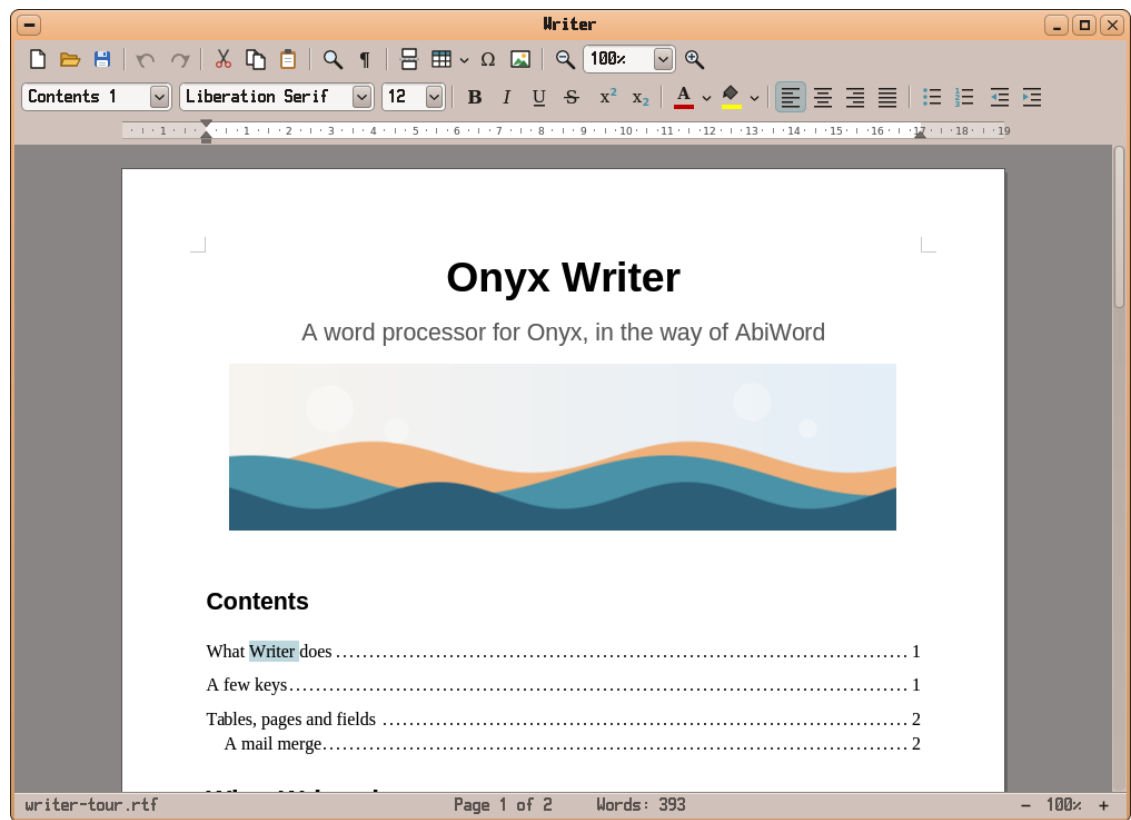
App	Description and controls
	clicks, keys, typing, scrolling and the pointer's moves (hover) reach the page's scripts; <code>fetch</code> and <code>XMLHttpRequest</code> load data, <code>localStorage</code> is kept between visits). Each download runs in its own thread: the window stays responsive while a page loads. Fonts as Chrome's on Windows: a page's web fonts (<code>@font-face</code>: TrueType, OpenType, WOFF, WOFF2) are downloaded; Arial, Times New Roman, Segoe UI and Georgia are drawn with metric-compatible free fonts (Liberation, Selawik, Gelasio — in <code>SD:/res/fonts</code>, with DejaVu for the other characters). Toolbar: <code><</code> back (Alt+Left), <code>></code> forward (Alt+Right), reload — a <code>×</code> stop while a page loads — (F5 / Ctrl+R, Esc), home, the clock (the history), the address field (click it, F6 or Ctrl+L; an address, a host, a path on the card or words to search the web; Enter). The mouse wheel scrolls the page; a file dropped on the window is opened. Navigate ► History... (Ctrl+H, the clock): the pages visited, the most recent at the top — their title, their address, when (the time today, the day this week, else the date); type in Find to filter them; a double-click or Enter opens one; Delete (or Del in the list) forgets it, Clear all forgets them all. Files: the options in <code>SD:/res/Choices</code> (<code>enable_javascript:0</code> turns the scripts off); its <code>app.txt</code> asks the kernel for an 8 MB stack (<code>stack = 8M</code>: the JavaScript engine's); the pages visited in <code>SD:/apps/netsurf.app/History</code> and the cookies in <code>SD:/apps/netsurf.app/Cookies</code> (written a few seconds after each page and when NetSurf closes — private: never committed). Build: <code>user/netsurf/README.md</code>. Needs the network up (see §3).
wpaconf (Wi-Fi Settings)	A Control Panel applet (alone: a window

App	Description and controls
	of its own). Editor for the WLAN credentials in <code>SD:/etc/wpa_supplicant.conf</code>. Fields: SSID — a combo box: Scan lists the networks around (about 3 s), pick one with its arrow (or Down / Up) and the proto / key mgmt follow its security (an open network gets <code>key_mgmt=NONE</code>, no password) — password (masked — Show password reveals it), country, proto, key mgmt; Tab moves between fields. Save rewrites the file; Save & Reboot writes it then restarts so the kernel re-reads it at boot (the only way new credentials take effect); Reload re-reads the file. The password is stored in clear text on the card (the radio needs it) — keep the card private.
Lisa	A chat with an AI assistant (a modern <i>Eliza</i>), through the Groq API over HTTPS. Type in the box at the bottom: Enter sends, Shift+Enter starts a new line; Lisa's answer appears in the conversation above (word-wrapped; "Lisa is thinking..." meanwhile). Every request sends Lisa's role and the whole conversation, so she keeps the context. Menus: Chat ► New Conversation (^N), Save Transcript... (^S); Edit ► Copy (the selected text), Paste, Copy Last Answer; Settings ► Edit Configuration... (opens <code>config.ini</code> in tinypad). Setup: get a free API key at console.groq.com and put it in <code>SD:/apps/lisa.app/config.ini</code> as <code>key = gsk_...</code> (see <code>config.ini.example</code> in the same folder: <code>model, role, temperature, max_tokens</code>). That file holds your key: keep it private — it is never committed. Needs the network up (see §3).
voronoy	The wallpaper's painter (launched at boot, and by the Theme applet's Apply; no window): Voronoi cells, a gradient, bubbles, a colour, a picture, or a grey pattern of <code>SD:/wallpapers</code> coloured by the gradient, as <code>SD:/etc/wallpaper.ini</code>

App	Description and controls
	says (§11).

On a PC: `tools/fmsplayer/fmsplayer.exe` is an **FM Song player for Windows** built from the same code (the `.FMS` reader and the FM synthesizer of the Onyx kernel): Open... or drop `.fms` files on it; the folder's songs make the playlist (double-click one); Play / Pause, Stop, Previous / Next, Loop song; it shows the title, author, comment, position and each channel's note. Rebuild it with `tools/fmsplayer/build.sh` (MinGW-w64).

Writer, the word processor (`writer`)



Writer with its sample document (`SD:/docs/writer-tour.rtf`): its table of contents, a word selected, the toolbar showing its style, font and size.

Writer is Onyx's word processor, in the way of AbiWord and Word. The document is laid out on **pages** — A4 by default, 2 cm margins — shown one under the other on a grey desk, each with its **header** and **footer**, and every letter is drawn by **FreeType** from the TrueType fonts of the card (`SD:/res/fonts`; a `.ttf` added to `SD:/fonts` shows up too): **Liberation Serif** and **Liberation Sans** (the metrics of Times New Roman and Arial), **DejaVu Sans / Serif / Sans Mono**, **Gelasio** (Georgia's), **Selawik** (Segoe UI's). A font a document names but the card lacks is shown with its twin (Arial → Liberation Sans, Times New Roman → Liberation Serif, Courier New → DejaVu Sans Mono, Georgia → Gelasio, Segoe UI → Selawik, others by kind) and keeps its name when the document is saved. It reads and writes **Word (.docx)**, **OpenDocument (.odt)** and **RTF** documents with their tables, headers, fields and lists; it fills letters from **Cardfile** forms (the **mail merge**). No printing yet.

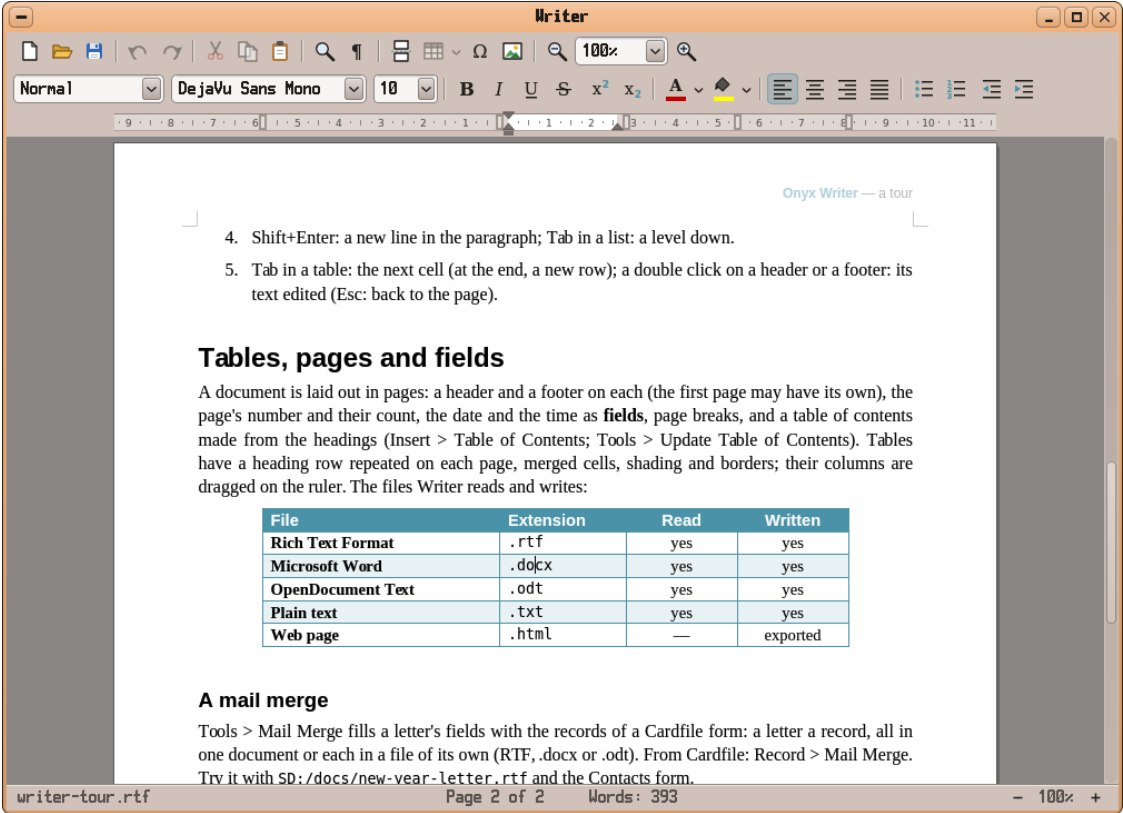
The window, from the top:

- **The standard toolbar:** New, Open, Save · Undo, Redo · Cut, Copy, Paste · Find and Replace, Formatting marks (¶: the spaces, tabs, line breaks and paragraphs' ends shown) · Page break, **Table** (the button: Insert Table...; its arrow: a grid — the cells under the pointer lit, a click inserts that many columns and rows), Special character (Ω), Insert image · the **zoom** (–, the list: Page Width, Whole Page, 25 %–400 %, +).
- **The format toolbar:** the paragraph's **style** (Normal, Heading 1–3, Title, Subtitle, Quote, Plain Text, Contents 1–3, Contents Heading, Header, Footer — the list shows each in its look), the **font** (the list shows each font in itself), the **size** (type a number then Enter, or pick one), **B I U S**, superscript and subscript, the **text colour** and the **highlight** (a click applies the colour shown under the letter; the arrow opens the palette: Automatic / No Colour, sixty colours, More Colours...), the four **alignments**, **bullets** and **numbering**, **decrease / increase indent**. The buttons show the text at the caret: bold lit on bold text, its font, its size, its alignment.
- **The ruler:** the page's width at the zoom, the margins grey, in centimetres (View ► Ruler in Inches / Centimetres). Its markers are the paragraph's indents — the first line's (the triangle on top), the hanging indent (the triangle below), the left indent (the little box: both together), the right indent: **drag them** (the selected paragraphs change, one undoable edit). Drag the edge between the grey and the white to move the page's left or right margin. In a **table**, the ruler is the cell's (its numbers from the cell's left edge) and shows the table's **column borders**: drag one to resize the columns on both sides of it.
- **The pages:** a click places the caret, a **drag** selects (past the edge, the page scrolls), a **double click** selects a word, a **triple click** the paragraph, **Shift+click** extends the selection; the **wheel** and the scroll bars scroll; a **right click** opens a menu (Cut, Copy, Paste, Font..., Paragraph..., then — in a table — Insert Row Below, Insert Column Right, Delete Rows, Delete Columns, Merge Cells, Split Cell, Table Properties...; in a table of contents, Update Table of Contents; in a header or a footer, Close Header and Footer; else Bullets, Numbering —, Select All). A **double click in the top or bottom margin** edits that page's header or footer; a table's **column border** is dragged on the page too.
- **The status bar:** the file's name ("modified" when it is), the caret's page and the number of pages (in a header: "Header - Page 2 of 3"), the number of words, the zoom (– / +).

Keys: typing replaces the selection; the arrows (**Ctrl**: by word, by paragraph; in a table, Up / Down go from cell to cell), **Home / End** (the line's; **Ctrl**: the document's), **Page Up / Down**, with **Shift** to select; **Backspace / Delete** (**Ctrl**: a word); **Enter** a new paragraph (after a heading: a Normal one; in an empty list item: the end of the list; in a table: a new paragraph in the cell), **Shift+Enter** a new line in the paragraph; **Tab** the next tab stop (the paragraph's own, else every 1.25 cm) — at the start of a list item, a level down (**Shift+Tab**: up); in a table, the **next cell** (in the last one: a new row; **Shift+Tab** the previous cell); **Esc** drops the selection, or leaves a header or a footer. Shortcuts: **Ctrl+N / O / S** New, Open, Save · **Ctrl+Z / Y** Undo, Redo · **Ctrl+X / C / V** Cut, Copy, Paste · **Ctrl+A** Select All · **Ctrl+F** Find and Replace · **Ctrl+B / I / U** bold, italic, underline · **Ctrl+L / E / R / J** left, centred, right, justified · **Ctrl+D** Font...

The menus: **File** (New, Open..., Save, Save As..., Export as HTML..., Export as Text..., Page Setup...), **Edit** (Undo, Redo, Cut, Copy, Paste, Paste Unformatted, Select All, Find and Replace...), **View** (Actual Size, Page Width, Whole Page, **Header and Footer**, Formatting Marks, the ruler's unit), **Insert** (Page Break, **Table...**, Image..., Special Character..., **Page Numbers...**, Date and Time..., **Field...**, **Table of Contents**), **Format** (Font..., Paragraph..., **Tabs...**, Bold, Italic, Underline, Strikethrough, Superscript, Subscript, Clear Formatting, the four alignments, Bullets, Numbering), **Table** (Insert Rows Above / Below, Insert Columns Left / Right, Delete Rows, Delete Columns, Delete Table, Merge Cells, Split Cell, Distribute Columns Evenly, Select Table, Table Properties...), **Tools** (Word Count..., Update Table of Contents, **Mail Merge...**).

Tables



The

sample's second page: its header, a table with a heading row and shaded rows, the caret in a cell — the ruler shows its columns.

Insert ► Table... asks the number of columns and rows (and whether the heading row is repeated on each page); the toolbar's grid inserts one at once. The table spans the text's width, its columns even; each **cell** holds paragraphs of its own (styles, lists, images, fields...). **Tab** goes from cell to cell and, in the last one, adds a row. A **drag** across cells selects them, as does **Table ► Select Table**. The **Table** menu acts on the selected cells: it inserts **rows** above or below them (as many as selected) and **columns** left or right, **deletes** the rows, the columns or the whole table, **merges** the selected cells into one (their text kept, one paragraph under the other) and **splits** a merged cell back, **distributes** the columns evenly. **Table Properties...**: the lines (all, none, the outline only, the rows only), their width and colour, the table's alignment on the page and its indent, the heading row repeated on each page; for the selected cells, the columns' width, the rows' least height and the **shading**. A table breaks across pages between its rows — a row, and the rows its merged cells span, kept whole —; its **heading row** is drawn again at the top of each page. Each change undoes in one step.

Pages: headers, footers, page numbers, fields

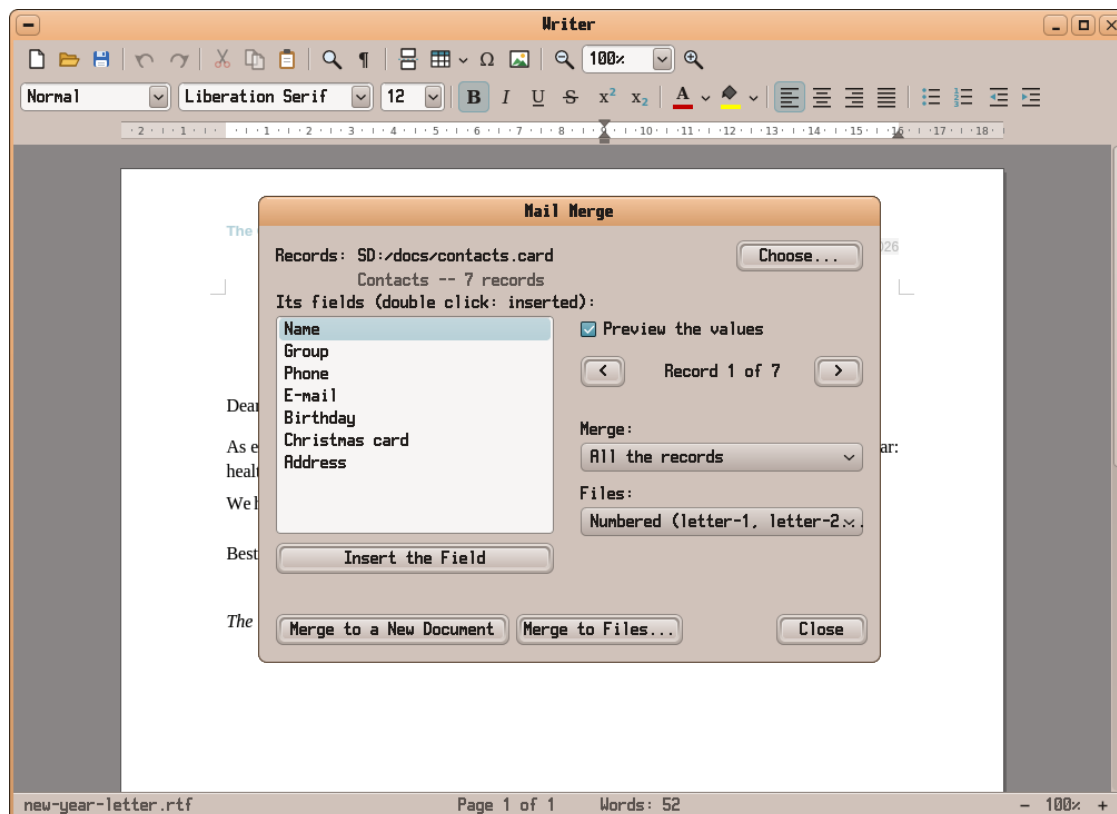
- **View ► Header and Footer** (or a **double click** in a page's top or bottom margin) edits the header or the footer — the body greyed, the header's frame labelled "Header", "First Page Header"...; a double click on the body, **Esc** or the menu again goes back. A header or a footer holds what a page does (styles, tab stops, images, fields), and the page's body starts below it when it grows.

- **Insert ► Page Numbers...:** at the top (the header) or the bottom (the footer), left, centred or right, as "1", "Page 1", "Page 1 of 3" or "1 / 3", and whether the first page shows it (else the first page gets a header and footer of its own).
- **File ► Page Setup...:** the paper (A4, A5, A3, Letter, Legal), portrait or landscape, the four margins, the header's distance from the page's top and the footer's from its foot, **Different first page** (a title page with its own header and footer), the **first page's number**; a preview of the page.
- **Insert ► Field...:** the **page number**, the **number of pages**, the **date** or the **time** (in the form chosen), text kept up to date (shaded grey on the screen, not in the files); **Insert ► Date and Time...** types today's date or the time — as a field with **Update automatically**.
- **Format ► Paragraph...** says how the pages break: **Page break before**, **Keep with next** (the headings are), **Keep lines together**, **Widow / orphan control** (no paragraph's first or last line alone at a page's foot or top: on by default).

Tab stops: **Format ► Tabs...** (or the Paragraph dialog's **Tabs...** button) lists the paragraph's tab stops: a **position**, an **alignment** (left, centred, right, **decimal** — the numbers' points lined up) and a **leader** (none, dots, dashes, a line), **Set / Clear / Clear All**; past the last one, the default stops every 1.25 cm.

The table of contents: **Insert ► Table of Contents** puts one at the caret — a "Contents" heading, then a line for each **Heading 1, 2 and 3** of the document, indented by level, its page number at the right after a line of dots. **Tools ► Update Table of Contents** (or its right-click menu) makes it again after the document changed — its titles and its pages.

The mail merge



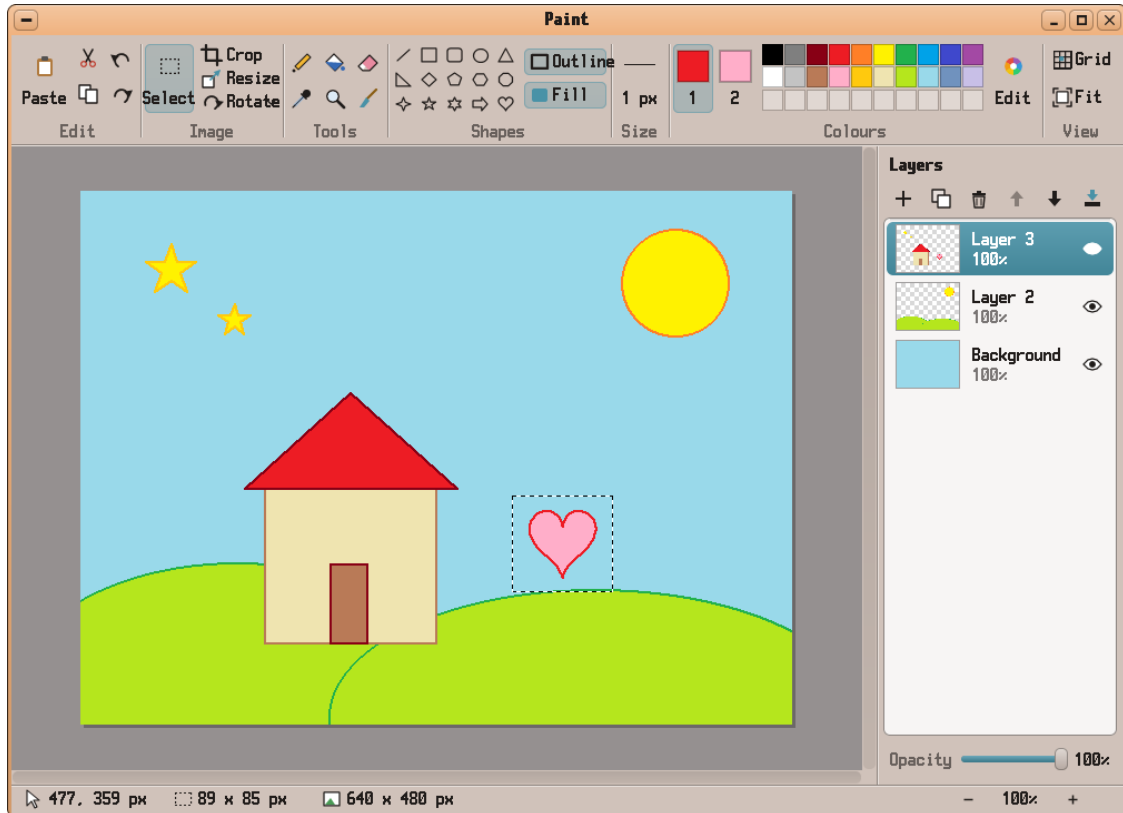
Tools ►

Mail Merge over the sample letter (SD:/docs/new-year-Letter.rtf): the Contacts form's fields, the first record's values shown in the letter.

A **letter** (any Writer document) gets **merge fields** — the columns of a **Cardfile** form — that the mail merge fills with the form's **records**: one letter per record. **Tools ► Mail Merge...** opens the dialog: **Records** — the Cardfile form (**.card**) the letter's fields come from (**Choose...**; the letter remembers it); **Its fields** — a double click (or **Insert the Field**) puts one at the caret, shown «name» in the letter; **Preview the values** shows a record's values instead, < > go through the records; **Merge: All the records** or **The record previewed**; **Merge to a New Document** opens the letters, each on a new page, as a new document in another Writer; **Merge to Files...** writes each letter in a file of its own — the name and the folder chosen give the folder and the format (**.rtf**, **.docx**, **.odt**), the files named after a field (**Files**: "Named after: Name" → **Alice Martin.odt**) or numbered (**letter-1.odt...**). Cardfile does the same from a form: **Record ► Mail Merge...** (see *Cardfile*). A multi-line value (an address) keeps its lines; a date shows as in Cardfile (29/09/2026), yes / no as Yes / No. Files written: the documents chosen; **SD:/apps/writer.app/ merge-letter.rtf** and **merge.job** (the request to the other Writer).

Files: **.rtf** (Rich Text Format), **.docx** (Word 2007 and later) and **.odt** (OpenDocument Text: LibreOffice, OpenOffice), read and written with **everything** — the fonts, sizes, colours, highlights, styles, alignments, indents, spacing, tab stops, lists, page breaks, images, tables (merged cells, lines, shading, the heading row), the headers and footers (the first page's own), the fields (page, pages, date, time, the merge fields), the table of contents, the page's size and margins; documents from Word, WordPad, LibreOffice or AbiWord open with theirs (a feature Writer lacks is left out: text boxes and shapes, comments; tracked changes are read accepted). **.txt**: plain text (UTF-8 when a character needs it, else Latin-1 like the rest of Onyx). **Save** writes the format of the file's name (a new document: Save As..., **.rtf** by default — type **.docx** or **.odt** for those; saving formats as **.txt** asks first); **File ► Export** writes an **HTML** page (its images inside it) or a text file, the document staying where it was. A **.rtf**, **.doc**, **.docx** or **.odt** double-clicked in the File Viewer opens in Writer (**fileassoc.ini**; so does the RTF Reader's **File ► Edit in Writer**), as does **writer <file>**; **drop** a file on the window to open it, or text to insert it at the caret. New, Open and a drop first ask to **save unsaved changes**; **closed with unsaved changes** (the close box, Quit), the document is kept in **SD:/apps/writer.app/recovered.rtf** and offered back when Writer starts again. **Undo** keeps the last 200 edits (a word typed is one). Copy and paste within Writer keep the formats (and the images); the other apps get the text. Documents usually start in **SD:/docs**; the samples: **SD:/docs/writer-tour.rtf**, **SD:/docs/new-year-letter.rtf** (the letter of the Contacts form: **SD:/docs/contacts.card**).

Paint (paint)



Paint: a

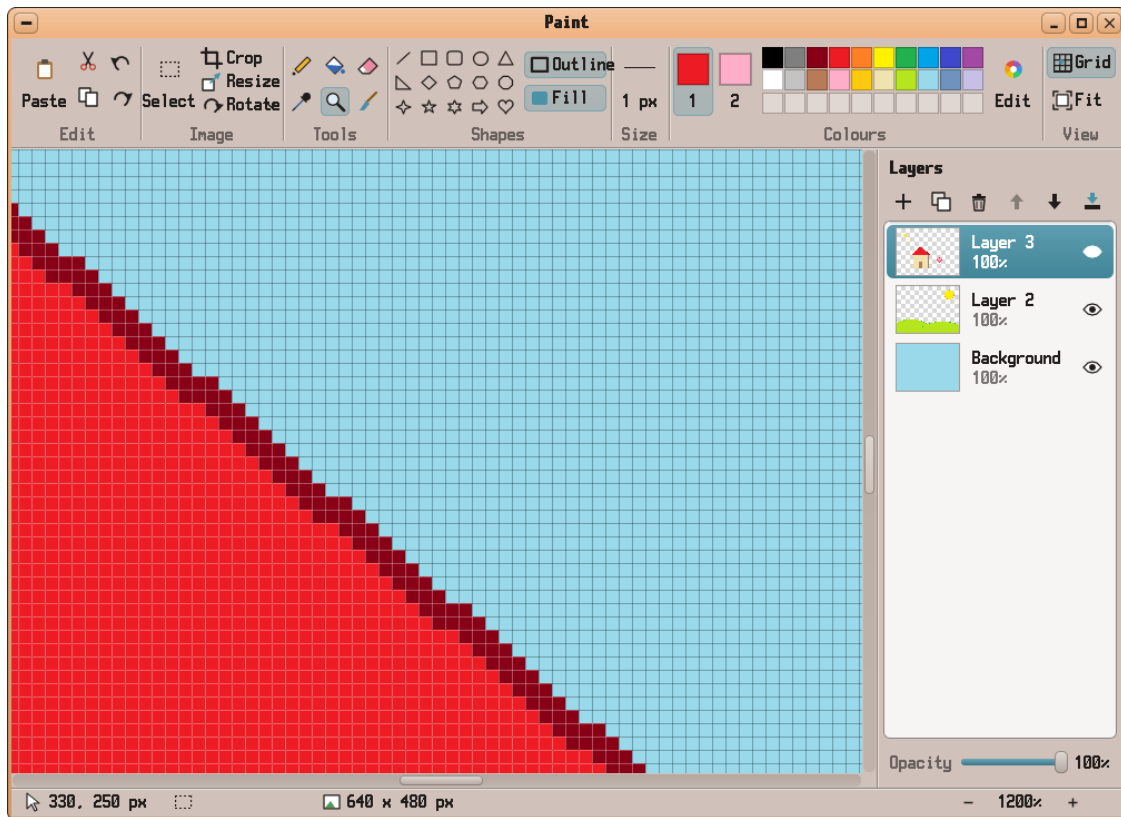
picture on three layers — the sky, the hills and the sun, the house — the heart selected.

Paint draws **to the pixel**, in the way of Windows 11's Paint, on **layers**: transparent sheets stacked over the background, each shown or hidden, more or less opaque. The window: the **ribbon** at the top, the **canvas** in the middle (the picture on a grey desk, its transparent parts over a checkerboard), the **Layers** panel on the right, the **status bar** at the bottom (the pixel under the pointer, the selection's size, the picture's size, the zoom).

The ribbon, from the left:

- **Edit: Paste** (the copied pixels — or a picture file copied in the File Viewer — floating, ready to be moved), **Cut**, **Copy**, **Undo**, **Redo**.
- **Image: Select** (drag a rectangle; drag inside it to move its pixels, the arrows move them a pixel — Shift: ten —; a **click outside puts them down**), **Crop** (to the selection), **Resize** (the picture scaled — sharp pixels or smooth —, or its canvas made bigger or smaller, the picture at the top left or centred; the proportions kept or not), **Rotate** (right or left 90°, 180°, flip vertical or horizontal): **the selection if there is one, else the whole picture** — every layer.
- **Tools: Pencil** (square pixels), **Fill** (the area of one colour, 4-connected), **Eraser** (to transparent — on an opaque background: colour 2, as the classic Paint), **Colour picker** (from what is visible: colour 1 with the left button, colour 2 with the right one; back to the tool used before), **Magnifier** (left: zoom in there, right: zoom out), **Brush** (round).
- **Shapes**: line, rectangle, rounded rectangle, ellipse, triangle, right triangle, diamond, pentagon, hexagon, octagon, four-, five- and six-point stars, arrow, heart — the polygons **inscribed in the ellipse of the box** you drag; **Shift** makes the box a square (a circle, a regular polygon) and a line horizontal, vertical or at 45°. **Outline** (colour 1) and **Fill** (colour 2) are toggles (one at least).

- **Size:** the width of the pencil, the brush, the eraser, the shapes' outline (1 to 32 px).
- **Colours:** **colour 1** (the left button's) and **colour 2** (the right button's, the shapes' inside) — click one of them to choose which one the palette sets; the **palette** (twenty colours: left click the chosen colour, right click colour 2); **ten colours of your own** below it, filled by **Edit** (any colour: the colour dialog). **X** swaps the two colours.
- **View: Grid** — the pixel grid, **on or off** (seen from 300 %: turning it on zooms to 400 %) —, **Fit** (the whole picture in the window).



The pixel

grid at 1200 %: every pixel of the roof's edge.

Drawing: the left button draws with colour 1, the right one with colour 2 (a shape: its outline colour 1 and its inside colour 2 — the right button swaps them). The **wheel** scrolls (Shift: sideways), **Ctrl+wheel** zooms around the pointer; **+ / -** zoom; the status bar's **- / 100 % / +** too (the percentage: a list, Fit). Keys for the tools: **S** select, **P** pencil, **B** brush, **E** eraser, **F** fill, **K** colour picker, **Z** magnifier, **U** shapes; **Delete** clears the selection (on the background: colour 2), **Esc** puts a floating selection down.

The layers: the panel lists them, the top one first, each with its thumbnail, its name, its opacity and its **eye** (a click shows or hides it). A click on a layer makes it the one you draw on; a **double click** opens its properties (name, opacity, shown); a **right click** its menu. Its buttons: **new layer** (transparent, above the current one), **duplicate**, **delete**, **move up / down**, **merge down** (into the one below). The **Opacity** slider under the list sets the current layer's. The Layers menu adds **Flatten** (one layer of what is visible) and Layer Properties. Selections, pastes, fills and the eraser work on the current layer; the colour picker takes what you see.

Files: **File ► Save** (Ctrl+S) writes the **working format**, OpenRaster (**.ora**: every layer kept, with its name, opacity and visibility — GIMP, Krita and MyPaint open it too); **File ► Open** reads it, or a **PNG, JPEG, BMP, GIF** (its first frame), WebP or PCX picture (one layer: the Background). **File ► Export as PNG /**

JPEG / BMP / GIF writes **what is visible**, flattened: PNG keeps the transparency, GIF too (a transparent colour; 256 colours: a picture with more is reduced), JPEG (quality 90) and BMP lay the transparent parts on white. **File ▶ New** (Ctrl+N) asks for the size (640 × 480 by default) and a white or transparent background. A picture named on the command line (`paint <file>`: the Image Viewer's File ▶ Edit in Paint), dropped on the window or double-clicked (a `.ora: fileassoc.ini`) opens; New, Open and a drop first ask to save unsaved changes. **Closed with unsaved changes**, the picture is kept in `SD:/apps/paint.app/recovered.ora` and offered back the next time Paint starts. **Undo** keeps the last 60 changes (a stroke is one).

Cardfile, a small database (`cardfile`)



Cardfile's

Form view with its sample (`SD:/docs/books.card`): a record on its index card.

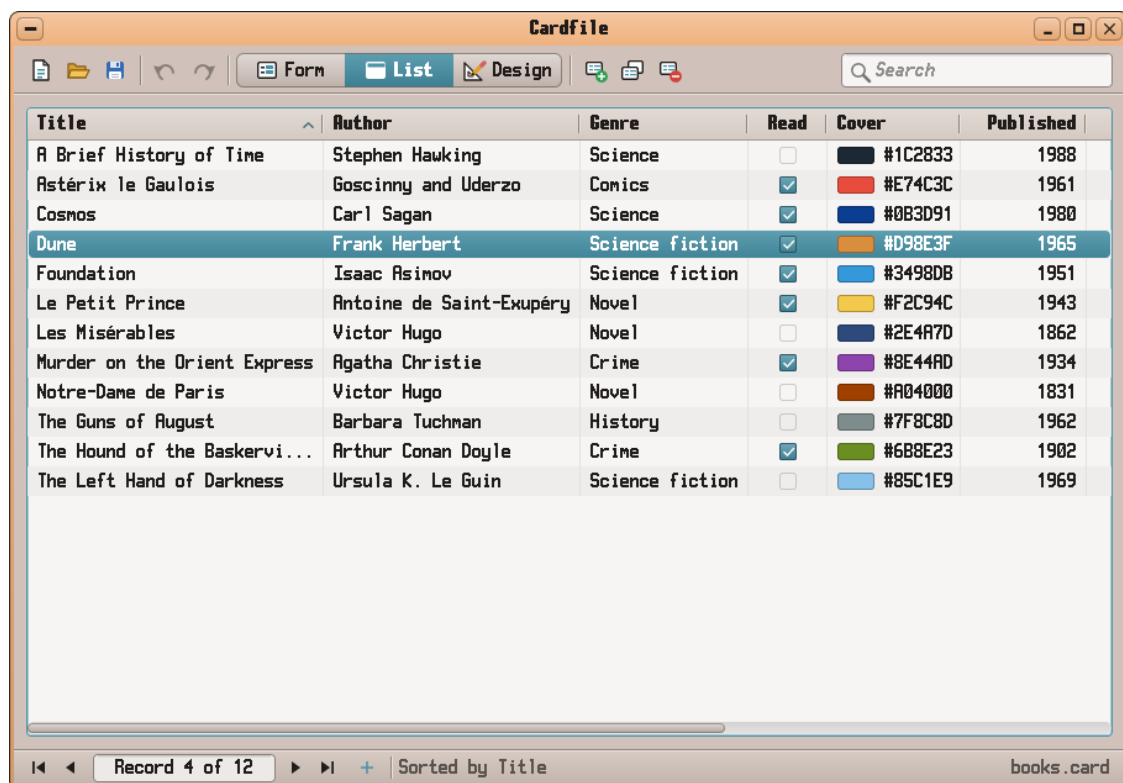
Cardfile keeps **records** — books, contacts, a collection, recipes... — in the way of Microsoft Access, without SQL. One file (`.card`) holds one **form** — its title, a description and its **fields** — and its records. A field has a **display name** (on the form and in the list), a **column name** (the file's) and a **type**:

Type	On the form	Kept as
Text	a line, of any length	as typed
Multi-line text	a box of several lines, wrapped at the words	as typed
Integer	a line, on the right: 42, -7, 1 000 000	42
Decimal number	the same, with its decimals (0 to 6): 12,5 → 12.50 (. or ,)	12.50

Type	On the form	Kept as
Date	typed as DD/MM/YYYY (or 29.9.26, 29/9 — this year —, 29092026, 2026-09-29), or picked on the calendar its button drops (Today, Clear)	2026-09-29
Colour	a swatch and its code; its button drops a palette (40 colours, No colour, More Colours...: the colour dialog)	#3366CC
Yes / No	a check box	yes, or empty
Choice list	a list of the form's choices , and "(none)"	the choice

The toolbar: New form, Open, Save · Undo, Redo · the **view switch** — Form, List, Design (F5, F6, F7) · New record, Duplicate record, Delete record · the **search** box. **At the foot:** the record navigator — first, previous, *Record 3 of 12* (a click: Go to Record...), next, last, a new record (+) —, then what is shown (the records, the search's matches, the sort), and the file's name (a dot before it: unsaved changes; a dot before *Record*: the record shown has changes not kept yet).

The Form view: the record on an index card — the form's title and description, its place (3 / 12, or *New*), a line a field. **Tab** / Shift+Tab, **Enter**, **Up** / **Down** move between the fields (a click on a field's name too — on a check box's name it ticks it); **Page Up** / **Page Down** show the previous / next record, **Ctrl+Home** / **Ctrl+End** the first / last one; **Esc** puts the record's values back. The values go into the record when it is left (another record, another view, Save...): a value that is not one of its type (31/02/2026, letters in a number) is said, outlined in red, and its field keeps the keyboard. A new record left without a value is dropped. In a line: the selection (Shift + the arrows, a drag, a double click on a word, Ctrl+A), Ctrl+X / C / V, Ctrl + the arrows by words; in a choice: Up / Down, a letter jumps to the next choice starting with it, Delete = (none), Enter or a click drops the list; a date or a colour: a click on its button (or Alt+Down) drops the calendar or the palette, Delete empties a colour.



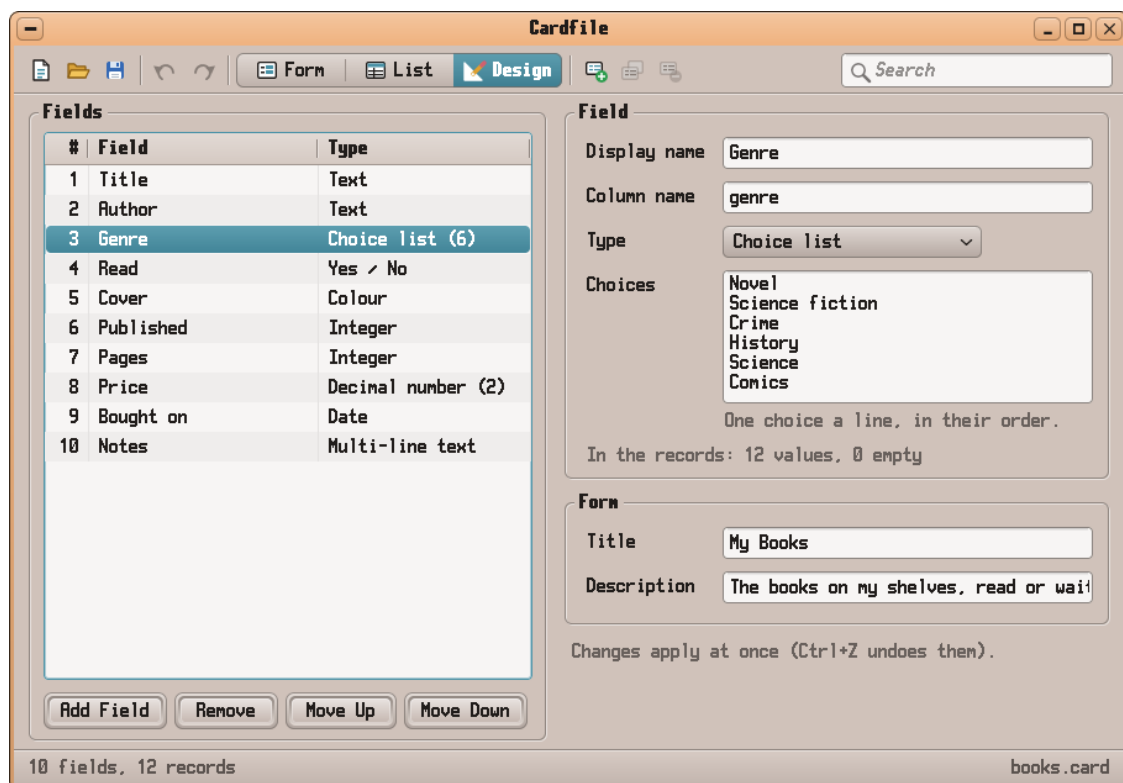
The List

view: sorted by title (the arrow), a record chosen.

The List view: the records in a grid, a column per field — the numbers on the right, a date as the form shows it, a colour's swatch and code, a check mark, a text of several lines on one line. A click on a column's name **sorts** by it, again the other way, a third time back to the file's order (also View ► In the File's Order): each type in its order — numbers, dates, a choice list in its choices' order, text without regard to case or accents and "Item 9" before "Item 10" —, empty values last; the sort is kept in the file.

Drag a column's edge to widen it. A **double click** or Enter opens the record in the form; **Delete** deletes it (asked first); a **right click**: Open in the Form, New Record, Duplicate Record, Delete Record.... The arrows, Page Up / Down, Home / End move; a letter jumps to the next record whose sorted column (else the first) starts with it; Left / Right and Shift + the wheel scroll sideways.

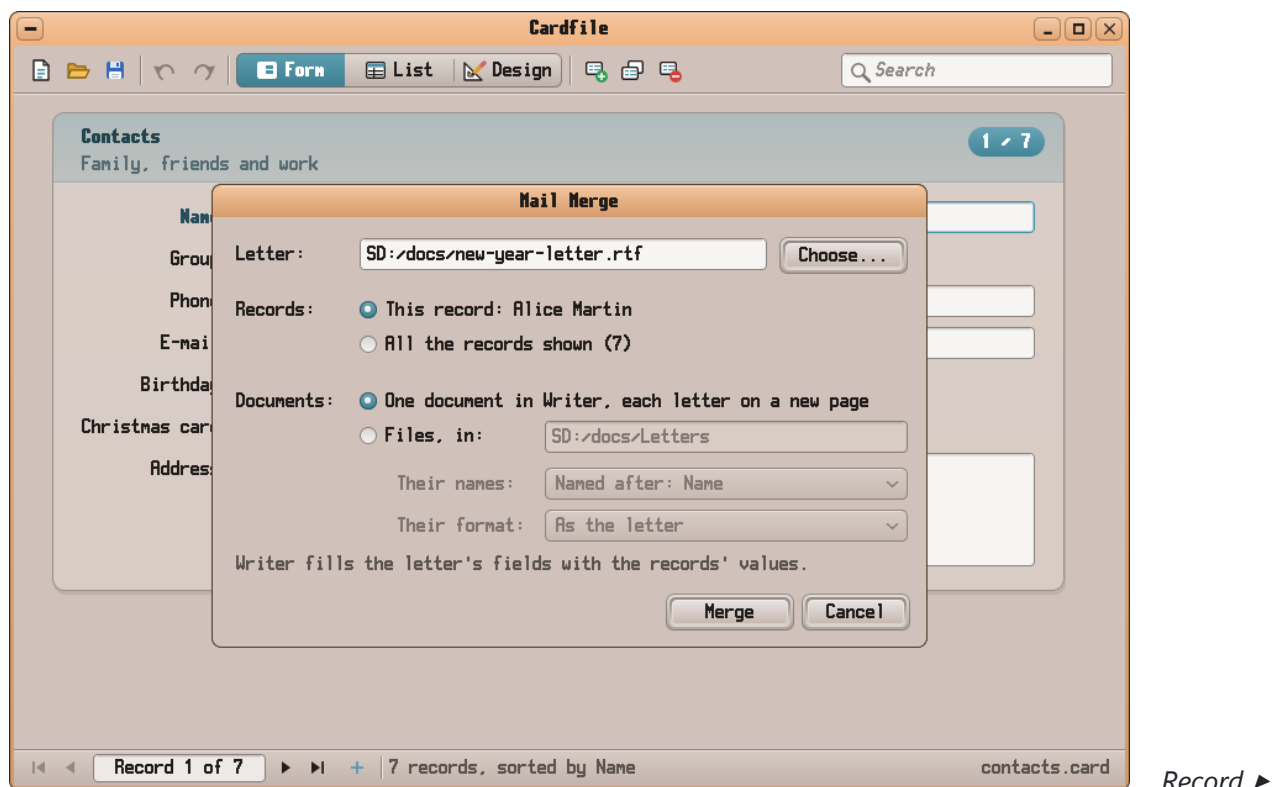
The search (Ctrl+F, or a click in the box): only the records holding **every word** typed, in any of their fields (case and accents ignored; a date as it is shown) — in the form and in the list; Esc or its cross empties it. A record made meanwhile stays shown.



The

Design view: the genre's choices.

The Design view: the form's fields in their order — **Add Field** (after the one chosen), **Remove** (asked first, with the number of values it holds; Delete in the list too), **Move Up**, **Move Down** — and the field chosen: its **display name**, its **column name** (letters, digits, `_` and `-`; made from the display name as long as it was not changed: "Date of birth" → `date_of_birth`; two fields cannot share one), its **type**, the type's option (a decimal number's **decimals**; a choice list's **choices**, one a line, in their order), what the records hold in it; then the form's **title** and **description**. **A change applies at once** (Undo takes it back). A new **type converts** the values through their text as shown: what reads as the new type stays (text → integer: "42" stays; a date → text: "29/09/2026"; a yes / no → text: "Yes" / "No"...), the rest is emptied — Cardfile asks first when some would be (3 values of "Year" are not a whole number: they will be emptied. Change the type?); to a choice list, the values become its choices. Fewer decimals round the values (said in the status bar). A value that is not among a list's choices stays (the form shows it at the end of the list).



Mail Merge... on the Contacts form: its letter, this record or all of them, one document or a file each.

The mail merge (Record ► Mail Merge...): a **Writer** letter whose **merge fields** are the form's columns (made in Writer: Tools ► Mail Merge, see *Writer*) is filled with the records — a letter per record. The dialog: the **Letter** (.rtf, .docx or .odt; **Choose...**; the form remembers it), the **Records** — **this record** or **all the records shown** (the search and the sort applied) —, the **Documents** — **one document in Writer**, each letter on a new page (to read, change, save as one file), or **files** in a folder (SD:/docs/Letters by default; made if needed) named after a field (**Named after: Name** → Alice Martin.rtf; two alike: the second numbered) or numbered after the letter (new-year-letter-1.rtf...), in the letter's format or as RTF, Word or OpenDocument. **Merge** hands it to Writer, which opens the document (or, for files, says how many it wrote and opens the first one). Cardfile writes the records to merge in SD:/apps/cardfile.app/merge.card and the request in merge.job (Writer's writer --merge JOB). Try it with the Contacts form (SD:/docs/contacts.card) and its letter SD:/docs/new-year-letter.rtf.

The menus: **File** (New Form ^N, Open... ^O, Save ^S, Save As..., Import CSV..., Export as CSV...), **Edit** (Undo ^Z, Redo ^Y — record edits, deletions and the form's design, 100 steps —, Cut, Copy, Paste, Search... ^F, Clear the Search), **Record** (New Record ^R, Duplicate Record ^D, Delete Record..., First / Previous / Next / Last Record, Go to Record... ^G, Mail Merge..., Undo the Record's Changes Esc), **View** (Form F5, List F6, Design F7, In the File's Order), **Design** (Add Field, Remove Field..., Move Field Up, Move Field Down).

Files: the .card file (below). **File ► Export as CSV...** writes the records shown (the search and the sort applied), their values as shown, the display names on the first line. **Import CSV...** (or opening a .csv) makes a new form of a CSV file (, ; or a tab between the values, quotes): its first line names the fields, each column's type is guessed from its values (whole numbers, decimals, dates, yes / no words, #RRGGBB colours, several lines, a few values repeated: a choice list; a code with a 0 before it — 007, a telephone number — stays text); File ► Save As... keeps it as a .card. New, Open and a file dropped on the window first ask to **save unsaved changes**; **closed with unsaved changes** (the close box, Quit), the form is kept

in `SD:/apps/cardfile.app/recovered.card` and offered back at the next start. `cardfile <file>` opens a file, and a `.card` double-clicked in the File Viewer opens in Cardfile (`fileassoc.ini`). Started without a file, Cardfile opens the form it had last (kept in `SD:/apps/cardfile.app/last.txt`), else a new form in the Design view (a Name and a Notes field). Samples: `SD:/docs/books.card` (every type of field) and `SD:/docs/contacts.card` (with its mail merge's letter, `SD:/docs/new-year-letter.rtf`).

The `.card` file is text (Latin-1, as Onyx writes it), easy to read and to edit by hand:

```
# Onyx Cardfile -- a form and its records (open it with Cardfile)
[form]
version = 1
title = My Books
description = The books on my shelves, read or waiting
sort = title

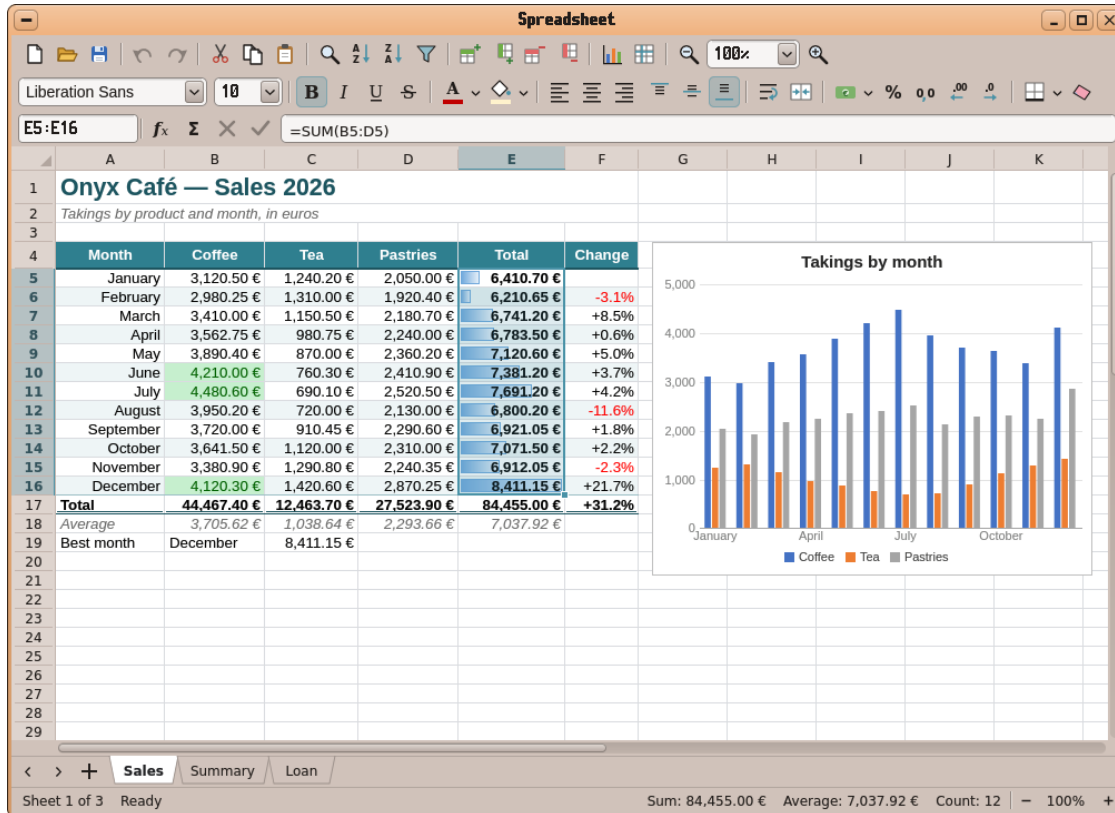
[field]
column = genre
label = Genre
type = choice
choice = Novel
choice = Science fiction

[field]
column = price
label = Price
type = decimal
decimals = 2

[records]
title  author  genre  price
Dune   Frank Herbert  Science fiction 10.90
```

[`form`]: the title, the description, the views' order (`sort` = a column; `order` = `descending`), the mail merge's letter (`merge` = `SD:/docs/letter.rtf`). A [`field`] section a field, in the form's order: `column`, `label`, `type` (`text`, `multiline`, `integer`, `decimal`, `date`, `colour`, `yesno`, `choice`), `decimals` (a decimal number: 0 to 6), `choice` (a choice list: a line a choice, in their order). [`records`]: the columns' names on the first line, then a record a line, a **tab** between its values; in a value, `\n` is a line break, `\t` a tab, `\\` a backslash. The values as kept: text as typed, integer 42, decimal 12.50, date 2026-09-29 (shown 29/09/2026), colour #3366CC, yes / no `yes` or empty, a choice's text. A line starting with `#` or `;` is a comment (not in [`records`]). Cardfile reads such a file leniently: keys in any case, the header's columns in any order (a column missing: empty values; unknown: ignored), no [`field`] at all (the header's columns become text fields), a value that is not of its type (kept as it is — the form asks for a valid one when the record is edited).

The Spreadsheet (sheet)



The

sample workbook *SD:/docs/cafe-2026.xlsx*: a café's takings by month — formats, a merged title, data bars on the totals, the three best months of coffee in green, a column chart; the Total column chosen, its sum in the status bar.

The Spreadsheet works in the way of **LibreOffice Calc** and **Gnumeric** (and of Excel, whose files it writes): a **workbook** of several **sheets** of up to 1 048 576 rows × 16 384 columns (A ... XFD), **formulas** recomputed at each change, **number formats**, fonts, colours, borders, merged cells, **charts**, **conditional formatting**, the **AutoFilter**, **defined names**.

The window, from the top:

- **Two toolbars.** The first: New, Open, Save; Undo, Redo; Cut, Copy, Paste; Find and Replace; **Sort** ascending / descending (the table around the cursor, by the cursor's column), the **AutoFilter**; insert rows above / columns before, delete rows / columns; insert a **chart**; **freeze panes**; the zoom (–, the percentage — a list —, +). The second: the **font** (each name drawn in its font) and its **size**; bold, italic, underline, strike-through; the **text colour** and the **fill colour** (the button applies the colour on its bar, its arrow drops the palette); left, centre, right; top, middle, bottom; wrap text; **merge and centre**; the **currency** format (its arrow: € \$ £ ¥ CHF), percent, the thousands' separator, a decimal more / less; the **borders** (the button applies the last ones, its arrow lists them: all, outside, thick outside, bottom, top, left, right, double bottom, thick bottom, inside, none); clear the formatting.
- **The formula bar:** the **Name Box** — the cell or the range chosen (or its name); type **B7**, **C2:F9**, **Loan!B6** or a name and Enter to go there; a new name typed there **names the selection** —, **fx** (Insert Function: the functions by category, each with its arguments and what it does), **Σ** (AutoSum: =SUM(of the numbers above the cell, else at its left; a range chosen: a total under each

of its columns), $\times$ / $\checkmark$ while a cell is typed, and the **input line**: the cell's content — its formula — shown and edited there too.

- **The grid**: a click chooses a cell, a drag a range (Shift+click extends it); a click on a column's letter or a row's number chooses it whole, the corner the whole sheet. Drag a letter's or a number's **edge** to size it, **double-click** it to fit its content. The **fill handle** — the small square at the selection's corner — dragged down or across continues a **series** (1, 2 → 3, 4...; Monday → Tuesday...; Item 9 → Item 10; dates by day or by month) or copies the cells, their formulas' references moved. The **right button**: cut, copy, paste, Paste Special, insert / delete rows or columns, clear, sort, a chart, Format Cells (on a letter / a number: the width / height, optimal width, hide, show; on a chart: its properties, delete, bring to front).
- **The sheet tabs**: a click shows a sheet, + adds one, a double click renames it, the right button: insert, delete, rename, duplicate, move left / right, the tab's colour. The arrows scroll the tabs; Ctrl+Page Up / Down go to the previous / next sheet.
- **The status bar**: the sheet, the mode (Ready, Enter, Edit, Point) and, for a range chosen, the **Sum**, **Average** and **Count** of its values (in their format when they share one); the zoom (– / +; Ctrl+wheel over the grid).

Typing. Choose a cell and type: **Enter** goes down, **Tab** right (after a row typed with Tab, Enter goes back to the column it started in), Shift+Enter / Shift+Tab back, an **arrow** finishes the cell and moves; **Esc** cancels. **F2** or a double click edits the cell in place (the arrows then move the caret; F2 again: they choose cells), **Alt+Enter** starts a new line in the cell. **Delete** clears the selection, Backspace empties the cell and edits it. What is typed is read as the spreadsheets read it: a number (1234.5, 1,234.50, 1 234, 3,5, -2e3, (42) = -42), a **percentage** (12.5%), an **amount** (\$1,200, 12,50 €), a **date** (29/09/2026, 29/9 — this year —, 2026-09-29, 29 Sep 2026, Sep 29, 2026: day first), a **time** (14:30, 2:30 PM), both, TRUE / FALSE, an error value — each keeps the format it was typed in —; anything else is **text** (a ' first: text whatever follows, '123). A long text flows over the empty cells beside it; a number too wide for its column shows #####.

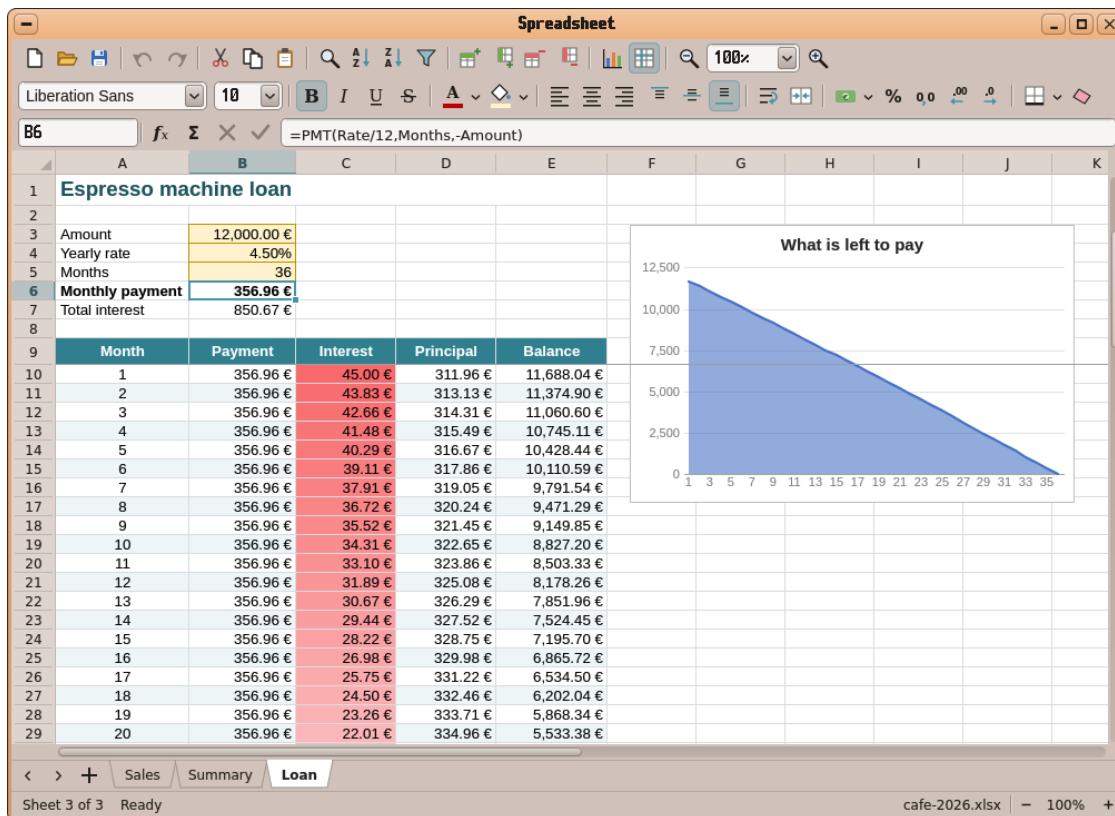
Formulas start with =: =B5*1.2, =SUM(B5:B16), =AVERAGE(Sales!E5:E16), =IF(B5>4000, "good", "low"), =VLOOKUP("Tea",A4:D16,3,FALSE). While a formula is typed, the functions whose name starts with what you type are offered (Tab or Enter takes one; ↑ / ↓ choose), then the function's **arguments** are shown, the current one in bold; each reference is **coloured**, with its cells framed in the grid in the same colour.

Pointing: after =, (, , or an operator, the **arrows** (Shift+arrows: a range) or a **click / drag** in the grid write the reference — on another sheet too: click its tab —; **F4** turns the reference at the caret A1 → \$A\$1 → A\$1 → \$A1. The operators: + - * / ^, & (text joined), = <> < > <= >=, %, : (a range); references B5, \$B\$5 (absolute: kept when copied), B5:D16, B:B (a column), 3:3 (a row), Loan!B6, 'My sheet'!A1; constants {1,2;3,4} (arrays), "text", TRUE. **237 functions**: mathematics (SUM, SUMIF(S), SUMPRODUCT, ROUND, ROUNDUP / DOWN, INT, MOD, ABS, POWER, SQRT, EXP, LN, LOG, the trigonometry, RAND, RANDBETWEEN, SUBTOTAL...), statistics (AVERAGE(IF(S)), COUNT, COUNTA, COUNTBLANK, COUNTIF(S), MIN, MAX, MINIFS, MAXIFS, MEDIAN, MODE, LARGE, SMALL, RANK, PERCENTILE, QUARTILE, STDEV, VAR, CORREL, SLOPE, INTERCEPT, FORECAST...), logic (IF, IFS, IFERROR, IFNA, AND, OR, NOT, XOR, SWITCH, CHOOSE), text (LEFT, RIGHT, MID, LEN, FIND, SEARCH, SUBSTITUTE, REPLACE, UPPER, LOWER, PROPER, TRIM, CONCAT, TEXTJOIN, TEXT, VALUE, REPT...), lookups (VLOOKUP, HLOOKUP, XLOOKUP, INDEX, MATCH, OFFSET, INDIRECT, ROW(S), COLUMN(S)...), dates (TODAY, NOW, DATE, TIME, YEAR, MONTH, DAY, WEEKDAY, WEEKNUM, EDATE, EOMONTH, DATEDIF, NETWORKDAYS, WORKDAY...), information (ISNUMBER, ISTEXT, ISBLANK, ISERROR, NA...) and finance (PMT, IPMT, PPMT, FV, PV, NPER, RATE, NPV, IRR...) — Insert Function lists them all. An array is computed element by element inside a function (=SUMPRODUCT((C5:C16>1000)*B5:B16)); a cell shows one value (no spilled arrays). A formula that cannot be read is refused with the reason, the caret at the fault; errors show as #DIV/0!, #VALUE!, #REF!, #NAME?,

#N/A, #NUM!, #CIRC! (a formula that needs its own value). **View ► Formulas** (Ctrl+`) shows the formulas instead of their values; **F9** recomputes (with **NOW**, **RAND**).

Copy, cut, paste. Copy (Ctrl+C) frames the cells with dashes; Paste (Ctrl+V) writes them at the cursor — their formulas' relative references moved, their formats, merges and (whole columns) their widths —, over a larger selection in repeats; a **Cut** moves them and the formulas that point at them follow. **Paste Special:** all, the values only, the formats only, the formulas only; transposed. Text from another app is pasted as a table (tab-separated columns, one row a line). **Fill Down / Right** (Ctrl+D / Ctrl+R) copy the selection's first row / column over the rest.

Formatting. **Format ► Cells...** (Ctrl+1) has five tabs: **Numbers** (General, Number, Currency, Percent, Scientific, Fraction, Date, Time, Text, Custom — decimals, thousands' separator, negative numbers in red, the currency; a list of formats; the **format code** itself, Excel's: #,##0.00 "€", 0.0%, dd/mm/yyyy, [Red]-0.00, 0; -0; "zero"..., with a preview of the cell's value), **Font** (family, style, size, underline, strike-through, colour), **Alignment** (horizontal, vertical, indent, wrap, merge), **Borders** (the lines of each side and inside, their style and colour, presets) and **Fill**. Row heights follow their tallest font and wrapped text unless set by hand (**Format ► Row Height**; Column Width, Optimal Column Width; Hide / Show Rows and Columns). **Merge and Centre** makes a range one cell (only the top left cell's content is kept). **View ► Freeze Panes** keeps the rows above and the columns left of the cursor in place while the rest scrolls; **View ► Gridlines** hides or shows the grid.

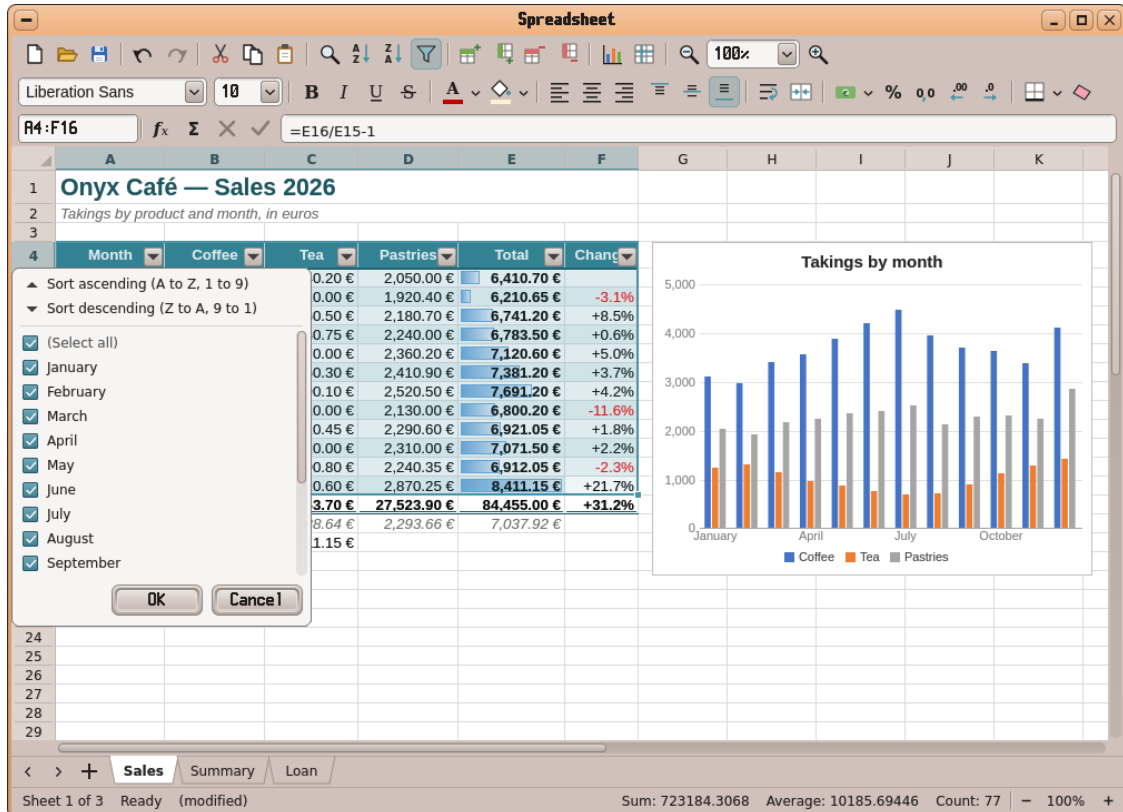


The loan

sheet: its inputs named (*Rate*, *Months*, *Amount* — the payment is `=PMT(Rate/12,Months,-Amount)`), the interest coloured by a scale, the first nine rows frozen.

Conditional formatting (Format ► Conditional Formatting...) gives cells a look by their value: the sheet's rules are listed (the first that sets a fill, a colour or bold wins; **Up / Down** order them); for each, the **cells** it covers and its kind — **Cell value is** (greater than, less than, equal to, between... a number, a text or a

formula: `=B$1, =AVERAGE($B$5:$B$16)`, **Text** (contains, does not contain, begins with, ends with), **Top / bottom** (the N highest or lowest, or N %), **Above / below the average**, **Duplicate / unique values**, **Formula is true** (written for the range's top left cell, it moves with each cell: `=F5<0` colours the whole row of a negative change, `=MOD(ROW(),2)=0` every other row) — and its **look** (light red fill with dark red text, yellow, green, red text, bold...); or a **colour scale** (two or three colours from the lowest value to the highest) or **data bars** (a bar the length of the value). **New** adds the rule, **Change** updates the one chosen, **Delete** removes it. Rows and columns inserted or deleted move the rules' cells and their formulas.



Data ►

AutoFilter on the table: a button on each header; the months' list dropped.

The AutoFilter (Data ► AutoFilter, or the funnel of the toolbar) puts a **button** on each header of a table — the selection, else the block of cells around the cursor, its first row the headers. A button drops the column's **values** (as they are shown; "(Empty)" for the empty cells): uncheck those to hide, OK; the rows whose value is unchecked are **hidden**, their row numbers turn blue and the button shows a funnel; several columns filter together (each list only shows the values the other filters leave). The same list **sorts** the table by the column (ascending / descending, the headers kept). AutoFilter again takes the buttons off and shows every row.

Names (Insert ► Names...) name a range or a value for the formulas (`=SUM(Coffee)`, `=PMT(Rate/12,Months,-Amount)`): a name, what it refers to (`=Sales!$B$5:$B$16,=0.2`), its scope (the whole workbook or one sheet); **Add** (or change), **Delete**. Typing a new name in the Name Box names the selection at once; choosing a named range shows its name there; typing a name goes to its range. Rows and columns inserted or deleted move the names' ranges as they move formulas.

Charts. Choose the data (the first row and column as names: the series, the categories — or a single cell: the table around it) and **Insert ► Chart...**: **column**, **bar**, **line**, **area**, **pie** or **scatter**, a title, the legend (right,

bottom, top, none), the series in columns or in rows, the first row / column holding names, stacked, gridlines — with a preview. The chart lies over the sheet, anchored to the cell under its top left corner (it moves when rows or columns are inserted or sized); drag it to move it, its corners to size it; double-click it (or the right button ► Chart Properties) to change it; Delete removes it. It follows its cells' values.

Sort and find. Data ► Sort...: up to three keys (a column each, ascending or descending), the first row kept as the headers or not; the toolbar's buttons sort the table around the cursor by the cursor's column. Numbers come before texts, empty cells last; the formulas of the rows moved keep pointing at their own row. **Find and Replace** (Ctrl+F): in the values shown or in the formulas, case, entire cells, this sheet or all; Find Next, Replace, Replace All. **Go To** (Ctrl+G) is the Name Box.

Rows, columns, sheets. Insert / delete rows and columns (Insert ► Rows Above, Columns Before; Sheet ► Delete Rows / Columns; Ctrl++ / Ctrl+-; the right button): the formulas everywhere follow (a reference to a deleted cell becomes #REF!). Sheets are inserted, renamed, duplicated, moved, deleted and coloured from the Sheet menu or the tabs; a formula names another sheet by its name ([Loan!B6](#)) and follows it when it is renamed or moved.

Keys: the arrows move (Shift: extend the selection; Ctrl: to the edge of the data), Home (column A), Ctrl+Home (A1), Ctrl+End (the last used cell), Page Up / Down (a screen; Alt: across), Ctrl+Page Up / Down (the sheets), Ctrl+Space / Shift+Space (the whole column / row), Ctrl+A (all); Ctrl+Z / Ctrl+Y (undo / redo, 100 steps), Ctrl+X / C / V, Ctrl+D / R, Ctrl+B / I / U, Ctrl+1 (Format Cells), Ctrl+; (today's date), Ctrl+: (the time), Ctrl+F, Ctrl+G, Ctrl+N / O / S, F2, F4, F9.

Files. File ► Save (Ctrl+S) writes Excel's [.xlsx](#) — the cells, formulas (with their last values), styles, number formats, merges, column widths and row heights, hidden rows and columns, frozen panes, tab colours, charts, conditional formats, the AutoFilter and the names: Excel, LibreOffice and Gnumeric open it. **File ► Open** (Ctrl+O) reads [.xlsx](#) (from Excel, LibreOffice, Google Sheets...), LibreOffice's [.ods](#) (with its styles, number formats, merges, charts, conditional formats, AutoFilter and names; saved again as [.xlsx](#)) and **CSV** / [.tsv](#) / [.txt](#) (the separator — comma, semicolon or tab — guessed; UTF-8 or Latin-1; each field read as if typed). **File ► Export as CSV** (or Save As [name.csv](#)) writes the sheet shown, its values as shown. A double click on an [.xlsx](#), [.ods](#) or [.csv](#) file in the File Viewer opens it here ([fileassoc.ini](#)); a file dropped on the window too. New, Open and a drop first ask to save unsaved changes; **closed with unsaved changes**, the workbook is kept in [SD:/apps/sheet.app/recovered.xlsx](#) and offered back the next time the Spreadsheet starts. Not kept: fonts' exotic effects, pictures, pivot tables, macros, comments, validation lists (the rest of an Excel file is read). Sample: [SD:/docs/cafe-2026.xlsx](#) (its three sheets: the sales, a summary with lookups and a pie chart, the espresso machine's loan).

Games

Game	Goal and controls
tetris	Stack the pieces. Arrows: left/right/rotate/drop; Space : instant drop; r : restart.
snake	Eat to grow. Arrows: steer (no U-turn); r : restart.
2048	Merge the tiles. Arrows: slide the whole board; r : restart.
minesweeper	Minesweeper. Left-click : reveal; right-click : flag; r : restart.

Game	Goal and controls
sokoban	Push each box onto a target. Arrows: move/push; r : restart the level; n : next level. (levels in <code>levels.txt</code>)
pong	Two players. Left: w/S ; right: up/down arrows; first to 9; r : reset.
life	Game of Life. Click/drag : (de)populate cells; Space : run/pause; s : one step; c : clear; r : random.
same	SameGame. Click a group of ≥ 2 same colors to destroy it (collapse); r : new board.
Solitaire	Klondike. Drag cards: the seven columns build down in alternating colours (a king on an empty column), the four foundations up by suit from the ace. Click the stock to turn one card (or three: Game ► Draw Three); an empty stock turns the waste over again. Double-click sends a card to its foundation, right-click sends every card that can go. Hidden cards turn over by themselves. ^Z undo, ^N deal. Windows scoring + timer; the cards bounce when you win.
FreeCell	All the cards face up in eight columns, four free cells (top left, one card each), four foundations (top right). Drag cards: a column takes a card one lower in the other colour (anything on an empty column); a run moves at once when free cells and empty columns allow it. Double-click : to the foundation, else to a free cell. Cards no longer needed go home by themselves. ^Z undo; Game ► Select Game... plays deal 1–32000 — the same deals as Microsoft FreeCell; Restart Game.
Pipes	After <i>Pipe Dream</i> : lay pipe pieces before the water comes. The next pieces wait in the queue on the left (the bottom one goes next); click a square (or arrows + Space) to put it there — on an unfilled piece it replaces it (–50). When the countdown (the blue bar) runs out the water leaves the red valve: 50 points per

Game	Goal and controls
	piece it crosses, 500 more for a cross used both ways. If it went through the required number of pieces (top right) when it spills, the round is won. F : let the water run now, fast (double points). Walls from round 3, faster water every round. P pause.
Arkanoid	Written in BASIC (<code>main.bax</code> , from <code>SD:/basic/examples/arkanoid.bas</code>), in <code>SCREEN 13</code> shown full screen (F : a window, and back). Break the bricks. The paddle follows the mouse or the <code>←/→</code> arrows (held); Space or a click launches the ball (and fires, with the laser). Silver bricks take several hits, gold ones never break. Catch the falling capsules: E longer paddle, S slower ball, C catch the ball, L laser, D three balls, P extra life. 5 rounds (then again, faster), 3 lives. P pause, Esc title / quit. No file read or written.
Planets 3D	Written in BASIC (<code>main.bax</code> , from <code>SD:/basic/examples/planets3d.bas</code>): a little solar system in 3D, drawn by the GPU — the sun, four planets turning on their orbits, a moon, a ringed gas giant, stars; the planets' textures are drawn by the program itself. Arrows turn the camera, + / - nearer / farther, Space pause, F full screen, Esc quit. The top line says GPU or software and the frames a second. No file read or written.
Invaders	Space Invaders. <code>←/→</code> (held) or the mouse move the cannon; Space or a click fires (one shot at a time). The fleet marches faster as it thins out (the four-note march on the synth); the shields crumble; the red saucer is worth 50–300. An invader reaching the ground ends the game. P pause.
Teapot (GPU) (<code>teapot</code>)	The demo of the Raspberry Pi 4's GPU (V3D): the Utah teapot turning, lit (6400 triangles), drawn by the GPU with a depth buffer. The top line shows the renderer (V3D 4.2 (1 core)), the

Game	Goal and controls
	triangles, the frames a second and the time of one frame. Space pause, G GPU / software (the same picture drawn by the CPU, to compare), Up / Down tilt. Without a usable GPU it draws in software and the top line says why (the details are in kmsg). Reads and writes no file.
GPU demo (gpudemo)	The GPU's full pipeline: six textured cubes turning (each moved by the GPU with its own matrix), a glass pane in front (transparency) and glowing sparks (additive light). Each cube's texture has a size that the GPU stores differently (its label: 4x4 LT, 8x8 UB1, 16x16 UB2, 64x64 UIF, 256 UIF/XOR, 100x60 UIF); every face should show a white border, a yellow dot in a corner and a dark arrow — a scrambled face means that layout is wrong. F nearest / linear filtering, C culling (back / none / front: with <i>back</i> only the outer faces show), B blending on / off, T textures on / off, Space pause. The top line: the GPU, the settings, frames a second, time of a frame (and the error, if the GPU refused a frame). Reads and writes no file.
Doom (doom)	id Software's Doom (the GPL source, through doomgeneric). Onyx ships Freedoom Phase 1 (SD:/doom/freedoom1.wad, free content); copy your own doom.wad, doom2.wad, doom1.wad (shareware), plutonia.wad or tnt.wad into SD:/doom to play the original — the first found is used. Opening a .wad in the File Viewer starts Doom with it (a mod — a PWAD — is loaded over the game). Arrows move, Ctrl fires, Space opens / uses, Alt + arrows or , / strafe, Shift runs, 1–7 weapons, Tab the map, Esc the menu, F1–F10 as in DOS Doom (F2 save, F3 load...). USB gamepad: d-pad, A fire, B use, X run, L / R strafe, Start menu, Select map. The picture is Doom's 320

Game	Goal and controls
	× 200 doubled in a 640 × 400 window; F11 / Game ► Full Screen stretches it to the display at 4:3. Sound effects and music (MUS or MIDI) on the Onyx synthesizer's FM voices with the WAD's own OPL instruments (GENMIDI), like the DOS version on an AdLib / Sound Blaster. Settings in <code>SD:/doom/default.cfg</code>, saved games in <code>SD:/doom/savegame/<iwad>/</code>. Loading a 28 MB WAD takes a couple of seconds. The game runs on an app core (core 2 or 3) when one is free: steadier, and the rest of Onyx stays fluid.
Game Library (<code>gamelib</code>)	A "Netflix for ROMs", laid out as the File Viewer: every GameCube (<code>.iso</code> / <code>.gcm</code>), Nintendo 64 (<code>.z64</code> / <code>.n64</code> / <code>.v64</code>), Super Nintendo (<code>.sfc</code> / <code>.smc</code>), Game Boy Advance (<code>.gba</code>), Game Boy Color (<code>.gbc</code>), Game Boy (<code>.gb</code>) and NES (<code>.nes</code>) game of the watched folders (<code>SD:/roms</code> by default) and their sub-folders, one card each — a picture of its title screen and its name (a Nintendo 64 game: a label with the name from its header; a GameCube disc: its banner). On the left, the sidebar (click a group's title to fold it): Library ► All Games, Systems — the emulators, each with its icon and its number of games: click one to see its games only — and Folders (the watched folders and their games; Add Folder...; right-click one: Show, Show in File Viewer, Remove Folder). Above, the path bar (<i>Game Library ► Super Nintendo</i>, the number of games; click <i>Game Library</i> for all of them); below, the status bar (the game chosen, the picture being made). The cards: one section per system; click one to select it, double-click it (or Enter) to play; right-click: Play, Play Full Screen, Show in File Viewer. Keys: arrows, Enter, Page Up / Down, Tab = the next system. With a gamepad: the d-pad moves, Start (or A) plays, L / R the previous / next

Game	Goal and controls
	system, L2 / R2 turn a page. The pictures are made in the background the first time (each game runs a few seconds unseen; the games shown first) and cached in <code>SD:/apps/gamelib.app/thumbs/</code>. Library ► Refresh (^R) finds new ROMs. Several folders are watched, on any volume (e.g. <code>SD1:/roms</code> on an exFAT partition): the sidebar's Add Folder... / Folders ► Add Folder... (the folder dialog), Folders ► Remove — kept in <code>SD:/apps/gamelib.app/config.ini</code>, one <code>folder = <path></code> line each (63 characters at most); View ► All Games / a system, Play Full Screen On / Off. The emulators are in no menu of the desktop (their <code>category</code> is <code>Emulators</code>): the Game Library starts the right one for a game (and an emulator started without a ROM opens the Game Library).
Super Nintendo (snesemu)	The Super Nintendo / Super Famicom emulator. Opening a <code>.sfc</code> / <code>.smc</code> file starts it (<code>SD:/etc/runners.ini</code>); without a ROM it opens the Game Library. Arrows D-pad, X = A, Z = B, S = X, A = Y, Q = L, W = R, Enter = Start, Backspace = Select (held), P pause; or a USB gamepad (the buttons by place, as on a Super Nintendo pad: right = A, bottom = B, top = X, left = Y, the shoulders L / R). View ► Full Screen (F11; Esc back), Zoom 1x/2x/3x, Region: NTSC (60 Hz) / PAL (50 Hz) (read from the ROM's header: a European game runs at 50 Hz), Show Speed (F12); Sound ► On / Off; Game ► Reset. The cartridge's battery RAM (e.g. Zelda: A Link to the Past's three files) is <code><rom>.sav</code> beside the ROM (written every 5 s after a change and on exit). Games with an enhancement chip in the cartridge (Super FX: Star Fox, Yoshi's Island; SA-1: Super Mario RPG; DSP-1: Super Mario Kart, Pilotwings...) are not

Game	Goal and controls
	supported: a message says so. Runs on an app core when one is free, like the other emulators.
GameCube (gcemu)	The Nintendo GameCube emulator — just started: the console's CPU (checked instruction by instruction against a reference) and chips, the graphics by the GPU, the start of a disc through its own loader; the sound (the game's audio stream and the Zelda games' music; Sound ► Sound On / Off — AX games are still silent) and a memory card in slot A, kept as <game>.sav beside the disc image (the same file as NintendoEMU's on the PC: a save moves between them), and its CPU is recompiled to the Pi's own code as it runs (a JIT: the integer, floating point and paired-single code; the rarer instructions still go through the interpreter — the speed on real games is being worked on: The Wind Waker, a PAL disc, runs at ~46-49 fields a second of its 50 on Outset (~23-24 frames a second of its 25: smooth on a TV), 50 in the lighter scenes; a sound that stutters is the game running below real time; a Pi 4 without a fan slows down above ~80 °C). Opening a .iso / .gcm disc image or a .dol program starts it (the disc is read from the file as the game asks, not loaded); the Game Library shows the discs with their banner. Arrows the stick, X = A, C = B, S = X, A = Y, Z = Z, Enter = Start, Q / W = L / R, I J K L the C stick, T F G H the D-pad, P pause; or a USB gamepad. The pictures are drawn by the GPU with the console's TEV turned into GPU shaders (every stage of its colour combiner computed as the console does, the textures, the alpha test — the fog, the indirect textures and the render-to-texture effects not yet); View ► TEV Shaders On / Off goes back to the older, simpler drawing (one texture, the colours

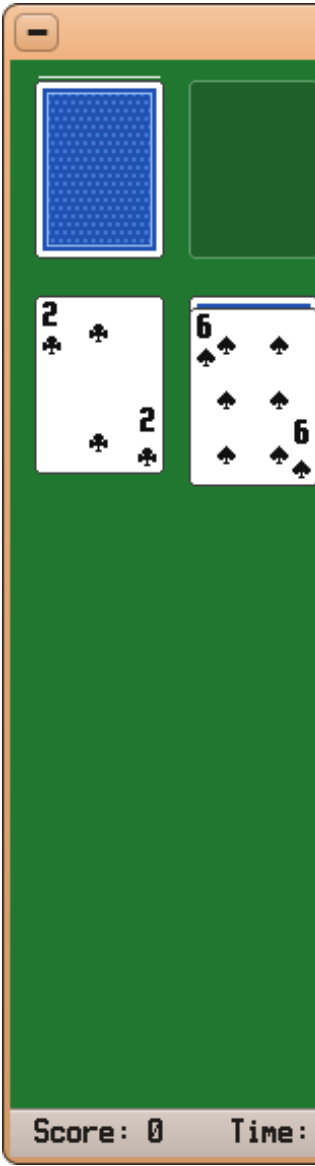
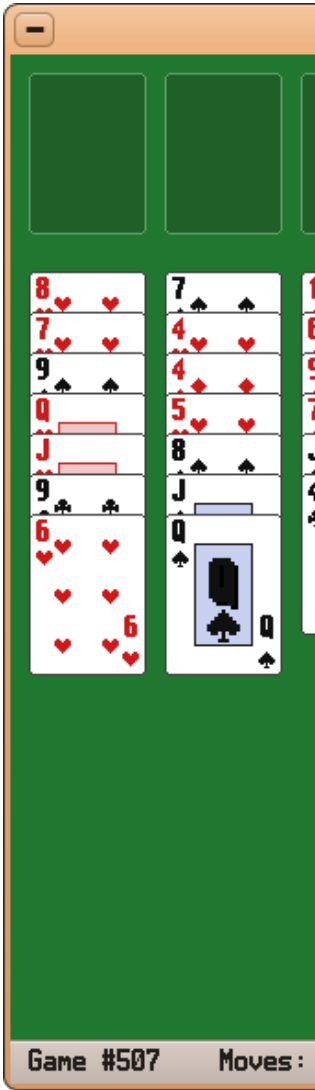
Game	Goal and controls
	computed per vertex). View ► Full Screen (F11), Size 640 × 480 / 960 × 720, Show FPS (F10): the game's frames a second and its speed against real time, in a corner), Show Speed (F12): fields/s, JIT or interpreter, TEV and the number of shaders made, or GPU; with the TEV shaders a third line tells what the graphics card did with the frame — useful in a problem report — and a fourth where the time goes: the graphics commands, the textures, the vertices, the second core's share, and the frame's drawing), Dump the Frame (TEV) (F9): the frame shown saved into <code>SD:/gcdump/frame_<n>.gxf</code>, for the developers; <code>gcemu <disc> --diag</code> does it by itself: the speed lines every second into <code>SD:/gcdump/diag.txt</code>, a frame every 60 s, and it quits after 200 s). Game ► Interpreter (no JIT) (or <code>--interp</code>) runs the plain interpreter, to compare. Runs on an app core when one is free, its graphics commands on a second one when there is one (<code>netcore=0</code> in <code>SD:/cmdline.txt</code> leaves both cores to the apps; <code>--gxone</code> keeps them on one); <code>--pmu</code>, <code>--jitprof</code> (with <code>--diag</code>), <code>--statlog</code> (the speed lines every second into <code>SD:/gcdump/statlog.txt</code>, for as long as it runs) and <code>--nodraw</code> are measures for the developers.
Nintendo 64 (<code>n64emu</code>)	The Nintendo 64 emulator — in progress: the CPU and the console's chips are emulated, the graphics are drawn by the GPU (at the window's size, sharper than the console), the sound of Zelda Ocarina of Time / Majora's Mask is played (other games run silent for now; Sound ► Sound On / Off) and some effects are still approximate (the title screen of Ocarina of Time shows; the rest is being worked on). Opening a <code>.z64</code> / <code>.n64</code> / <code>.v64</code> file starts it; without a ROM it opens the Game Library. Arrows the stick, X = A, C = B, Z = Z, Enter =

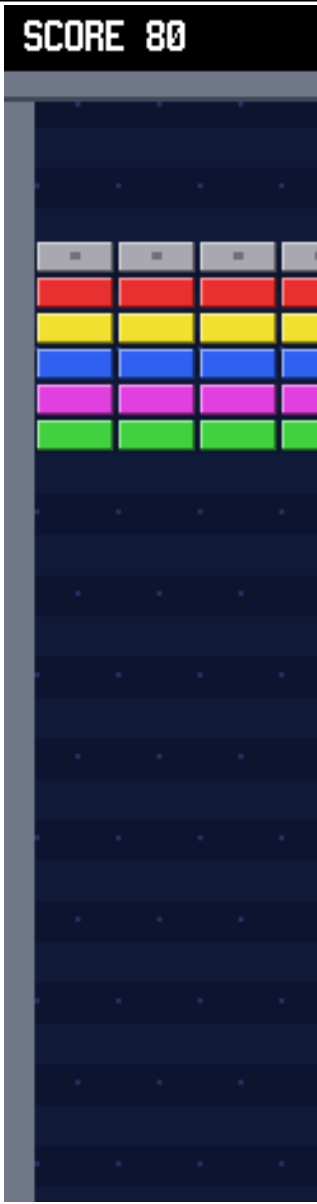
Game	Goal and controls
	Start, Q / W = L / R, I J K L the C buttons, T F G H the D-pad, P pause; or a USB gamepad (left stick, A = A, X = B, L2 / R2 = Z, L / R, Start, the right stick = the C buttons, the D-pad). View ► Full Screen (F11; Esc back, 4:3 centred, drawn by the GPU straight on the screen at its resolution), Zoom 1x/2x/3x (the window's frame follows), Show Speed (F12: frames a second, the time of a frame, GPU, software or framebuffer, the sound queued, the core), Draw with the GPU On / Off (off: the 3D is drawn by the processor, slowly — to tell a graphics-card problem from another one); Game ► Reset. The cartridge's save (SRAM / EEPROM) is <rom>.sav beside the ROM. Runs on an app core when one is free.
NES (nesemu)	The NES / Famicom emulator. Opening a .nes file starts it (SD:/etc/runners.ini); without a ROM it opens the Game Library. Arrows D-pad, X = A, Z = B, Enter = Start, Backspace = Select (held), P pause; or a USB gamepad (right / top face button = A, bottom / left = B, Start, Select). View ► Full Screen (F11; Esc back), Zoom 1x/2x/3x, Region: NTSC (60 Hz) / PAL (50 Hz) — guessed from the ROM's header, or its name ((Europe), (E), (PAL), (France)...): a European game runs at its real speed; Show Speed (F12); Sound ► On / Off; Game ► Reset. The cartridge's battery save (e.g. Zelda's three files) is <rom>.sav beside the ROM (8 KB, written every 5 s after a change and on exit). Cartridges supported: mappers 0 (NROM), 1 (MMC1), 2 (UxROM), 3 (CNROM), 4 (MMC3), 7 (AxCROM), 66 (GxROM) — most of the library (Super Mario Bros. 1-3, Zelda, Metroid, Mega Man, Castlevania, Punch-Out!!...); another one says which mapper it needs. Runs on an app core when one is free, like the

Game	Goal and controls
	other emulators.
Game Boy Advance (gbaemu)	The Game Boy Advance emulator. Opening a <code>.gba</code> file starts it (<code>SD:/etc/runners.ini</code>); without a ROM it opens the Game Library. Arrows D-pad, X = A, Z = B, A = L, S = R, Enter = Start, Backspace = Select, P pause; or a USB gamepad (right / top face button = A, bottom / left = B, the shoulders L / R). View ► Full Screen (F11), Zoom 1x/2x/3x/4x, Show Speed (F12); Sound ► On / Off; Game ► Reset. The cartridge's save (SRAM, Flash or EEPROM, recognised from the ROM) is <code><rom>.sav</code> beside the ROM. No BIOS file is needed (its functions are built in). A 16 MB ROM takes a few seconds to load: the window opens at once with a loading screen (the ROM's name and a progress bar). The console runs on an app core (core 2 or 3) when one is free, so the rest of Onyx stays fluid and a slow picture does not slow the game; Show Speed then ends with <code>core N</code>.
Game Boy (gbemu)	The Game Boy / Game Boy Color emulator. Opening a <code>.gb</code> / <code>.gbc</code> file (the Game Library, the File Viewer, run <code>SD:/roms/x.gbc</code>) starts it (<code>SD:/etc/runners.ini</code>); without a ROM it opens the Game Library. Arrows D-pad, X = A, Z = B, Enter = Start, Backspace = Select (held), P pause; or a USB gamepad (right / top face button = A, bottom / left = B, Start, Select). View ► Show Speed (F12): frames emulated and shown per second, the time of one emulated / shown frame, the sound queued, and <code>core N</code> when the console runs on an app core (core 2 or 3, when one is free: the game is then never slowed by the picture or the rest of Onyx). View ► Full Screen (F11; Esc back): stretched to the whole display with the proportions kept, centred; Zoom 1x/2x/3x/4x in a window; Palette Green / Grey / Pocket (Game

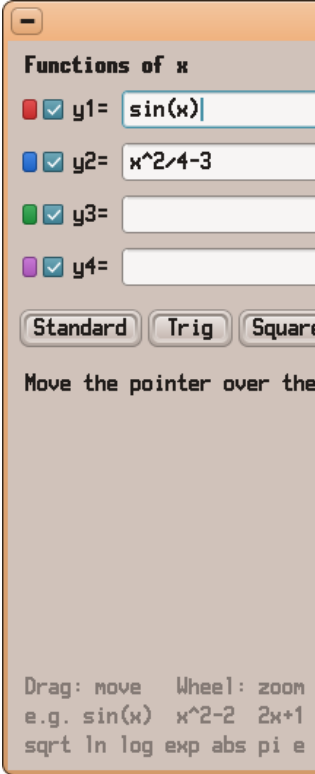
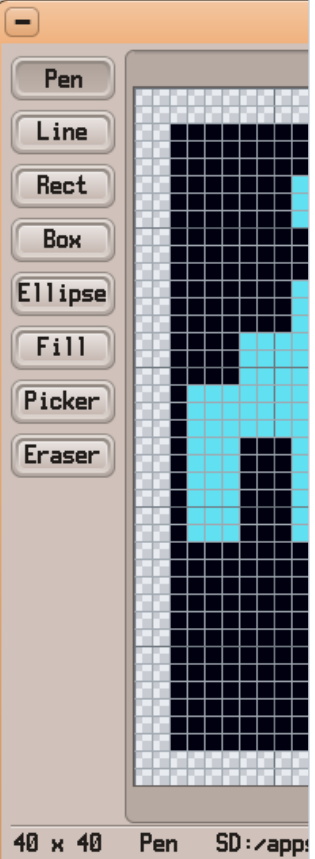
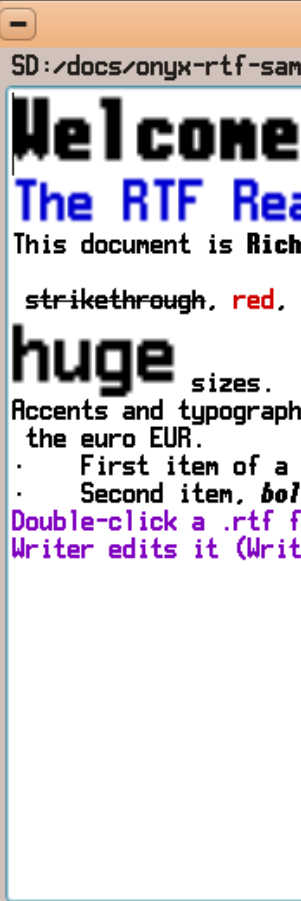
Game	Goal and controls
	Boy games); Sound ► On / Off; Game ► Reset. The cartridge's battery save is <code><rom>.sav</code> beside the ROM (read at start, written every 5 s after a change and on exit). <code>gbemu <rom> --fullscreen</code> starts full screen. The window opens at once with a loading screen (the ROM's name and a progress bar) while the ROM is read. No ROM ships with Onyx: copy your own dumps to <code>SD:/roms</code> .

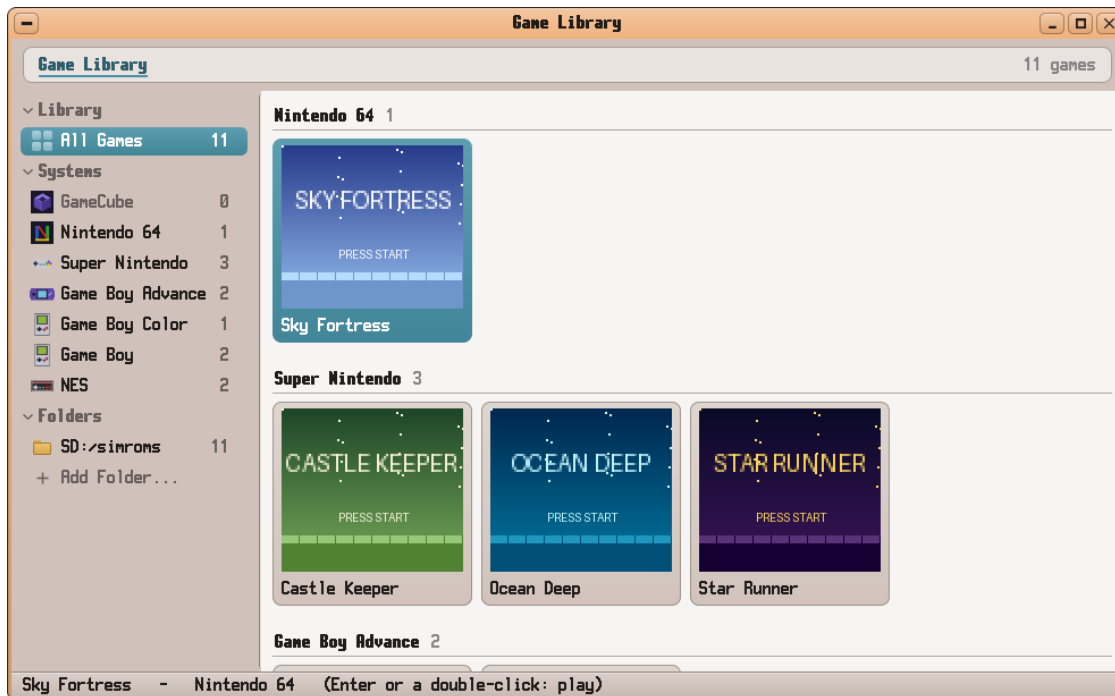
The new games, rendered by their real drawing code on a PC (`tools/tests/run_games_test.sh`):

		
<i>Solitaire (Klondike)</i>	<i>FreeCell — deal #1</i>	<i>Pipes</i>

		
<i>Arkanoid</i>	<i>Invaders</i>	

And the new tools (their graph / canvas / document areas, rendered the same way):

		
<i>Graphing Calculator — trace</i>	<i>Icon Editor</i>	<i>RTF Reader</i>



The

Game Library: the systems in the sidebar (their number of games), All Games shown by system (sample games, made up for the picture).

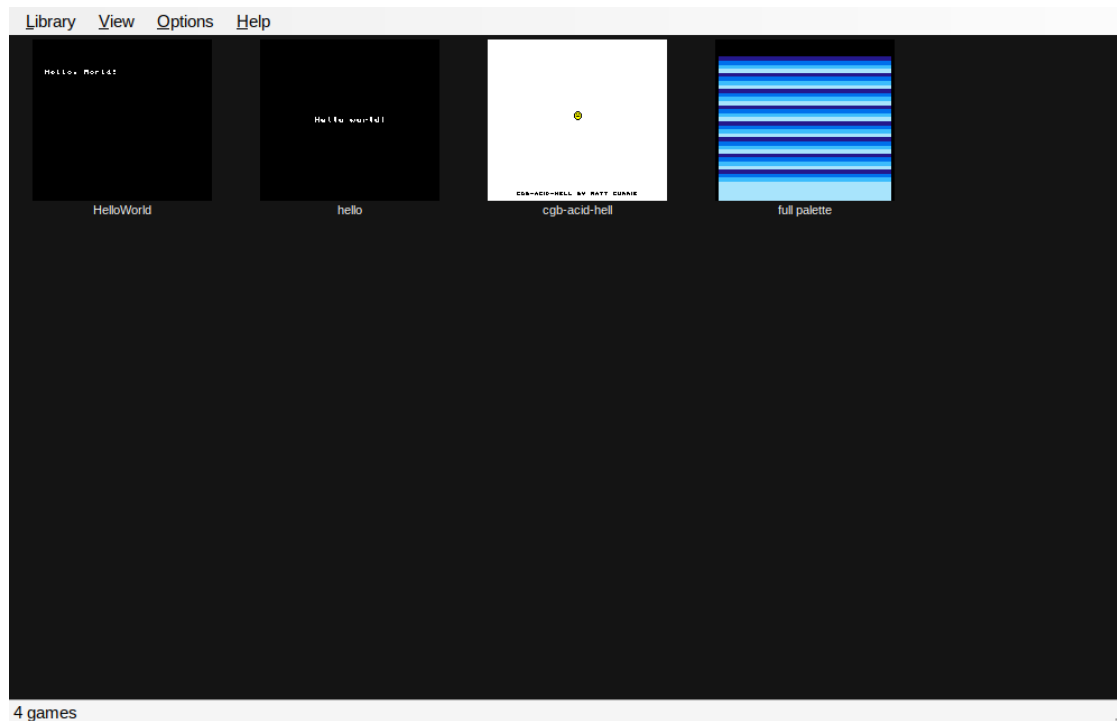
The emulators on a Windows PC (NintendoEMU)

`pc/dist/` also holds **NintendoEMU** (Windows 10 / 11, .NET Framework 4.8 — already there): the Onyx emulators — Game Boy / Color, Game Boy Advance, NES, Super Nintendo, Nintendo 64 and GameCube, **the same cores** as on the Pi — in one program with a library of your games. Keep `NintendoEMU.exe`, `NintendoEMU.exe.config` and `nemucore.dll` together and start `NintendoEMU.exe`.

- **The library:** Library ► **Add Games...** (Ctrl+O, several files at once), **Add Folder...** (Ctrl+Shift+O: every game of a folder and its sub-folders), or drop files / folders on the window. Only the **paths** are kept — in `library.txt` beside the program (or in `%APPDATA%\NintendoEMU` if that folder cannot be written), one a line; the games stay where they are. A tile per game, one section per system, with a picture: a 2D game is run ~7 s unseen and its screen kept, a Nintendo 64 game gets a label with its name, a GameCube disc its banner (cached in `thumbs\`; View ► **Refresh Pictures** makes them again). **Del** removes a game from the library (not from the disk); View ► Tiles / Details.
- **Playing:** double-click, **Enter**, or a gamepad's **Start / A** (the d-pad moves in the library). Keys as on Onyx (Help ► Controls...): arrows, **X / Z** (A / B), **Enter** Start, **Backspace** Select, **A S Q W** for Y, X, L, R... (N64 / GameCube: **C** = B, **Z** = Z, **I J K L** the C buttons / stick, **T F G H** the D-pad). **Xbox-style pads** (XInput) work, the buttons by their place as on Onyx; **other USB pads** (DirectInput / HID ones) too, with Options ► **Gamepad...**: each button of the Onyx pad (Up... Start, named after its place) gets a button, an axis end or a hat direction of the pad ("Set", then press it; a lamp shows what is held), and the sticks an axis each (kept in `settings.ini`). **P** pause, **F11** or **Alt+Enter** full screen (**Esc** back), **F12** the speed, **Ctrl+R** reset, Ctrl+W close; View ► Size 1x–5x, Smooth Picture; Sound ► On / Off.
- **Saves:** `<game>.sav` beside the game — the **same files as on Onyx**, so a save can go from the Pi to the PC and back. A GameCube disc's `<game>.sav` is its **memory card** (slot A, 251 blocks, made

and formatted the first time; a card image from Dolphin — a `.raw` of 59 to 2043 blocks — can be copied over it).

- **3D** (Nintendo 64, GameCube): drawn by the PC's graphics card with **OpenGL** (Nintendo 64: 2.0 or later, at the window's size); View ► **3D Renderer** ► Software uses the BASIC 3D's renderer on every core of the processor instead — also the fallback when OpenGL is missing. With OpenGL, F12's speed shows in the title bar. A **GameCube** game (OpenGL 3.3) is drawn by the graphics card the way the console draws: its lighting, its colour combiner (the TEV: the cel shading of The Wind Waker), fog, transparency, the effects made by copying the picture into textures (blur, glow), at **1–4 × the console's resolution** (View ► 3D Resolution: 2 × by default). The first time a new effect shows, the picture may pause a moment while the graphics card prepares it (only once: the card keeps it). A laptop with two graphics cards: View ► 3D Renderer ► **Use the High-Performance Graphics Card** (Windows' own setting for NintendoEMU; it applies the next time NintendoEMU starts).
- **GameCube**: its CPU is **recompiled** to the PC's own code as it runs (a JIT), so games run at full speed on a recent PC; **sound** for the games on the "Zelda" sound microcode (The Wind Waker...) — the games on Nintendo's usual one (AX) are silent for now; the memory card above. A key pressed briefly moves a menu's cursor by one (the game repeats it when held).



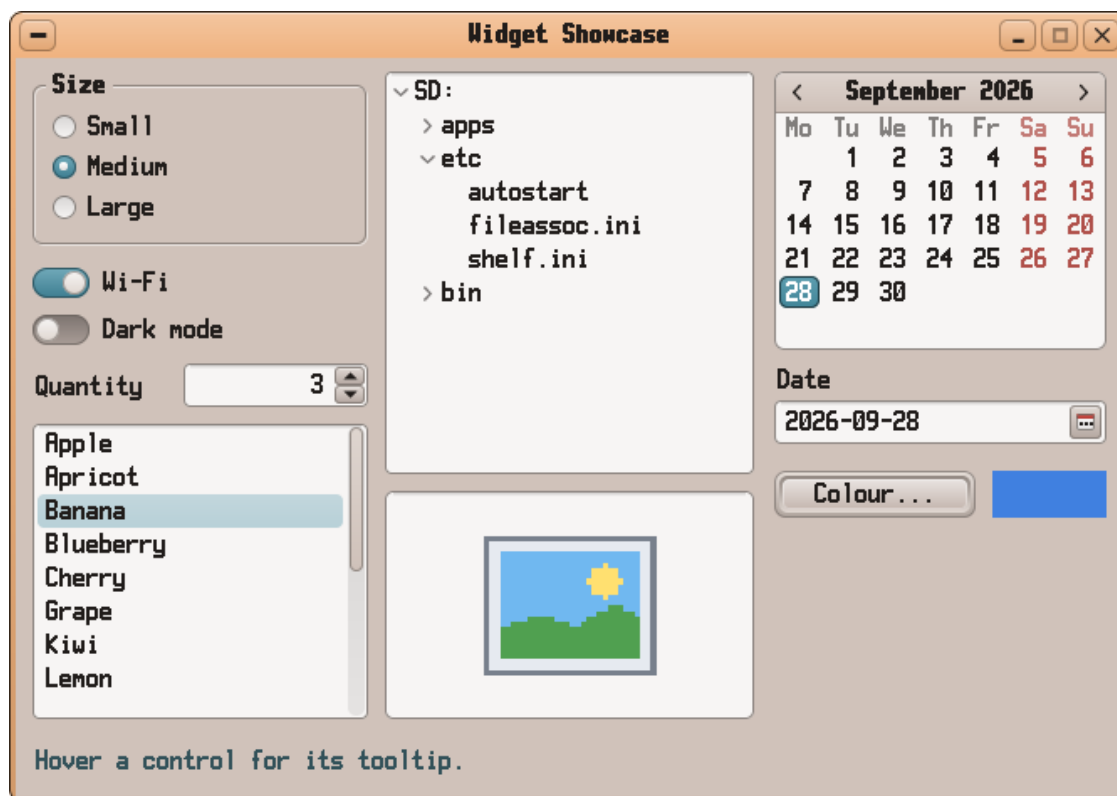
NintendoEMU's library (test ROMs): a picture per game, taken from the game itself.

Demos (technical examples)

plasma — a full-screen plasma animation (the demo of full-screen apps): the desktop disappears while it runs; **Esc**, **Enter**, **q** or a click quits and brings it back.

Demo	Shows
demoA	Bouncing box (direct framebuffer access + file reading).
demoB	Animated color field (multitasking).

Demo	Shows
demoC	Fire effect; "Color" button to cycle the palette.
demoD	Widget gallery (label, textbox, checkbox, button, slider, progress bar).
demoE	Multi-line textarea + scrolling view with scrollbars.
demoF	Small borderless launcher (buttons A–E that launch the other demos).
widgets (Widget Showcase)	The WPF-style wtk controls: radio buttons in a group box, toggle switches, a numeric up/down, a list box, a tree view, a calendar and a date picker, an image box, the colour dialog (Colour...), and tooltips (rest the pointer on a control). The bottom line reports each event.
basicdemo (BASIC Demo)	An app written in BASIC (<code>main.bas</code> , run by <code>/bin/basic</code>): a text box and Say hello (a notification), a click counter and a progress bar, and concentric circles whose colour (drop-down), size (slider) and fill (check box) follow the controls. Open it in QBasic to read it.
cppdemo	C++/OO example: a class hierarchy with virtual draw, objects created with <code>new</code> (user allocator), global constructor — proves the C++ app toolchain.
spin	Preemption test: a CPU hog that never yields . On a purely cooperative kernel it freezes the whole machine; with preemptive scheduling the rest of the UI (cursor, panel, other apps) stays responsive while it spins. It cannot be closed by its window (it never checks for the close) — stop it from taskman .



The

Widget Showcase: group box + radio buttons, toggles, numeric up/down, list box, tree view (with a tooltip), image box, calendar, date picker and the colour button.

13. Programming in BASIC

Onyx has a **BASIC in the style of QBasic**: the **QBasic** editor (`qbasic`, category *Productivity*), the runtime `/bin/basic`, and apps written in BASIC. Programs are compiled to bytecode and run by a small virtual machine. The full list of keywords is in **Help ► Keywords** (`SD:/apps/qbasic.app/help.txt`). **Compiled programs: Run ► Make .bax** writes `<program>.bax`, the bytecode, which starts without parsing and runs like a `.bas` (File Viewer, `CHAIN`); **File ► Make App** can make a compiled app (`main.bax`); in a terminal `basic -c prog.bas` writes `prog.bax`. The editor shows the code in light grey on blue, as QBasic did. Examples are in `SD:/basic/examples` (**File ► Examples...**): `hello`, `guess`, `subs`, `files`, `graphics`, `gui` and `arkanoid.bas`, a full brick breaker in `SCREEN 13` shown with `FULLSCREEN` (arrows or the mouse move the paddle, Space / click launches and fires, P pause, F full screen on / off, Esc title / quit; capsules E expand, S slow, C catch, L laser, D three balls, P a life; it reads and writes no file).

Onyx BASIC on a Windows PC

`pc/dist/` holds **Onyx BASIC for Windows** (Windows 10 / 11, nothing to install): the same compiler and virtual machine, to write and try programs on a PC. Copy the folder (keep `OnyxBasic.exe`, `OnyxBasic.exe.config` and `obcore.dll` together) and start `OnyxBasic.exe`:

- **The editor** works like `qbasic`: one module at a time (the main module, each `SUB / FUNCTION`); **View ► SUBs...** (F2), **Edit ► New SUB...** (or type `SUB Name` + Enter, as in QBasic); **Run ► Start** (F5) checks the syntax and runs the program, an error jumps to its line; the language's words are capitalised when you leave a line. Every command is in the menus (**File**, **Edit**, **View**, **Run**, **Options**, **Help**); files are saved in Latin-1 with Onyx line ends, ready for the SD card. **File ► Make App...**

writes `apps/<name>.app` into the SD folder (as source or compiled); **Run ► Make .bax** compiles the program, and the runtime runs `.bax` files as well.

- **SD:/** is a folder of the PC: **Options ► SD Folder...** (by default the repository's `sdcard/` when `pc/dist` is used in place), so programs that read files run unchanged.
- **The program's window** shows the screen scaled (320-wide modes doubled, proportions kept), with BASIC's controls as Windows controls; its menu: **Program ► Stop / Restart, View ► Full screen / Zoom**. `FULLSCREEN` does nothing on the PC; `LAUNCH / EXEC` (Onyx apps) are not available; `SHELL` runs a Windows command.

The editor (qbasic)

- As in QBasic, the program is split into **modules** edited one at a time: the **main module** and each **SUB / FUNCTION**. The line above the text says which one is shown. **View ► SUBs...** (**Ctrl-L**) lists them (**Edit** opens one, **Delete** removes it); **Edit ► New SUB... / New FUNCTION...** asks for a name and creates it. On disk the program is one ordinary `.bas` text file (the main module, then every SUB / FUNCTION).
- **Run ► Start (Ctrl-R)** checks the syntax — an error opens the right module on the right line, with the message in the status bar — then runs the program in its own window. A runtime error comes back the same way. **Run ► Check Syntax (Ctrl-K)** only checks.
- **File:** New (**Ctrl-N**), Open... (**Ctrl-O**), Examples..., Save (**Ctrl-S**), Save As..., **Make App...** (below). **Edit ► Go to Line...** (**Ctrl-G**) takes a line number of the whole program. **Enter** keeps the indentation of the line above; Page Up / Down scroll.
- **F5** runs, **F2** lists the SUBs, **F1** opens the help (as in QBasic).
- Double-clicking a `.bas` file in the File Viewer opens it in the editor (`fileassoc.ini`); dropping one on the editor opens it too.

Running programs

- From the **terminal**: `basic prog.bas [arguments]` (or just `prog.bas`). The program then works like any console tool: `PRINT` writes to the console, `INPUT / LINE INPUT` read the keyboard, **pipes and redirections** work (`basic sort.bas < list.txt`). It opens a window only if it uses one (graphics, `SCREEN`, `WINDOW`, controls).
- As an **app**: a program opens a window of 80 × 25 text cells (640 × 400) at its first `PRINT`; text and graphics share it (`SCREEN 12 = 640 × 480`, `SCREEN 13 = 320 × 200`). When a text-only program ends, "Press any key to continue" keeps the window open.
- `COMMAND$` holds the arguments. Relative file names are in the program's folder.

The language

QBasic's: numbers and strings (`$`), arrays (`DIM`, up to 4 dimensions), `IF / ELSEIF`, `FOR`, `WHILE`, `DO ... LOOP`, `SELECT CASE`, `GOTO / GOSUB`, line numbers and labels, `SUB / FUNCTION` with arguments **by reference** (plain variables; an expression or a parenthesised variable goes by value), `DIM SHARED`, `STATIC`, `CONST`, `DATA / READ`, files (`OPEN ... FOR INPUT / OUTPUT / APPEND`), the string and math functions, `CLS`, `LOCATE`, `COLOR` (16 colours, or `RGB(r, g, b)`), `PSET`, `LINE (B / BF)`, `CIRCLE (F fills)`, `INKEY$`, `TIMER`, `RND`, **sound**: `PLAY "T140 03 L8 CDEFG>C"` (QBasic's music language), `SOUND freq, ticks`, `BEEP`, and Onyx's `NOTEON voice, freq[, wave, volume] / NOTEOFF [voice]` (a note that plays until stopped, 16 voices).

And the rest of QBasic 1.1 (the editor's Help ► Keywords lists everything):

- **Types:** % INTEGER, & LONG, ! SINGLE, # DOUBLE (or AS INTEGER ..., DEFINT A-Z ..., DEFSTR); INTEGER / LONG round when stored and raise *Overflow*; DOUBLES print 15 digits; fixed strings STRING * n. **User types:** TYPE ... END TYPE records (nested, in arrays, passed to SUBs, copied by =), LEN (var) their size, with **methods** (Onyx, in the way of FreeBASIC): test AS SUB (a AS INTEGER) declared in the TYPE, defined by SUB Point.Test (a) where this is the object (this.x = a, RETURN this.x + a in a FUNCTION), called as p.Test 3, y = p.F (2), t(i).Test 1; a **constructor** SUB Point.new (...): DIM p AS Point (1, 2) calls it (DIM p AS Point does not), and p = NEW Point (1, 2) makes a new object. DEF FN, RETURN value in a FUNCTION, MID\$ (...) = ..., LSET / RSET, PRINT USING (all the #, . + - ** \$\$ ^^^ ! \ \ & _ fields).
- **Errors:** ON ERROR GOTO handlers with RESUME / RESUME NEXT / RESUME label, ERR, ERL, ERROR n — an error inside a SUB comes back to the module-level handler.
- **Files:** RANDOM (records of LEN = n, GET / PUT # of numbers, strings and records, or FIELD + LSET / RSET) and BINARY files, SEEK, LOC, MKX\$ / CVX, INPUT\$, RESET, FILES, CHDIR, ENVIRON, SHELL (a /bin tool, its output on the screen).
- **Graphics:** the screen modes 1, 2, 7–13 (320-wide modes shown doubled) with pages (SCREEN m, , apage, vpage, PCOPY), PAINT, DRAW, GET / PUT sprites (PSET, PRESET, AND, OR, XOR), VIEW, WINDOW logical coordinates and PMAP, PALETTE (existing pixels change colour, as on a VGA), CIRCLE arcs / ellipses, STEP, line styles, VIEW PRINT, SCREEN (row, col). Onyx adds **FULLSCREEN**: the screen scaled to the whole display, proportions kept (a whole-number zoom when it fills nearly as much: at 1024 × 768, SCREEN 13 is shown 3×); MOUSEX / MOUSEY stay in the program's pixels.
- **Text** uses QBasic's character set (code page 437: frames CHR\$(201) ⏏, blocks CHR\$(219) █, card suits...) in the VGA fonts, drawn by the runtime: 8 × 8 in SCREEN 13 and the other 320/640 × 200 modes, 8 × 14 in SCREEN 9 / 10, 8 × 16 otherwise; DRAWTEXT is always 8 × 16. Accents typed in the editor or on the keyboard are translated (é is CHR\$(130), as in QBasic); text sent to Onyx (controls, file names, clipboard) is translated back. File contents are kept byte for byte, so an Onyx text file with accents shows other characters.
- **Keys and sound for games** (Onyx): KEYDOWN(k\$) is -1 while a key is held (k\$ as INKEY\$ gives it, e.g. CHR\$(0) + "K", or a name: "LEFT", "RIGHT", "UP", "DOWN", "SPACE", "ENTER", "ESC", a letter). PLAY "MB..." plays in the background while the program goes on (MF back to the foreground); PLAY(0) = notes still queued.
- **USB gamepads:** PAD(n) = the buttons held on pad n (0–3; PAD alone: every pad) — 1 up, 2 down, 4 left, 8 right, 16 A (bottom), 32 B (right), 64 X (left), 128 Y (top), 256 L, 512 R, 1024 L2, 2048 R2, 4096 Select, 8192 Start (IF PAD AND 16 THEN ...); QBasic's STICK(n) (0/1 = x/y of pad 0, 2/3 of pad 1, 1–199, 100 centred) and STRIG(n) (0–3 button A of pad 0/1, 4–7 button B; even n = pressed since the last call, odd = held). Nothing is pressed while the program's window is in the background. Also in the Windows runtime (Windows game controllers).
- **3D** (Onyx: drawn by the GPU; software when there is none, and in the Windows runtime): a frame is built between SCENE3D [colour] (clears to colour, black by default; -1 draws over the screen as it is) and RENDER3D (draws it on the screen; PRINT / LINE after it go on top). The camera: CAMERA3D ex, ey, ez, tx, ty, tz [, fov] (the eye, the point looked at, the field of view in degrees, 60), y is up. The light: LIGHT3D dx, dy, dz [, ambient%] (the direction it comes from; 0, 0, 0 = no lighting). Placing things: the statements act on the shapes drawn after them — TRANSLATE3D x, y, z, ROTATE3D ax, ay, az (degrees, around X then Y then Z), SCALE3D s [, sy, sz], IDENTITY3D, and PUSH3D / POP3D to save and restore the placement (32 levels: a moon around its planet). The look: COLOR3D c [, alpha] (a colour or RGB (), alpha 0–255), TEXTURE3D t [, smooth [, wrap]] (0 none; smooth 1 = filtered; wrap 0 repeat, 1 clamp, 2 mirror), BLEND3D m (0 opaque, 1 transparent, 2 added light, 3 multiply), DEPTH3D test [, write], CULL3D m (0 both faces, 1 the

front only — the default —, 2 the back only). The shapes (lit): **CUBE3D** [*size*], **SPHERE3D** [*radius* [, *detail*]], **CYLINDER3D** [*radius* [, *height* [, *detail*]]] (standing on *y* = 0), **PLANE3D** [*w* [, *d*]] (flat on *y* = 0, facing up); and any triangles: **VERTEX3D** *x*, *y*, *z* [, *s*, *t*], three by three (counter-clockwise = the front; *s*, *t* = texture coordinates 0–1). **t** = **GRAB3D** (*x*, *y*, *w*, *h*) makes a texture of a rectangle of the screen (draw it with **LINE**, **CIRCLE**, **PSET**...; magenta RGB (255, 0, 255) = transparent); **GPU3D** is -1 when the GPU draws. Example:

SD:/basic/examples/planets3d.bas (the **Planets 3D** app).

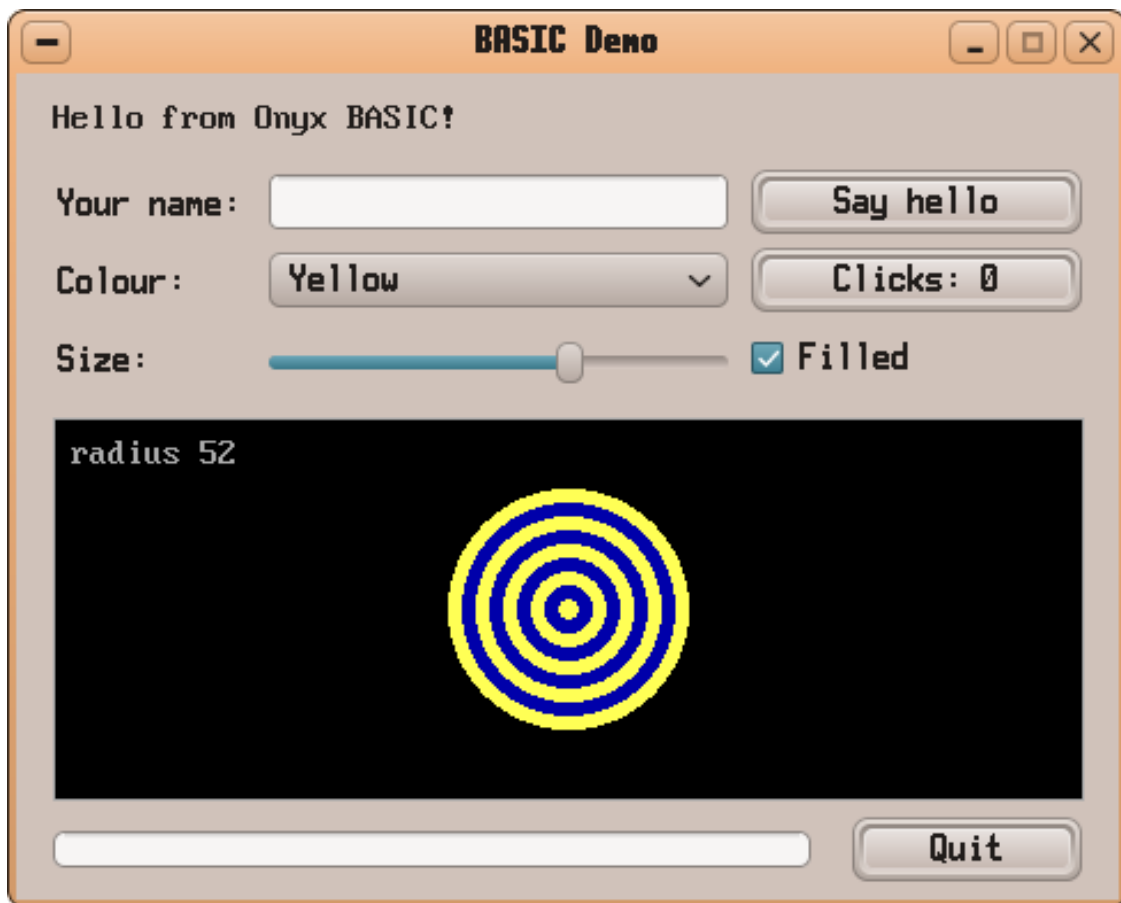
- **Events:** **ON TIMER** (*n*) **GOSUB**, **ON KEY** (*n*) **GOSUB** (F1–F12, arrows, user keys) with **TIMER** / **KEY** (*n*) **ON** / **OFF** / **STOP**. **INKEY\$** returns F1–F10 as **CHR\$(0) + CHR\$(59..68)**.
- **Programs:** **CHAIN** (with **COMMON** variables and the open files), **RUN**, **CLEAR**, **TRON** / **TROFF**, **FRE**. **Ctrl+C** stops a running program (QBasic's Ctrl+Break).
- Not supported (DOS hardware): **PEEK** / **POKE**, **DEF SEG**, **VARPTR**, **CALL ABSOLUTE**, **INP** / **OUT**, **ON COM** / **PEN** / **STRIG** / **PLAY**.

Onyx additions — a program can be a real **windowed app**:

```
WINDOW "Converter", 320, 150
c = TEXTBOX(100, 14, 120, 24, "20")
go = BUTTON(230, 12, 78, 28, "Convert")
res = LABEL(12, 60, 296, 22, "")
DO
  e = WAITEVENT ' the control used; -1 = the window was closed
  IF e = -1 THEN END
  IF e = go THEN SETTEXT res, STR$(VAL(GETTEXT$(c)) * 9 / 5 + 32) + " F"
LOOP
```

Controls: **BUTTON**, **LABEL**, **TEXTBOX**, **CHECKBOX**, **LISTBOX**, **DROPDOWN** (items "a|b|c"), **PROGRESS**, **SLIDER**; **SETTEXT** / **GETTEXT\$**, **SETVALUE** / **VALUE**, **WAITEVENT** / **EVENT**. System: **NOTIFY**, **MSGBOX**, **CLIPBOARD\$** / **SETCLIPBOARD**, **OPENFILE\$** / **SAVEFILE\$** (the file dialogs), **EXEC**, **LAUNCH**, **DRAWTEXT**, **MOUSEX** / **MOUSEY** / **MOUSEB**, **PAUSE** *ms*.

A windowed app is **in the theme's colours**, as the other Onyx apps: its background is the windows' colour, its text (**PRINT**, **DRAWTEXT**) and its default drawing colour the theme's ink, the controls drawn as everywhere else — unless the program chose its colours with **COLOR** before **WINDOW** (a **COLOR** after it changes them as usual; labels and check boxes then pick a readable ink on them). The QBasic screens — text programs, **SCREEN** modes, the games — keep their classic colours.



The

BASIC Demo, a windowed app written in BASIC, in the theme's colours (its picture keeps its own).

Apps written in BASIC

An app bundle may contain `main.bas` or `main.bax` instead of `main`: `SD:/apps/<name>.app/main.bas` (+ `app.txt`, `icon.bmp`). It is listed and launched like any app — the launchers see the file and run it with `SD:/bin/basic` (the programs for such formats are listed in `SD:/etc/runners.ini`). **File ► Make App...** in the editor creates one from the current program (it asks for the folder name and the title, and whether to compile it). Examples: **BASIC Demo** (`basicdemo`, `main.bas`), **Planets 3D** and **Arkanoid** (`arkanoid`: `main.bax`, compiled at build time from `SD:/basic/examples/arkanoid.bas` — the game is written in BASIC).

14. Troubleshooting

- **Nothing on screen / it freezes at boot.** Check that **all** the files from `sdcard/` are at the root of a **FAT32** card, that `config.txt` correctly targets `[pi4]` and that `kernel8-rpi4.img` is present. Connect the **serial** (115200) to read the log.
- **Black screen after launching an app, with green text.** The app exited (or faulted): the **debug console** took over and shows the log. Note the message; in case of a fault, the **ELR** address helps locate the problem (cf. [developer guide](#)).
- **Keyboard in the wrong layout.** Use `keyb XX`, or the Control Panel's **Keyboard & Mouse** applet (it also keeps it in `SD:/etc/autostart`).
- **Wrong resolution.** Adjust `width=/height=` in `cmdline.txt`.
- **An app stops responding / the desktop freezes.** Connect with the remote shell (`python tools/onyx-telnet.py <pi-ip>`) and run `kmsg`: the GUI watchdog logs `compositor STALLED` (with

every task's state) or `app '<title>' NOT PUMPING events`, and the `heartbeat` line shows whether frames and input still flow. Kill a frozen app with `ps + kill <pid>` (or `taskman`); otherwise, restart.

- **No mouse/keyboard.** Check that they are standard **USB HID** devices and that they are plugged in at startup (hot-plug is handled, but the initial connection is the most reliable).